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ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Laura Gentile, a Hampden County clerk, checked a ceiling for mold at the decaying Roderick C. Ireland Courthouse.

For a new courthouse, an eye-popping price

Springfield roiled by $2b cost and state's choice of location, builder

By Catherine Carlock and Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

SPRINGFIELD — The building where Laura Gentile has worked for three decades is, in a word, toxic. Black stains streak the concrete. Remnants of mold speckle ceiling tiles. Many who work there have been diagnosed with cancer; some have died of ALS.

Indeed, the Roderick C. Ireland Courthouse is in such decay that the state is planning to spend $2 billion to replace it. Yes, that's billion with a "b."

That jaw-dropping sum has cast a shadow over the Western Massachusetts city, which has long resented the power Beacon Hill wields and the attitude some feel it holds toward the farther reaches of the state.

Massachusetts leaders, however, argue that $2 billion — which includes both the cost of construction and rent over at least 40 years — may prove less expensive than some alternatives.

But everyone from Gentile and her colleagues in the Hampden County courthouse, to the mayor of Springfield, to the unhappy losing bidders, is railing against the state's location for the courthouse and team they chose to build it — which includes a Northern Virginia firm specializing in government facilities and a pair of politically connected Boston developers.

Among the questions swirling about the project is the price tag. Because how on Earth could what essentially looks like a six-story office building on a barren block in Springfield cost $2 billion?

To be clear, the construction itself costs much less: an estimated $462 million, according to the winning proposal, and perhaps as much as $525 million, state officials said.

Those expenses will be rolled into the lease payments, which over a 40-year period will top $1.6 billion; the remaining are the typical costs to operate the building over that extended timeframe, said Hannah Carrillo, a spokesperson for the Division of Capital Asset Management and Maintenance, or DCAMM, the state agency overseeing the procurement.

Construction costs have soared across the US since the COVID-19 pandemic, with disruptions to the global supply chain, spikes in materials costs, inflation, tariffs, and wars in Ukraine and Iran.

COURTHOUSE, Page A7

Despite vows, some cross casino picket line

Encore's strong lure makes it tough to measure strike's effects on the business

By Karyna Cheung
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

After a recent dinner with a friend, Malden resident Mark Crehan was in a bind. His friend wanted to go gambling at Encore Boston Harbor — the Everett casino where 1,300 workers have now been on strike for more than a month.

Crehan, a member of the electricians union IBEW Local 103, refused at first. He comes from a union family — he says his father was a Teamster — and he wasn't about to cross the picket line. He'd even driven by the picketers in recent weeks and honked his horn in support.

But as the night went on, his friend kept pressing. Once a regular at the casino, Crehan said he finally gave in. They spent a few hours at Encore, and Crehan walked out with $500 less in his pocket.

"I never thought I would cross a picket line," Crehan said. He also hadn't realized the Local 25 Teamsters were among those on strike in Everett. He insists he won't go back until the contract dispute is over.

But not everyone is willing to give up their source of entertainment to support the workers. A month into the strike, it's not yet known how much of a dent it's made on Encore's business. Revenue reports and foot traffic numbers have not yet been released by the casino or the Massachusetts Gaming Commission.

On a recent weeknight, dozens of striking workers chanting and beating drums could be

ENCORE, Page A10

Fighting addiction with compassion, not judgment

BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

"They wanted me to get clean, but they weren't forcing me," said Daniel Wood, a recovering opioid user.

Police initiative grows by offering help right away

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

KINGSTON — The young man is a known drug user, and police have come looking for him again. Three attempts, two addresses, and he continues to elude them.

Still, they try. In an unmarked SUV, Sergeant Ryan Calter and Victoria Butler, a civilian, arrive unannounced outside the modest house where he is believed to be staying.

But there will be no arrest here this day; Calter and Butler aren't even assuming he's done something wrong. Instead, they're here to offer help following a recent overdose. To listen without judgment. And to connect him with services that will steer him toward recovery.

"We've all kind of been there. We've all stumbled," said Butler, executive director of Plymouth County Outreach, which connects with the area's vulnerable residents. "There are a lot of people who are too ashamed to make the call."

What happened in Kingston is but one example of a decade-old approach to drug addiction and recovery, rooted in Massachusetts, one that stresses compassion over handcuffs. Pioneered by police chiefs in Gloucester and Arlington, and backed by an ambitious nonprofit organization, it has spread since then to hundreds of police departments across the nation.

While the epidemic of opioid use and fatal overdoses has eased, it hasn't gone away. So, the nonprofit Police Assisted Addiction and Recovery Initiative, or PAARI, is as relevant as ever, focused on treating substance abuse more as a medical condition rather

ADDICTION, Page A10

From the ocean to an appointment

Many Bermudians come to Boston for health care

By Allyson Chiu
GLOBE STAFF

When Darren Glasford needed a PET scan in 2024, the Bermuda resident did what many of his neighbors in the British territory often do for higher-level health care: He skipped the local hospital and hopped on a plane to Boston.

While Bermuda did not have the PET scans that Glasford needed for treatment of his prostate cancer, his 1,500-mile round trip was hardly extraordinary. For decades, residents of the tiny islands in the Atlantic Ocean have come to Boston as part of a little-known pipeline for medical care.

Such trips are so routine that more than 90 percent of the population had some level of insurance coverage for overseas health services.

"Boston has a big reputation with Bermuda," said Glasford, 56, a police officer whose government insurance covered much of his treatment-related costs, including travel. "Direct flight there, direct flight back, and they have the expertise, so it just makes sense."

The health care connection between Bermuda and Boston came into focus last week after a medi-

BERMUDA, Page A7

You glow girl

Thursday: Sun, some clouds. High 72-77. Low 51-56.
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The woman Tennessee tried and failed to execute, Christa Pike, was "angry and confused" after she woke up, her lawyer said. Meanwhile, a Texas court denied a request to stay the scheduled lethal injection of a man. **A2.**

In their first debate, Governor Maura Healey and Republican challenger Mike Minogue will have to contend with rising costs and President Trump, while Senator Susan Collins of Maine and Democratic opponent Troy Jackson had few standout moments in their face-off. **B1.**

Amazon will sublease 375,000 square feet of office space in the Seaport, in a partial exit that may reflect an uneven market recovery from the pandemic. **D1.**

A SOLEMN ANNIVERSARY IN THE MIDEAST

Three years after the Hamas-led attack on the site of the Nova Music Festival in Reim plunged the region into war, Israelis mourned Wednesday (at right, an installation in Tel Aviv). Militants killed 200 people and took 251 hostage. Israel's retaliatory offensive killed tens of thousands of Palestinians, destroyed much of Gaza, and drove most of its 2 million residents from their homes. Most are still living in squalid tent camps. **A3.**

ODED BALILTY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Nation

Attorney: Pike angry, confused

Believed to be first to survive lethal injection

By Kim Chandler and Kristin M. Hall
ASSOCIATED PRESS

GEORGE WALKER IV/ASSOCIATED PRESS/POOL

Christa Pike's attorneys held a news conference after a court hearing Wednesday in Nashville.

NASHVILLE, Tenn. — Christa Pike was "angry and confused" in the hours after regaining consciousness following Tennessee's failed execution attempt, first asking, "Where am I?" her lawyer said Wednesday.

Pike, believed to be the first person to survive after receiving lethal injection drugs during an execution, stunningly woke up as plans were being made to remove her from life support, just six days after she was strapped to a gurney in the death chamber, attorney Randy Spivey said.

"But on Tuesday, to the shock of everyone ... Christa woke up and began talking," Spivey said.

Pike, who was sentenced to death for the 1995 beating and stabbing death of classmate Colleen Slemmer, is aware of what happened to her, at least up to a point, Spivey said.

Many questions remain, though, about her prognosis for recovery and whether Tennessee will make another attempt to execute Pike, now age 50.

Her lawyers said Wednesday that she has suffered enough and want the governor to commute her sentence. A judge in Nashville told the state on Wednesday to save evidence from the execution attempt as Pike's attorneys try to find out more.

The failed execution on Sept. 30 has renewed scrutiny of how states carry out the death penalty, in particular the use of lethal injection. Texas was set to carry out Wednesday the first execution in the United States since Tennessee attempted to put Pike to death.

Pike's legal team said she can't move her arms or swallow and has some cognitive confusion. She also has pneumonia and a blood clot in her arm, Spivey said. Her hands were extremely swollen when they saw her Tuesday in the hospital, shackled to a bed, he added.

Her prognosis remains unclear and she has a long road to recovery, he said.

"She is angry and confused about everything right now," Spivey said during a news conference following a court hearing about preserving evidence.

Spivey, who was not with Pike when she woke up, was told her first words were, "Where am I?" and "Who are you?"

The Death Penalty Information Center says Pike is the first person to survive after receiving lethal injection drugs during an execution.

At the hearing Wednesday, a judge told the state that the Tennessee Department of Correction needs to save evidence, including "anything that was in the actual room."

Chancery Court Judge I'Ashea Myles said she plans to issue a sweeping order that will direct the state to maintain recordings, witness accounts, emails, drugs, syringes, IV lines, and other medical items.

The Tennessee attorney general's office had argued a court order was unnecessary. John W. Ayers, assistant attorney general, said some evidence from the death chamber already had been collected and logged. He declined to comment after the hearing.

Pike's attorneys accused the state of carrying out the attempted execution in secrecy, saying more transparency is needed. They also repeated their calls for clemency for Pike. Republican Governor Bill Lee has not yet indicated how he'll respond.

Outside the courthouse, Michelle Nowell yelled "Justice for Colleen" as Pike's attorneys talked with supporters.

"The victim is Colleen. The victim is not Christa Pike," said Nowell, who was among a group outside the prison last week where the failed execution took place.

The governor postponed the state's only other execution for this year and ordered a review of what went wrong. The state's prison chief resigned.

Medical and lethal injection experts have focused on the possibility that a problem with the IV line caused the drug to pool in her tissue rather than entering her bloodstream.

Pike's attorneys wrote in a court filing that "apparently at no point did any member of the execution team realize that the IV lines were not correctly placed or that the veins had blown."

State officials have not yet offered an explanation.

The attempted execution got underway when Pike was given a chance to make a final statement. About five minutes later, she raised her head and said her arm was hurting. At some point she appeared to lose consciousness, but she could be heard breathing heavily until media were escorted from the witness room nearly 90 minutes into the execution. An ambulance took Pike to a hospital.

Dr. Joel Zivot, a professor of anesthesiology and surgery in Atlanta who consulted as an expert for Pike's legal team, said it could be weeks or months before anyone knows exactly what her recovery might look like, and whether her competency could be restored so the state can try again to execute her.

State court denies request to stop execution in Texas

Lawyers cite failed attempt in Tennessee

By Jamie Stengle
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DALLAS — A Texas court on Wednesday refused to halt the execution of a man who fatally shot a convenience store clerk after his attorneys cited the failed lethal injection of Christa Pike in Tennessee.

The execution in Texas, which was set to take place later Wednesday, would be the first in the United States since Pike survived her execution last week.

Because the same drug used in Pike's attempted execution, pentobarbital, would be used in Texas for 46-year-old Jamaal Howard, his attorneys argued to the Texas Court of Criminal Appeals that the drug poses the same risks. His lawyers also raised concerns over the quality of the state's execution drugs.

The court denied the stay request without elaboration.

Pike's lawyers are seeking more information about what went wrong after the 50-year-old Pike survived two doses of pentobarbital on Sept. 30. She was hospitalized and on Wednesday was awake and speaking.

"Texas should not be eager to follow in Tennessee's footsteps; a stay would keep that from happening," Howard's attorneys had argued to the court.

Texas has executed six people so far this year, with two more scheduled after Howard, who would become the 30th person executed nationwide in 2026.

Howard was found guilty of capital murder in the 2000 killing of Vickie Swartout, 42, who was shot once in the chest during a robbery. Evidence presented at the trial included the store's surveillance video, which showed Howard shooting Swartout.

Howard, who was 20 at the time, took $114 and a carton of cigarettes from the store in the small, rural town of Silsbee, about 100 miles northeast of Houston, according to court records.

His attorneys have argued that Howard is intellectually disabled and his execution should be halted. The state said that he has not presented evidence that would show he meets the requirements for a claim of intellectual disability.

He has appealed to the US Supreme Court to stop the execution.

The Supreme Court in 2002 had barred the execution of intellectually disabled people. But it has given states some discretion in how they determine such disabilities.

The motion filed in the Court of Criminal Appeals in Texas early Wednesday said Howard's attorneys had filed requests for information about the lethal dose of pentobarbital the Texas Department of Criminal Justice planned to use. They say the department asked for a state attorney general opinion about whether they would have to disclose that information, despite a "years-long practice of disclosing information."

The Texas attorney general opinion is not expected to be returned until after Wednesday, meaning Howard can't litigate whatever decision the state might make on releasing that information, they argued.

Texas officials did not immediately return a request for comment Wednesday morning.

DAILY BRIEFING

JULIO CORTEZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Opal Lee reacted as confetti was popped during an event honoring her 100th birthday Wednesday in Fort Worth, Texas.

Opal Lee celebrates 100th birthday; kicks off construction of museum

FORT WORTH, Texas — Opal Lee celebrated her 100th birthday Wednesday by kicking off construction of a museum in her Texas hometown dedicated to telling the history of Juneteenth, the holiday commemorating the end of slavery in the United States.

"It was important for us to do this on this date because everything we've done for the last several years, everything we continue to do, is built around the spirit of the venerable Miss Opal Lee," said Jarred Howard, chief executive of the upcoming National Juneteenth Museum in Fort Worth.

Lee, founding board member of the museum, became known as the "grandmother of Juneteenth" after spending years rallying to get federal recognition for June 19. When then-president Joe Biden signed a bill into law making Juneteenth a federal holiday in 2021, Lee was by his side.

The holiday marks the day in 1865 when Union soldiers arrived in Galveston at the end of the Civil War with an order declaring the freedom of the enslaved people in Texas. It was about 2 1/2 years after the Emancipation Proclamation freed the enslaved people in the still rebellious states of the Confederacy. Six months later, the ratification of the 13th Amendment permanently ended slavery in the United States.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Man posing as ICE agent at Miami polling site faces felony charges

A Brazilian man was charged with multiple felonies for impersonating an Immigration and Customs Enforcement agent at a Miami polling site during the Brazilian presidential election Sunday.

Danilo Alves Silva, 46, is facing three felony counts — voter intimidation, conspiracy to commit bribery, and influencing a public servant — and two misdemeanors after being arrested at the Kendall Campus of Miami Dade College in Florida, one of about a dozen locations in the United States where Brazilians living abroad could vote in their country's general election.

Carlos J. Martinez, a public defender, entered a not guilty plea on Silva's behalf. The public defender's office did not immediately return a request for comment.

Silva, a Brazilian citizen living in Port St. Lucie, Fla., was seen "aggressively walking around the election site" wearing a blue ICE hat, sunglasses, a face mask, a blue ICE raid jacket, and black tactical boots, according to charging documents.

NEW YORK TIMES

FBI stops Minn. terror attack by teen

MINNEAPOLIS — FBI agents thwarted a terror attack by a teenager on the Mall of America after supplying him with an assault rifle following months of text messages, authorities said Wednesday.

The 18-year-old had been under investigation for nearly two years, trading messages with a confidential informant, before agents sold him the rifle and ammunition and arrested him on the spot, they said.

"This was a radicalized young man who needed to be watched," US Attorney Daniel Rosen said as he praised the FBI investigation. Agents "were able to detect a threat, and disrupt it, before the defendant carried out his intention to kill, in his words, maybe 30 to 60 people."

Sheikhdoon Abdullahi Mohamud, 18, was arrested Tuesday in a public park in Richfield, Minn., several miles northwest of the Mall of America, after he paid $600 to an undercover FBI employee posing as a member of ISIS for an AK-47 and 200 rounds of ammunition, according to the criminal complaint.

Daniel Rosen, US attorney for the District of Minnesota, spoke about the case.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DNA leads to arrest in R.I. murder case

A breakthrough in a 41-year-old murder case came after Rhode Island investigators tailed a man to a rock concert and collected his DNA from a water bottle that he had discarded, authorities said Tuesday.

The suspect, William Morton, 61, was charged Tuesday with first-degree murder in the death of Hillary Hellewell, who was 22. She had been sexually assaulted and killed in Newport, R.I., in May 1985, authorities said during a news conference.

Morton appeared in court Tuesday for an arraignment, and the case was referred to the public defender's office, according to records. The office did not respond to a request for comment.

He had been recently identified as a suspect through new DNA testing, as part of a review of "cold cases," Newport police said in a news release.

According to the Rhode Island attorney general's office, investigators tailed Morton and his wife in August at a concert. Investigator Michael Naylor said he watched Morton take a swig from a water bottle and leave it.

The DNA on it was consistent with a sample found on Hellewell's pants, said Rhode Island Attorney General Peter Neronha.

NEW YORK TIMES

For the record

■ **Correction:** Because of a reporting error, a story on Wednesday's Page One about the Cornell rape case provided the wrong day of a Women's March demonstration. It is scheduled for Thursday. The Globe regrets the error.

The Globe welcomes information about errors that call for corrections. Information may be sent to comments@globe.com or left in a message at 617-929-8230.

The World

DAILY BRIEFING

Search for flood victims halted

KATHMANDU, Nepal — The families of thousands of people who remain missing in Nepal weeks after catastrophic floods devastated the country have expressed mixed feelings after the government said that it is stopping the search for victims.

The office of Prime Minister Balendra Shah decided on Monday that search and rescue operations for victims of the Aug. 26 floods will cease. Instead, authorities will concentrate on rehabilitation and reconstruction including restoring roads and bridges cut off by floods, particularly in remote areas.

Rescuers have so far recovered the bodies of at least 1,455 people, but 5,285 others remain missing, including hundreds of foreign nationals.

The government estimates reconstruction and recovery will cost $4.77 billion. Nearly 33,000 people have been affected and about 7,500 homes were damaged or destroyed.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Woman at heart of protest dies

MADRID — Spain's Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez on Wednesday expressed his condolences after the reported death of María del Carmen Abascal, the 87-year-old woman whose eviction sparked nationwide protests.

"All my love to Maricarmen's family and loved ones," Sánchez said in a post on X. "A hug as well to all of us who feel this loss as our own today."

Maricarmen, as she was known, had been hospitalized since she was carried out from the apartment where she had lived for seven decades. She was expected to return home after accepting a deal with the company that owned her apartment.

Her case has drawn tens of thousands of people to the streets in outrage and led the prime minister to call for early elections after failing to pass measures to address the country's housing crisis.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Ex-first lady held over money charge

COLOMBO, Sri Lanka — The wife of Sri Lanka's powerful former president Mahinda Rajapaksa was detained Wednesday on allegations of misusing donations received for her charity when she was first lady.

Police questioned Shiranthi Rajapaksa at her home and later took her before a court, which ordered her detained for a week.

Rajapaksa was accused of misusing funds that her charity received as a donation from a state bank earmarked for the purchase of a scanner for a government hospital. The then-head of the bank also was arrested for allegedly circumventing procedures in releasing the money to the charity. The court released him on bail.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

9 hurt in attack at Polish school

OSTROLEKA, Poland — A 19-year-old student at a vocational school in northern Poland attacked fellow students, teachers, and passersby with a sharp object Wednesday, injuring nine people before fleeing and being arrested nearby, authorities said.

The attack took place about 11 a.m. local time at the Vocational School Complex No. 4 in Ostroleka, about 75 miles northeast of Warsaw, police said. Authorities did not provide any information about the suspected motive, or details about the weapon.

None of the injuries were life-threatening, but one person was seriously wounded and some victims were evacuated by helicopter to a hospital.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Three Oct. 7s later, mourning, ruins

Israelis weep for those lost; Gaza lies in rubble

By Melanie Lidman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

OMAR AL-QATTAA /AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

(Above), children of displaced Palestinians played atop a destroyed building in Gaza City Wednesday, while (below) Raz Zarfati, whose brother Run died in the 2023 Hamas attack, attended a memorial service in southern Israel.

REIM, Israel — On a field where music festival revelers were gunned down by Hamas-led militants three years ago, Israelis on Wednesday embraced and wept for those lost in an attack that plunged the Middle East into war.

Israelis mourned at the site of the Nova Music Festival, as well as at bomb shelters, intersections, and in communities targeted on Oct. 7, 2023. On that day — the deadliest in the country's history — militants killed 1,200 people and took 251 hostage. Israel's retaliatory offensive killed tens of thousands of Palestinians, destroyed much of Gaza, and drove most of its 2 million residents from their homes.

This is the first anniversary since all the hostages, living and dead, were returned. Signs calling for their return are mostly gone, but reminders of those who were killed are ubiquitous in a country still reckoning with the trauma of that day.

For Palestinians, the anniversary brings another day of fear and misery. Most Gaza residents live in squalid tent camps, with large parts of cities bombed to rubble. More than half the territory remains in the hands of the Israeli military. Despite a cease-fire deal reached nearly a year ago, Israeli strikes continue almost daily.

Israeli troops occupy a large chunk of southern Lebanon in their conflict with Hezbollah militants, who began firing on Israel in 2023 in support of Hamas. Iran, the United States, and their allies are locked in a confrontation that has seen attacks across the region and has shaken the global economy — a conflict that Israel helped launch and that the war in Gaza paved the way for, even if they weren't directly connected.

Hundreds of people paid their respects to the more than 350 people killed in and around the festival site. Videos from that day showed militants gunning down fleeing revelers, shooting the wounded at point-blank range, and ambushing those seeking refuge in bomb shelters.

On Wednesday, survivors' relatives hugged at 6:29 a.m. — the exact time the first rockets were launched three years ago — as explosions boomed in nearby Gaza.

Anya Davitashili, who lost her 25-year-old son, Sean, said she visits the site every Saturday. It's where she feels closest to him.

"I have a video of him dancing here that ends at 6:29 in the morning. It's in front of my eyes all the time," she said. "Every morning, you wake up and there is just endless missing.

Elkana Bohbot, 37, is marking the anniversary in Israel for the first time since his release after 738 days of captivity. For most of that time, he said, he was held underground in a dark, damp tunnel.

Bohbot, who was abducted from the festival, was kept in a small cell with other hostages, given little food and allowed to bathe only every few weeks, he said. His captors forced him to take part in propaganda videos, including one where he acted out a fake call to his family.

OHAD ZWIGENBERG/ASSOCIATED PRESS

In the year since his release, Bohbot has undergone physical and emotional rehabilitation. In August, his wife, Rivka, gave birth to a daughter, fulfilling his promise to himself in the tunnels to give his 5-year-old son, Reem, a sibling.

The newborn Michele is "not a symbol for my people, she is more of a symbol for the enemy," Bohbot told The Associated Press. "This child is the message for you that we were here and we will always be here forever."

No events were expected Wednesday in Gaza, but Hamas in a statement defended the Oct. 7 attack, saying it had returned the Palestinian cause to the world's attention.

"The conflict with the enemy did not begin on that day, [and] its final chapters are not written yet," it said.

Palestinians in the territory said their suffering over the past three years had previously been unimaginable.

"We witnessed death, destruction, and bombardment that we had never known before," said Walid Akram, a Gaza City resident who, like most in Gaza, has been displaced by the war.

Raed Khozeiq's coastal neighborhood in Tel al-Hawa was largely flattened. Nothing about his life is the same, he said."No country in the world has gone through what we have experienced here. A war of extermination, starvation, the absence of schools and universities — nothing remains."

More than 74,000 Palestinians have been killed in Gaza, according to the territory's Health Ministry, whose numbers are seen as generally reliable by UN agencies and independent experts. While a cease-fire that took effect Oct. 10, 2025, halted the heaviest fighting, Israeli strikes have continued, targeting what Israel says are Hamas militants. Since the cease-fire, 1,460 Palestinians have been killed in Gaza, according to the ministry. Five Israeli soldiers have been killed in attacks in that period. Restrictions on the entry of goods and aid have contributed to a hunger crisis, food security experts say.

Russia says it found no 'emergency' in plague lab

Death of worker raises fears, but risks seen as low

By Paul Sonne
NEW YORK TIMES

TATYANA MAKEYEVA / AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

A security worker looked out Wednesday from the infectious diseases hospital in Siberia where an employee of the Irkutsk Antiplague Research Institute had died Oct. 2.

BERLIN — Russian authorities gave additional information Wednesday about the mysterious death of a researcher at a Siberian institute that studies the plague, saying that she had been vaccinated against the disease and that no "emergency situations" had been identified at the lab.

Rospotrebnadzor, the Russian health regulator, issued the statement after the United States urged Moscow to be more forthcoming about the possible public health incident.

The paucity of details in Russian official statements and the absence of international health officials on the scene have led to questions about the Russian government's insistence that it has the situation under control. The world has remained on high alert about public health threats in the aftermath of the COVID-19 pandemic.

On Oct. 2, Darya Shipilova, a 28-year-old researcher at the Anti-Plague Institute of Siberia and the Far East in Irkutsk, died from pneumonia of an unknown origin at a hospital in Shelekhov, the town where she lived, prompting fears of a pneumonic plague outbreak.

Shipilova had been vaccinated against the plague and therefore "had immunity to the dangerous infections she worked with," the Russian health regulator said Wednesday. The statement implied that Shipilova had a lower risk of contracting the plague, though vaccination would not definitively rule out becoming ill with the disease.

Rospotrebnadzor also said that two commissions monitoring biological safety had inspected the institute. "No emergency situations were identified during work with pathogenic microorganisms," the health regulator said.

Tests on Shipilova's remains, the regulator previously said, had not found evidence of any of the microorganisms she worked with at the institute.

Medical observation has been completed for more than 90 percent of the people Shipilova had been in contact with, and "no health impairments related to infectious pathology were detected," the Russian regulator added. Nearly 5,000 laboratory tests revealed no hazardous pathogenic microorganisms, its statement said.

"Preventive and anti-epidemic measures have been organized to an exhaustive extent," Rospotrebnadzor said in the statement. "There are no epidemiological risks for the population of Irkutsk and the Irkutsk region."

Russian authorities released the additional information after the State Department sent a formal diplomatic note, known as a demarche, to Russia asking for more information about a possible outbreak.

Secretary of State Marco Rubio also voiced the request publicly Tuesday during a trip to Iceland, noting that the United States was monitoring the situation.

"I think it's incumbent upon Russia to obviously share more information with the world," Rubio said. "We're watching it very closely, hour by hour."

Shipilova's unexplained death prompted Russian authorities to quarantine part of the hospital where she was taken, the institute's staff, and other people whom she had come into contact with in her final days. Other facilities in and around Irkutsk also implemented restrictive measures, in some cases as a precaution.

In the immediate aftermath of Shipilova's death, the Russian authorities gave only sparing public statements, failing to clarify the researcher's whereabouts before her death or to address questions about whether an accident had taken place at the institute. The Russian health regulator also waited five days after Shipilova's death to reveal her vaccination status. An independent Russian publication, People of Baikal, cited a former intern at the institute who said all employees were vaccinated against the plague.

The Kremlin spokesperson, Dmitry Peskov, has referred questions to Rospotrebnadzor, which has not held any news conference on the matter. Russian President Vladimir Putin has not publicly commented.

The relatively thin details from Russian authorities have unnerved US officials and others around the world who remain scarred by the COVID pandemic and efforts by the authoritarian government in China, where the virus originated, to cover up information.

Experts have said that even if plague were confirmed in the Russian case, the risk of widespread contagion would be limited. In a statement Monday, the World Health Organization said that based on available information, "The public health risk to the general population appears to be low."

Chemists win Nobel for deciphering mirrored molecules

Discovery helped transform drug development

By Adithi Ramakrishnan, Kostya Manenkov, and Stefanie Dazio
ASSOCIATED PRESS

STOCKHOLM — Scientists Henri B. Kagan and Kenso Soai won the Nobel Prize in chemistry Wednesday for untangling mysterious mirror images in molecules, a discovery that has been used to develop countless drugs and transformed modern medicine.

Many molecules come in versions that look alike but are not exactly identical, like right and left hands. Kagan, who is from France, and Soai, from Japan, found ways to make chemistry pick a side, describing and designing reactions to produce the desired mirror image.

"The medicines we have today would not be possible without this chemistry," said Rigoberto Hernandez, president of the American Chemical Society.

Soai was shopping at a neighborhood supermarket when he heard he had won.

"I'm very excited to receive the very nice news," Soai told the Nobel committee and journalists by phone. "Of course, this is one of the most exciting days in my life."

Mirror images of the same molecule can have different properties. For example, one version of the chemical carvone smells like mint, while the other has a whiff of caraway, a spice often used in rye bread.

The alternate versions can also behave differently when interacting with other chemicals. When designing drugs to treat diseases, scientists are choosy about which mirror image they use. They want the version of a molecule to treat a cold, not one that will make the sniffles worse.

In the 1980s, Kagan's work showed there might be a way to design reactions to produce one form of a molecule over the other. Years later, Soai perfected the process. He created the first-ever chemical reaction to efficiently produce only one of a molecule's mirror images, in what's now known as the Soai reaction.

"This is probably the coolest experiment in organic chemistry," said Peter Somfai, a member of the Nobel Committee for Chemistry.

Kagan, 95, is affiliated with the Université Paris-Sud in Orsay, France. Soai, 76, is affiliated with the Tokyo University of Science. The Nobel committee described their work as a feat never previously achieved by anyone "other than life itself."

The French Academy of Sciences, where Kagan is a member, congratulated him, as did French President Emmanuel Macron, who called the prize "an immense source of pride for the country" and "a recognition befitting a lifetime of research."

"It might be difficult to say that this drug, or that drug, was developed using this," Somfai said. "I would say all of them, because we use this as a tool, we use this as an understanding, how to develop catalysts, how they function."

Life, too, prefers one mirror image over the other. DNA twists to the right, and the proteins in human bodies are made of mostly left-handed building blocks.

In addition to developing better medicines or perfumes, deciphering the mirror images of molecules can help scientists understand the chemical architecture of life, said chemist Holden Thorp, editor-in-chief of the journal Science.

"There are still fascinating aspects that remain unknown and surely more yet to be discovered," Soai said at a news conference hosted by his university in Tokyo. "I hope to do what I can, however modestly, to contribute to help advance research in this field."

Japan's largest newspaper, Yomiuri, distributed an extra edition with a headline proclaiming "Nobel Prize Mr. Soai," with a big photo of the scientist. The papers quickly disappeared as office workers picked them up on their way home.

The Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences announced the winner in Stockholm.

Last year, three scientists won the chemistry Nobel for their development of new molecular structures that can trap vast quantities of gas inside, laying the groundwork to potentially suck greenhouse gases out of the atmosphere or harvest moisture from desert environments.

This year's prizes began with the Nobel for medicine, awarded Monday to three scientists whose work led to a tool that uses light to help unravel how the brain works. The physics award announced Tuesday recognized a scientist's efforts to demystify a rare group of neutrinos.

The literature prize is set to be awarded Thursday. After Friday's peace prize is awarded, the Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences will be announced Monday.

The prize money this year is 12 million Swedish kronor (about $1.2 million), whether for an individual, a small group of laureates, or an organization.

Ukraine claws back land in the Donbas

Counterattack thwarts Putin, Russia's goals

By Marc Santora and Josh Holder
NEW YORK TIMES

EVGENIY MALOLETKA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

People cleared the rubble of a residential building destroyed in a Russian missile strike on Pryluky, Ukraine, Wednesday.

Russian President Vladimir Putin has repeatedly said that the fall of the Donbas region in eastern Ukraine is inevitable and will happen faster than Ukraine thinks.

Recent trends on the battlefield paint a different picture.

A monthslong Ukrainian counteroffensive in the northern part of the Donbas has thwarted Russian efforts to encircle the remaining Ukrainian-controlled cities in the region. Russia, Western analysts say, has lost dozens of square miles of territory during the Ukrainian campaign, which Ukraine is calling Operation Vivaldi.

In the southern Donbas, Russia continues to mount furious assaults to break through Ukrainian lines. But Ukraine has reorganized its defense there and has so far kept the Russian military from pressing farther in its efforts to surround the major Donbas cities.

More broadly, Russian gains across Ukraine have slowed markedly in 2026 from their already glacial pace of last year. September was the worst month in net territorial gains for Russia inside Ukraine since June 2023, according to Finland-based research firm Black Bird Group.

While Western researchers who track the battlefield report varying numbers, they generally agree that Russia has gained only slightly more land than it has lost this year.

That contrasts sharply with the narrative put forward by the Russian Ministry of Defense, which said on Sept. 19 that Russia had captured more than 2,000 square miles. Even ultranationalist Russian military bloggers have pushed back, voicing concern that Russia's push to envelop the so-called fortress cities of the Donbas is failing.

The Ukrainian gains have come as both sides have tried to find a way to restore movement on a battlefield that had become largely deadlocked because of ubiquitous drones.

The Vivaldi operation, said George Barros, a senior analyst at the Washington-based Institute for the Study of War, shows that when a military lays the necessary groundwork, mechanized movement remains possible even under dense drone surveillance. Still, it took Ukraine months of preparations to reclaim a tiny fraction of its lost land.

Putin has said full Russian control of the Donbas, gained either through force or through Ukrainian concessions, is a nonnegotiable condition for ending the war. Ukraine has rejected Trump administration proposals that it hand over land that Russia has failed to seize on the battlefield.

With its goals still unmet in the Donbas, Moscow has escalated its air war against Ukrainian cities, using its advantage in missiles and drones to bombard Kyiv, the capital. Strikes in several cities overnight Wednesday left at least 20 people dead, Ukrainian officials said. They have called the Russian bombardment a campaign of terrorism aimed at breaking the country's will to fight.

Operation Vivaldi is named for what Ukraine calls the campaign's four "seasons," or phases, and refers to the composer's most famous work.

As Russian forces moved forward this year in areas east of the "fortress belt" cities of Sloviansk and Kramatorsk, and pushed into Kostiantynivka from the south, Ukraine prepared a counteroffensive to the north.

When it was launched, Ukrainian soldiers said the Russians, caught by surprise, often deployed reinforcements to areas where Ukrainian forces had already advanced, leading to ambushes.

President Volodymyr Zelensky of Ukraine said that more than 5,000 Russian troops had been killed in the operation so far, and that an additional 250 had been captured.

The New York Times could not independently verify those figures.

US Marine accused of murder draws fury

Triggers calls for action in Japan

By Javier C. Hernández and Kiuko Notoya
NEW YORK TIMES

TOKYO — For days, the people of Okinawa, a Japanese prefecture that hosts a large US military presence, have expressed outrage over the death of a local woman, who the authorities say was killed by an American Marine.

On Wednesday, the anger reached the doorstep of Japan's prime minister, Sanae Takaichi, a close American ally who has sought to accelerate a military buildup in Okinawa.

Genta Koja, the prefecture's governor, had traveled to the capital to meet Takaichi and her advisers. He told Takaichi that the killing of the woman, Anna Yagi, "has caused great anxiety among the prefecture's residents and is absolutely unforgivable," according to a video of the meeting posted by the prime minister's office. Koja also expressed concern about the US military, telling Takaichi that efforts by the United States to strengthen discipline among personnel in Okinawa "are not working."

Takaichi reiterated at the meeting that Japan had lodged a protest with the US government.

"It is extremely regrettable that such a brutal and heinous incident has occurred," she said. "I feel strong indignation."

Koja is an ally of Takaichi and won office last month promising to uphold the central government's defense policies. But he has faced pressure from Okinawans in recent days to deliver a forceful response to Tokyo and Washington. Japan has worked to turn Okinawa into a bulwark in its efforts to counter Chinese military aggression, in concert with the United States, which has about 30,000 active-duty personnel stationed there.

At the meeting, he handed Takaichi a request that called on the central government to help promote economic growth to "alleviate the excessive burden of military bases." In the case of Yagi, he asked for "full cooperation with the investigation, the enforcement of discipline among US military personnel, the implementation of measures to prevent recurrence, and effective, fundamental countermeasures."

The Marine, Devin J. Ballard, a 20-year-old lance corporal assigned to the 3rd Marine Expeditionary Force in Okinawa, was arrested Sunday. He is accused of robbing and killing Yagi, 39, who was found in a hotel room in Naha, Okinawa's capital, on Saturday. Okinawan news outlets have reported that he told the police he denied the charges.

US military officials in Japan announced Tuesday that they would pause operations for two days and impose a ban on alcohol during that period. They also plan to implement a monthlong curfew on Okinawan bases.

Pope Leo embraces Francis' openness to civil remarriages

Urges bishops to listen to families in weak moments

By Nicole Winfield
ASSOCIATED PRESS

VATICAN CITY — Pope Leo XIV on Wednesday urged Catholic leaders to courageously accompany families in their weaknesses and failures, as he embraced one of Pope Francis' most contentious teachings about welcoming Catholics in second marriages and otherwise "irregular" unions.

Leo opened a weeklong, closed-door conference assessing the implementation of Francis' 2016 document "The Joy of Love." Leo called the text an "important" step in the church's long tradition of ministering to Catholic families for the sake of passing the faith on to future generations.

The document covers a host of issues relating to how the church can better minister to families today as they cope with issues such as poverty, war, LGBTQ+ children, and divorce. But when it was released after a yearslong consultation, "The Joy of Love" immediately sparked controversy, because it opened the door to allowing civilly remarried Catholics to receive Communion.

Church teaching holds that unless these Catholics obtain an annulment — a church decree that their first marriage was invalid — they can't receive the sacraments, since they are seen as living in sin and committing adultery.

Francis didn't create a church-wide pass for these Catholics, but suggested that bishops and priests could do so on a case-by-case basis after accompanying them on a spiritual journey of discernment.

In his opening remarks, Leo didn't refer specifically to Francis' opening to civilly remarried Catholics. Speaking in English, he seemed keen to redirect the conversation to the broader issues facing young people and families today, including how to incorporate sex and intimacy within the Christian "vision" of marriage.

He urged the bishops to pay specific attention to families in their weakest moments, to listen to them, and to look at whether the church is able to respond to them.

"The experience of fragility raises the question of whether we are able to remain close to one another when life no longer corresponds to what had been hoped for, and whether we can recognize the work of grace even in situations marked by limits, wounds, and apparent failure," Leo said.

ANDREW MEDICHINI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Pope Leo XIV greeted a child as he left his weekly general audience in St. Peter's Square, at the Vatican, on Wednesday.

The pontiff challenged the bishops to consider what kind of church people encounter when they are most fragile.

"Do our communities help them discover that they still have a place, a responsibility and gifts to offer? Can the truth we proclaim be encountered through the patience, closeness, and mercy of our pastoral presence?" he asked.

Francis' 2016 document became one of the most divisive of his pontificate and in many ways became the focal point of conservative opposition to his papacy.

Within the first year of publication, four conservative cardinals formally asked Francis to clarify certain questions raised by the text. They argued that church doctrine held that Catholics who remarried without a church annulment were living in sin and couldn't receive the sacraments.

He never replied.

For a variety of reasons, such annulments often can't be obtained, though Francis issued a separate reform to simplify, facilitate, and accelerate the process. The aim was to respond to cases where a spouse wasn't at fault for the failure of a marriage, such as a woman who experienced abuse at the hands of her first husband and merely wanted to remarry in the church and raise her children in the faith.

Sister Helen Alford, president of the Vatican's social sciences academy, urged the bishops in attendance to consider the "law of gradualness" in applying church law to such difficult family situations. The gradualness concept calls for nuance rather than black-and-white application of rules and norms.

"When social situations are turbulent and changing quickly, it can be necessary to find new ways of putting together both the objective demands of the law and the law of gradualness that many experience," she said.

Organizers of the conference insisted the meeting wasn't convened to debate or rewrite Francis' original text, but rather to understand how it had been implemented and what lies ahead.

Supreme Court weighs future of tropical beach in Guam

Site used by US forces to explode bombs since 1982

By Abbie VanSickle
NEW YORK TIMES

HIROKO MASUIKE/NEW YORK TIMES

Monaeka Flores, executive director of Prutehi Guahan, whose family has deep roots on Guam, at Tarague Beach on Sept. 28.

Tarague Beach is a tropical expanse of white sand on the island of Guam, where sea turtles lay their eggs, migratory seabirds forage, and reef fish glide in the clear blue-green water.

But the future of the beach, nearly 8,000 miles from Washington, D.C., now rests with the Supreme Court. The justices heard oral arguments Wednesday over a legal challenge to a US Air Force program to destroy expired rockets, bombs, and hazardous waste munitions on the beach.

For decades, the Air Force has used the spot to dispose of military waste, but Prutehi Guahan, a local nonprofit dedicated to protecting Guam's natural and cultural resources, sued to challenge the practice, arguing that the military had not properly considered the threats to the environment.

A lower court had found the group could not bring the suit. During Wednesday's argument, several justices across the ideological spectrum appeared concerned with that finding, worried that siding against Prutehi Guahan might mean foreclosing the group's ability to even bring a legal challenge against the Air Force, regardless of whether the group would ultimately win such a suit.

But many of the justices also raised worries that allowing the challenge could flood the court system with a host of other lawsuits. A decision in the case is expected by the end of June.

Guam's proximity to Asia — it's closer to Beijing than to Hawaii — has made it an increasingly important military outpost. That presence has only grown in recent years with rising tensions in the Pacific. Military experts often refer to the small island — about 170,000 people live on its 210 square miles, roughly five times smaller than Rhode Island — as the tip of the spear for US military might in the region.

Tarague Beach is near the northern tip of the island, within the bounds of Andersen Air Force Base, and for decades the military has used it as a place to destroy expired munitions. The leaders of Prutehi Guahan have challenged the practice, arguing that the explosions threaten the fragile marine ecosystem, nearby archaeological remains, traditional fishing sites, and the island's water supply, sending dangerous toxins and debris hurtling into the air and the water.

The legal question for the Supreme Court was a technical one about whether the Air Force followed environmental regulations as it sought a permit in recent years to continue detonations on the beach. In court filings, the Air Force has said that the detonation site is crucial for disposing of hazardous waste and that although it must reapply for a permit every three years, that process is meant to ensure ordinary compliance with the rules and not impose new restrictions.

The challengers say the dispute is deeply personal. They argue that enforcing federal environmental laws is among the few ways for Guam residents — who are US citizens by birth but who cannot vote for the president — to make their voices heard against the powerful US military.

"It's truly one of the only mechanisms that we have to have an impact on federal projects that will permanently alter our physical landscape, our environment, our cultural resources, and our daily lives," said Monaeka Flores, executive director of Prutehi Guahan, who is Chamorro, the Indigenous people of Guam.

Near the beach is the site of what is thought to be a more than 3,000-year-old Chamorro village, with stone megaliths and prehistoric rock paintings. The Guam National Wildlife Refuge, a protected area for fruit bats, birds, and turtles, is only a few hundred yards away.

"This is part of the collective memory, and therefore collective stewardship, of the Chamorro people," Flores said. "We need to preserve it for all future generations, and everybody should have a chance to come and appreciate how special the area is."

The US Air Force first received a hazardous waste permit in 1982 to use the beach as a site for disposing of unexploded ordnance — tear gas, ammunition, and other explosives — some dating back to World War II. The military set up what it calls an open detonation site on the sand.

Prutehi Guahan argues that when the Air Force reapplied for a permit from the Guam Environmental Protection Agency to continue the explosions in May 2021, it did so without properly examining the environmental consequences or allowing for public comment.

The requirement for the Air Force to renew the permit comes from a 1976 law called the Resource Conservation and Recovery Act. That law gives the Environmental Protection Agency the power to authorize state and territorial regulators to handle the treatment, storage, or disposal of hazardous waste. Lawyers for the Air Force have asserted that the military viewed the permitting process as part of ensuring its ongoing compliance with environmental rules.

But the challengers say the military should also be required to undergo a vigorous environmental review under a Nixon-era law called the National Environmental Policy Act. That law has been interpreted by federal courts to require the government to take a "hard look" at any environmental consequences of plans before taking actions that could significantly affect "the quality of the human environment."

After the Air Force sought the new permit, the Guam Environmental Protection Agency, the local territorial agency tasked with ensuring compliance with environmental laws, received public comments on the plan. After hearing concerns about the explosions, the agency announced it would consider whether to give the military its permit. In the meantime, though, the Air Force was allowed to keep detonating munitions on the beach.

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HIV research networks face uncertainty amid fund delays

Renewal process delayed by administration

By Apoorva Mandavilli and Benjamin Mueller
NEW YORK TIMES

The future of four large research networks that test vaccines and treatments for HIV, tuberculosis, and emerging infectious diseases is in limbo after weeks of delays from the Trump administration in launching the process to renew their funding.

Scientists are worried that the delays could foreshadow the end of the networks, at least in their current form.

HIV researchers grew more concerned Friday when they received word from the National Institutes of Health that they should temporarily hold off on launching new studies that had not yet enrolled participants and that would not be complete by Nov. 30, 2027, when their current funding is set to expire.

Delays to medical research spending have become a chronic issue during the second Trump administration, and funding for the networks may yet be renewed. But some scientists warned that any delays could jeopardize the safety of participants in clinical trials, derail time-sensitive studies, and disrupt staffing and resources.

"Just the loss of momentum that will happen when you don't have funding is enormous," said Dr. Emily Erbelding, who led an infectious disease division at the NIH before she was ousted from the agency in 2025. "I don't know whether the powers that be are understanding that these days," she added.

The Department of Health and Human Services did not answer questions about whether or when the NIH would kick off the process to renew the networks' funding beyond next year.

A department spokesperson, Grace Davis Jamison, instead sent an emailed statement that said the administration was planning continued investment in HIV research that delivers "meaningful results."

The networks' leaders said their worries stemmed from the Trump administration's cuts to HIV work generally. The administration has made sharp reductions to foreign aid dedicated to fighting HIV. It has overhauled the work of a landmark global HIV program and has fired roughly a third of staff from the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention's division for HIV prevention. It has proposed steep budget cuts to HIV surveillance and prevention nationwide.

Last year, the NIH ended a $258 million multisite program whose work was instrumental to the search for an HIV vaccine. Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. has been heavily critical of the hunt for a vaccine, writing in a 2021 book about Dr. Anthony Fauci's "vain obsession to develop an HIV vaccine" and testifying before a House panel last year that federal spending on the goal "accomplishes nothing."

The current funding delay affects Advancing Clinical Therapeutics Globally, a network that formed 40 years ago, as well as the HIV Prevention Trials Network, the HIV Vaccine Trials Network and the International Maternal Pediatric Adolescent AIDS Clinical Trials Network, which were formed years later. Together, the four networks work in dozens of countries and have conducted hundreds of clinical trials. They total more than $300 million each year, most of which comes from the federal government, although the exact amounts vary as studies begin and end at various times.

The programs' large footprint has enabled them to develop tools to prevent and treat HIV, including in marginalized or rare populations such as pregnant women, adolescents, and people who are resistant to multiple available drugs.

Having a ready base of researchers, data systems, and communities of participants has also helped in other health crises. The networks were used during the coronavirus pandemic to quickly enroll tens of thousands of participants to test vaccines and treatments — including a monoclonal antibody treatment used on President Trump.

Funding for the networks and their research sites is renewed every seven years. But questions over their future have grown since the Trump administration delayed publishing so-called notices of funding opportunities, a formal signal to scientists that the renewal process would begin. The federal government had said it expected to post the notices by Aug. 25. As of Wednesday, they still had not gone out.

A federal official said that the notices were under review by HHS, which is led by Kennedy, who has overseen vast cuts to many federal health programs. The official spoke on condition of anonymity to describe the review process.

The second Trump administration has significantly pared back the release of funding opportunities across medical research topics and left many such notices in limbo. It has also subjected the notices to new layers of political review, slowing their release.

Dr. Jay Bhattacharya, the NIH director, has alarmed some scientists by pushing to steer federal spending away from basic research on new HIV vaccines and treatments and toward studies of how to deploy existing tools for fighting the disease.

Bhattacharya has been a staunch supporter of lenacapavir, a treatment that includes injections taken twice a year that prevents HIV infection. But many HIV experts note that only a vaccine or cure can stop the epidemic, which still affects more than 40 million people worldwide and kills more than 500,000 people each year.

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New subway gates deterred fare evasion, MTA says

New York plans to install them at 50 more stations

By Stefanos Chen
NEW YORK TIMES

NEW YORK — Governor Kathy Hochul and transit officials announced Wednesday that the first batch of whooshing, beeping, metal-and-glass fare gates installed in New York City's century-old subway system may be turning the tide on fare evasion.

The new saloon-style doors — part of a pilot program that started last year to replace decades-old turnstiles at 20 stations — have led to an average of 35 percent less fare beating, according to the Metropolitan Transportation Authority, the state agency that runs the subway. (The MTA compared fare-gate data with the last full month of turnstile data at each station.)

At two of the stations, Hoyt Street and the Nostrand Avenue A/C station in Brooklyn, fare evasion fell 72 percent when turnstiles were replaced with the new gates, the agency said.

Encouraged by the results, the MTA said it was proceeding with a plan to install one or more versions of the new fare gates at 50 more stations across the Bronx, Brooklyn, Queens, and Manhattan by the end of next year. Three companies are vying for contracts, and selection of equipment for the next 20 stations is expected to begin this month.

Hochul, speaking at a news conference Wednesday morning at a high-security MTA facility in Queens where three fare gate models were being tested, said the effort was crucial for the regional economy.

"Nothing is more frustrating for those who are paying their fares than to see others who can clearly pay, but don't," she said. "Every time a fare beater steals a ride, they're stealing money meant for our trains and buses that keep them moving."

She also noted that the new models were more accessible than turnstiles for people with disabilities, parents with strollers, and travelers with luggage.

The fare gates used during the pilot — at busy hubs that include Times Square in Manhattan, Bedford Park Boulevard in the Bronx, and Roosevelt Avenue in Queens — were paid for by the vendors. The companies, Cubic, Conduent, and STraffic, have installed similar gates in cities such as Paris, London, and Los Angeles. Cubic also built the subway's tap-and-go payment system, OMNY.

The promising results follow a bumpy rollout for the new fare gates. Some riders have complained that the devices can cause bottlenecks because they are slow to accept payment, or even occasionally trap riders as they walk through. Some gates emit sirens when they register a fare beater, filling loud stations with another layer of noise. Social media posts have shown people inventing new ways to slink under, climb over, and burst through the doors.

The MTA has said the pilot was designed to address technical issues with the gates. The goal, the agency said, is not to eradicate fare evasion but to discourage the casual scofflaw — who might intend to pay the fare but decide to skip it after seeing other people walk through an open emergency gate.

By 2029, the MTA plans to spend more than $1 billion to install one or more of the models at 150 of the city's 472 subway stations, covering three-fourths of all traffic in the system. The investment is part of a record $68 billion, five-year capital plan that Hochul approved last year.

Based on the pilot findings, Hochul projected that, by 2029, the MTA could recoup $100 million a year in fare revenue.

More than 4 million people ride the subway every day. Fare beating surged during and after the COVID-19 pandemic and has been a persistent problem for the MTA, which relies on fare revenue for more than a quarter of its $21 billion annual operating budget. Those funds pay for the subway's vast workforce, growing utility costs such as electricity, and debt-related costs.

Fare evasion on the subway peaked at 14 percent in 2024, up from about 3 percent in the same period in 2018, according to the authority.

Janno Lieber, the chief executive of the MTA, has waged a wide-ranging campaign against it, installing spiky dividers and curved barriers at turnstiles and stationing gate guards at emergency exits.

The efforts appear to be working. In the second quarter of this year, the rate of fare evasion on the subway fell to about 10 percent — one of the lowest rates since the pandemic.

Trump officials scrutinize voter registration groups

POLITICAL NOTEBOOK

WASHINGTON — As the Trump administration promotes doubts about the integrity of the voting system before the midterm elections, Homeland Security officials have investigated more than 150 organizations as part of its effort to scrutinize nonprofits they say may be helping noncitizens illegally register to vote, according to internal government documents reviewed by The New York Times.

The documents also reveal that the department has considered deploying undercover agents to investigate the organizations. If they were found to be actively recruiting noncitizens for voter registration, the agents could gather evidence and "disrupt activities," the documents said. The findings could then be used to initiate prosecutions and "dismantle illicit facilitation networks," according to the documents, which were shared with the Times by Democracy Forward, a legal advocacy organization that received them through a public records request.

The details were included in a June memo providing status updates on the Department of Homeland Security's "election integrity investigations," an effort by the Trump administration to find and root out noncitizens who illegally voted or registered to vote.

The problem of noncitizens voting in the United States is a rare one, and there is no credible evidence that it has swayed an election. But the administration and its allies have been aggressively seeking data to back up assertions that Democrats could benefit from the support of noncitizens in the Nov. 3 midterm elections, in which Republicans are at risk of losing control of one or both chambers of Congress.

The investigations into nonprofits underscore how far-reaching the administration's pursuit of noncitizens on the voter rolls has become. The investigations have stretched beyond individuals to include organizations that help and encourage people to register to vote, a tactic that critics have denounced as an attempt to intimidate voting rights groups.

The Homeland Security Department declined to comment on ongoing investigations, but said it was focused on "actively rooting out and investigating election fraud wherever it can be found" and "ensuring that American citizens and only American citizens are electing American leaders."

NEW YORK TIMES

J. SCOTT APPLEWHITE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

MAKING HIS FEELINGS CLEAR — Bob Skylstadt of Boston carried an upside down American flag as a sign of distress as he joined other activists for a rally at the Capitol to demonstrate against President Trump on Wednesday.

$70,000 fee proposed for foreign students to work

WASHINGTON — The Department of Homeland Security on Wednesday proposed a $70,000 fee for international students seeking to work in the United States, the latest effort from the Trump administration to crack down on foreign enrollment.

A proposed rule would require schools to pay the fee for every student who participates in the optional practice training program, known as OPT, which allows students to work in jobs related to their major during or after their time in school. Students are generally eligible for one year of work post-graduation, though certain science, technology, engineering, and math majors are eligible for an additional two years.

Schools would be required to pay the $70,000 for each new student's initial application to the program, and a $30,000 fee for each renewal.

American colleges and universities heavily recruit students from overseas as a source of tuition revenue. Tech companies and other industries also hire many international students for technical roles.

The OPT program allows international students to gain hands-on experience and fill labor shortages in high-demand STEM fields, said Fanta Aw, chief executive of NAFSA, an association that represents international education.

"Driving away the talents, perspectives, and aspirations of international students will only hurt American innovation, economic growth, workforce development, and global leadership," Aw said in a written statement.

The public has 60 days to comment on the proposal before DHS can finalize it and put it into effect. The proposal also could face legal challenges from higher education groups or business associations that could delay it.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Investigator sues IRS claiming retaliation

WASHINGTON — An IRS investigator sued the agency this month, claiming officials illegally leaked his confidential personnel records to federal prosecutors to punish him for years of whistleblowing on the agency's failure to tackle tax dodging.

Brian J. Visalli, a 24-year IRS veteran, specializes in investigating complex offshore tax shelters. He has publicly criticized the agency, writing articles about its unwillingness to aggressively target schemes that multinational companies use to skirt their taxes. He contributed to two reports published by the Treasury Inspector General for Tax Administration: one on conflicts of interest within the IRS and the other on the agency's refusal to investigate advisers who design and sell aggressive tax strategies.

He says the IRS is using relatively small mistakes in his personal tax return to retaliate against him. The suit claims the IRS illegally disclosed his employee and tax information to Justice Department prosecutors to discredit and fire him. The lawsuit was filed in US District Court in the Northern District of Illinois. The IRS did not respond to a request for comment.

In the past year, Visalli has written articles in Tax Notes, a trade publication, criticizing the IRS's record on pursuing multinational tax dodgers.

Visalli's criticism of the IRS and the "abusive tax industry" have drawn attacks from right-wing groups.

NEW YORK TIMES

DNC sues over Trump ads paid for by taxpayers

WASHINGTON — The Democratic National Committee on Wednesday sued President Trump's administration for recent television advertisements that promoted his political message while costing taxpayers millions of dollars.

The complaint, filed in the US District Court for the District of Columbia, alleges that the ads are illegal government-sponsored propaganda and accuses Trump of personally directing them. It asks the court to declare the ads illegal and stop the use of federal funds to pay for them.

Trump has faced bipartisan backlash for the ads, which glorify him and echo his campaign pitch as voters cast early ballots with the midterm elections less than a month away.

The spots, which began airing in September, already have cost more than $12 million to run, according to the media tracking firm AdImpact, and a total of $20 million in Homeland Security Department funding has been tapped to pay for them.

Responding Monday to the criticism, Trump defended the ads as "positive promotion for our Great U.S.A." but said he'd pay for them using his MAGA Inc. super PAC going forward.

But on Tuesday, the fifth ad in the campaign began airing with the notice "paid for by the U.S. Government," promoting Trump's military actions in Venezuela earlier this year. The same day, Trump made it clear he hasn't committed to reimbursing any money that has already been spent, telling reporters "we'll decide."

ASSOCIATED PRESS

University of Ariz. suspends fraternity activities amid alleged misconduct

Reports involve nearly half of school's chapters

ASSOCIATED PRESS

TUCSON, Ariz. — The University of Arizona suspended activities at its fraternities following persistent reports of misconduct, including assault, hazing, and drug and alcohol-related behavior, a university official said.

Just seven weeks into the fall semester, the university's Dean of Students Office was investigating multiple misconduct reports involving nearly half the school's Interfraternity Council chapters, Dean Chrissy Lieberman said Monday in a letter to the school's fraternities and sororities announcing the suspension.

The reports follow misconduct findings against some interfraternity chapters in the spring and multiple criminal investigations, according to the letter.

University spokesperson Nick Prevenas did not say whether the suspension was triggered by recent public outcry over how Cornell University handled allegations that multiple fraternity brothers sexually assaulted a woman in 2024. Lieberman's letter noted that "the value of the Greek experience is under scrutiny nationwide."

"The number of cases under investigation and the severity of the concerns is egregious," Lieberman wrote.

Prevenas did not immediately respond to a request for more information about the criminal investigations on Wednesday.

Officer Frank Magos, a spokesperson for the Tucson Police Department, said he was unaware of recent cases involving fraternities that were investigated by the city's police agency.

The suspension prohibits fraternities from hosting, attending, participating in, and sponsoring any organizational activities at least until their advisers have met with Lieberman at one of three meetings that were scheduled for Tuesday, Wednesday, and Oct. 12, according to the letter.

ROSS D. FRANKLIN/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

The dean of the University of Arizona described the number and severity of the cases under investigation as "egregious."

The letter said the dean's office had reached "capacity" to investigate misconduct reports, and that reports continued even after the university's president warned Interfraternity Council presidents at an August meeting about the possibility of additional consequences.

"It is time for the University of Arizona Greek community to step up and set an example for good," the letter said. "It is time to have difficult conversations with each other and the members of the community."

The university had previously suspended activities at the Sigma Tau Gamma fraternity after new members last year were reportedly forced to consume large quantities of alcohol and live goldfish and were subjected to screaming, degradation, and threats, according to a Sept. 2 letter from a university official to the fraternity.

An email and phone message at the fraternity's national headquarters were not immediately returned. The AP also reached out to six other fraternity chapters at the University of Arizona's campus via social media seeking comment on the suspensions.

In Ithaca, N.Y., some Cornell students staged a sit-in at a dining hall and vowed not to spend money on campus Wednesday to protest sexual violence and how the university has handled complaints, in the latest expression of anger over an alleged 2024 gang rape at a fraternity house.

A sign reading "Justice for Jane Doe " — the name under which the accuser is suing — was propped on an empty table in the dining hall in the afternoon. Some students sat around the room without eating, while others lunched. Another group sat outside holding signs with messages such as "We are Jane Doe."

Groups organizing the demonstration intended to keep the sit-in going for seven hours.

The demonstrations were meant to spotlight complaints that the university is slow to respond to reports of sexual assault while quick to protect its reputation. Among other demands, the groups want the university to retool disciplinary procedures for addressing complaints and expel or revoke the degrees of anyone involved in the alleged October 2024 sexual assault.

Jane Doe, who was a student then, alleges that Chi Phi members plied her with alcohol and drugs and several sexually assaulted her. One man sent others a message inviting them to participate, according to a lawsuit she filed last month against Cornell, the fraternity, seven men who were Chi Phi brothers, and others.

Lawyers for two of the men have denied they participated in a sexual assault. Attempts to reach the others have been unsuccessful.

For a new courthouse, an eye-popping price

▶COURTHOUSE
Continued from Page A1

Still, roughly half a billion dollars is a lot for a 300,000-square-foot courthouse. It's more than twice the cost of a smaller courthouse in Lowell that opened in early 2020, and roughly double what the state's real estate arm estimated the Springfield project would cost just 18 months ago.

Rather than finance, build, and own the courthouse itself — the approach taken with most public buildings in Massachusetts — the Healey administration chose to use a private development team, with the state paying rent to operate in a courthouse on land it doesn't own.

The winning bidder, a team called Liberty Junction, includes a firm run by the husband of US Representative Ayanna Pressley and the interim head of the Massachusetts Convention Center Authority, and the Virginia firm, FD Stonewater, which is the lead developer on the project.

In its winning bid, Stonewater said it has "a stable of institutional and high-net-worth" investors to finance the construction. The state will pay back those upfront costs over the course of the lease, the bid states.

With this approach, state officials say, the courthouse will open five years faster than otherwise. By locking rents over the long term and reducing the risk of inflation, the first decade of the deal is expected to save taxpayers $154 million, Carrillo said.

"This project . . . will replace a sick building with a new, modern facility and bring thousands of jobs and economic activity to Springfield," said Karissa Hand, a spokesperson for Governor Maura Healey.

This type of deal is increasingly common as state governments get "more sophisticated in financing" and explore private development options instead of adding to their inventory of publicly owned buildings, said Anthony Flint, a Boston-based researcher who has studied major infrastructure projects and public-private partnerships.

"The days of a purely government-built public building may be over," Flint said.

The push to build a new Springfield courthouse was born out of lawsuits and complaints from court employees, who worried for their health and the integrity of the hulking structure. The state started the process to replace the facility in 2024, and the next year solicited proposals for a long-term deal.

Because a 40-year lease is atypical for a state project, the structure had to be approved by the state's Asset Management Board. In January 2025, the board approved the lease with one holdout vote: Inspector General Jeffrey Shapiro, who stressed skepticism of long-term leases. A spokesperson for Shapiro declined to comment further.

Liberty Junction's 266-page proposal centers around a vacant former medical office building that would become "a civic anchor for Springfield." Though relatively modest in size, the building requires a complex interior buildout. With special elevators for detainees and hallways accessible only by judges, juries, lawyers, and court staff, this courthouse is sort of like two separate buildings in one.

A project labor agreement signed last month estimated 2,000 union workers would build a 30-courtroom "justice center." Liberty Junction also envisions a future mixed-use development surrounding the courthouse property, with restaurants, housing, and opportunities for small businesses to anchor a neighborhood that had been decimated by urban renewal decades ago.

Still, as late as last year, DCAMM officials underestimated how expensive the project would be.

A March 2025 DCAMM briefing on the development, obtained by the Globe, estimated it could cost between $700 and $800 per square foot to build a new courthouse. A Globe analysis of the building's estimated construction cost and rentable square footage, based on the cost proposal outlined by Liberty Junction, shows the winning courthouse bid costing more than $1,500 per square foot to construct.

Of the proposals short-listed to win the state's Springfield contract, Liberty Junction had the second-highest construction cost. The three other finalists had each proposed a 40-year lease as required, and estimated construction at $409 million, $428 million, and $525.8 million, respectively.

The cost of building a government facility is 40 percent higher than in early 2020, federal data show. That escalation is evident when considering the Lowell Justice Center, a 263,000-square-foot, 17-courtroom facility that wrapped construction just before the COVID-19 pandemic. The Lowell project cost an estimated $184.9 million, or about $700 per square foot, to build, per a Globe analysis — less than half of the estimated construction cost for the 30-courtroom Springfield building.

Building materials such as steel and copper have more than doubled their pre-pandemic prices, while elements such as ornamental and architectural metalwork — decorative additions often seen in courthouses — have increased in price by nearly 125 percent, federal data show.

When public-private partnerships tackle complicated facility construction, it's important for governments to select developers with relevant experience, said Pam McKinney, an expert real estate consultant and principal of Byrne McKinney & Associates in Boston.

> The cost of building a government facility is 40 percent higher than in early 2020, federal data show.

"That's, in some ways, more important than just the numbers," McKinney said.

Hand, Healey's spokesperson, said Liberty Junction's winning bid "had the team with the strongest experience building courthouses."

The Liberty Junction architect, Leers Weinzapfel Associates, has designed eight federal, state, and county courthouses along the East Coast, the bid shows.

FD Stonewater has developed numerous federal, state, and local government facilities across the country, including multiple in Maine. However, beyond a brief mention of "redesigned courtrooms" at its $150 million US Drug Enforcement Administration headquarters redevelopment in Virginia, the team's winning bid did not identify any specific courthouse experience.

Liberty Junction contractor Suffolk Construction has built a juvenile justice courthouse in Florida and renovated two courthouses in Boston, though the bid does not mention those projects. It instead touts Suffolk's "strong ties to the region's subcontractor network" and "several employees living locally."

The other firm involved is Co-Jo Real Estate, which is led by Conan Harris, Pressley's husband, and John Barros, the interim head of the Massachusetts Convention Center Authority.

Individually, the pair have developed smaller-scale residential homes, but, as a team, have not developed large-scale commercial property. After an uproar about his involvement, Barros, also Boston's former economic development czar, said he will divest from the company.

On a recent fall afternoon at the site of the proposed project in Springfield's North End, it was hard to imagine a state-of-the-art courthouse or the promised vibrant, mixed-use space to come. Trash blew around the concrete like urban tumbleweeds. Pedestrians used the barren parking lot as a cut-through.

But the rendering of a brand-new courthouse with its gleaming windows and tree-lined corridors instills hope of reinvigorating the neighborhood, said Bud Williams, a five-term state representative who grew up here.

Stopping the project, or putting it out for a new bid at this stage, would only prolong the wait for what would be "a breath of fresh air" for the community, Williams said.

"The train has left the station," he said, as a freight train rumbled across the nearby railroad tracks. "When the train leaves, it's out."

Two losing bidders have sued to overturn the project, citing conflict-of-interest issues with Barros's presence on the winning team as well as questions about the property where the new courthouse would be built. The losing bidders unsuccessfully petitioned a judge to stop it for now, but their lawsuit is still ongoing.

The team has also launched a six-figure ad campaign urging Healey to stop the process. But the governor's spokesperson dismisses their complaints.

"No amount of money spent on misleading ads by frustrated losing bidders can change the fact that their proposals would have cost taxpayers $400 million more at a site that's within a few minutes' walk of the winning site that they are now criticizing," Hand said.

Back in the old courthouse, not far from the billboards paid for by losing bidders calling the Liberty Junction project a "bad choice," a large water spot spreads across a ceiling tile above Gentile's desk. For her, and the many who ask her to speak on their behalf, the Liberty Junction proposal is unsatisfying in every way: functionality, design, and location.

"I'd have more respect for this process if they came out here and said: 'Western Mass., you know how you've always said Boston doesn't give a [expletive] about you? You're right,' " said Gentile, Hampden County's elected clerk of courts. "That's the way people out here feel."

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ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

State Representative Bud Williams, shown at the Liberty Junction site, said, "The train has left the station," on the project.

Common for Bermudians to come to Boston for health care

▶BERMUDA
Continued from Page A1

cal jet carrying a patient and a family member went missing off the coast of Nantucket. Much about the flight, including what caused it to go down and which hospital it was bound for, remains unknown. A Mass General Brigham spokesperson said the patient wasn't heading for its hospitals.

Home to some of the premier hospitals in the United States, Boston has long been an attractive option for people who need specialized care that isn't always available in the islands. Of the top five hospitals used most frequently by people from Bermuda, four are in Boston: Boston Children's Hospital, Brigham and Women's, Dana-Farber Cancer Institute, and Lahey Clinic Hospital in Burlington, according to the Bermuda Health Council.

It's an easy enough trip, less than two hours one-way. Commercial flights to Boston run daily, and air ambulances are readily available for more severely ill patients.

Similar to other small island communities, comprehensive medical services, particularly for more complicated conditions, aren't readily available in Bermuda, said Dr. David Martin, medical director of Mass General Brigham International.

With a total land area of about 20 square miles, the small British territory is home to about 65,000 people — roughly the capacity of Gillette Stadium.

"It's not justifiable for a small population island like that to have cardiac surgery or brain surgery or complex cancer surgery," Martin said. "These are things that generally are not in such high demand that a small population could sustain that expertise."

There are few details about the circumstances of the crash. Some debris from the plane has been found, but authorities have suspended the search for survivors.

In Bermuda, Sharon Symonds, 68, said she knew the two on the missing medical transport flight but said the incident was unlikely to deter her or others from seeking care in Boston.

Symonds had cochlear implant surgery in both her ears and said her local ear, nose, and throat doctor recommended she have the operation at Mass Eye and Ear.

"They wouldn't have offered this care in Bermuda," she said.

As a government employee, Symonds, now retired, said her insurance covered her flights and the procedures and provided her with a small stipend for a hotel in Boston.

Usually, island residents make the trip to receive care at a hospital, according to the Bermuda Health Council report, which analyzed claims data from fiscal year 2022. But patients also traveled for lab and pharmacy services, to see physicians and specialists, and to receive vision and optometry care. The most common conditions related to overseas care included kidney failure, hypertension, heart conditions, cancer treatment, and fibroids, according to the report.

Formal health care partnerships between Bermuda and Boston go back at least 30 years, when Ewart Brown, a doctor who would go on to serve as Bermuda's premier, established a relationship with the Lahey Clinic.

That relationship came under scrutiny in 2017 when the government of Bermuda sued Lahey, accusing the hospital of bribing Brown, who served as premier from 2006 to 2010, to secure health care business there. Lahey denied the allegations and the suit was later dismissed. In 2021, Brown was charged by local prosecutors with corruption related to the arrangement.

"We respect the court's decision to dismiss the lawsuit several years ago," said Sarah Finlaw, a spokesperson for Beth Israel Lahey Health. Finlaw noted that the lawsuit came prior to the formation of the current version of the Lahey system.

Lahey and its physicians continue to serve the islanders who travel to Massachusetts for emergency and outpatient care. Lahey physicians also visit Bermuda to provide specialty care related to vascular surgery, endocrinology, ophthalmology, neurology, and allergy and immunology.

Other major hospital systems and clinics in Massachusetts, including MGB and Dana-Farber, similarly receive many Bermudian patients.

Last year, MGB had about 4,500 to 5,000 patients come from around the world, Martin said. Bermuda referred the most people for care, he said.

When Glasford went back to MGB last year to receive high-dose radiation therapy, which is not available in Bermuda, he recalled seeing other Bermudians at the hospital. A nurse, he said, recognized where he was from based on his accent.

If he needs specialized care again, Glasford said he would return to MGB "in a heartbeat."

"The level of care was high," he said.

Bermudians seeking health care mostly take commercial flights. Fewer patients use air ambulances like the one that disappeared last week, according to a health council report covering 2018 to 2023.

From April 2022 to March 2023, there were 125 insurance claims across all age groups for medical transport flights totaling more than $3 million. Most claims were filed for people over 65 years old.

Johnette McNeil, a Bermuda real estate broker who knew the patient and family member on the flight that vanished, said the incident has stunned the local community, where air ambulance usage is relatively common, but accidents are extremely rare.

"People have been getting air ambulances ... for decades," McNeil said. "There's never been any issues, I believe."

Jonathan Saltzman and Jeremiah Manion of the Globe staff and Globe correspondent Bryan Hecht contributed to this report. Allyson Chiu can be reached at allyson.chiu@globe.com.

JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Coast Guard members in Boston on Sunday. The health care connection between Bermuda and the city came into focus after a medical jet went missing off the coast of Nantucket.

Opinion

BOSTONGLOBE.COM/OPINION

EDITORIAL

Brigham managers and nurses must keep negotiating

Here's an idea: Put Mass General Brigham president and CEO Anne Klibanski and her underlings in a Brigham and Women's hospital room with Massachusetts Nurses Association president Katie Murphy and her leaders. Send up some cafeteria food and lock the door for a day. When they finally start talking to each other, instead of around each other, let them adjourn to the luxury of a conference room to continue negotiations on a new contract.

While the potential impending open-ended strike of approximately 4,000 nurses at Brigham and Women's Hospital is no laughing matter, perhaps the most disheartening thing about the situation is that at least until now, the nurses union and hospital management haven't worked harder to avoid one. In fact, the two sides haven't met since August 11, officials from both the union and hospital told the editorial board, although a mediator has been talking to both sides. Both sides blame each other for the stalemate, and they appear to remain far apart on numerous issues related to wages, health insurance, and working conditions.

The first sign of progress came Wednesday when the hospital said a bargaining session was scheduled for Thursday, where the union is expected to present a new proposal.

The nurses union has a right to strike to try to influence contract negotiations. But a strike should be a last resort. A strike poses potential danger to the quality of patient care, since the traveling nurses who would be hired by the hospital to replace striking nurses will be less familiar with the institution and its patients. It could increase health care spending by forcing the hospital to pay more for replacement nurses, a cost ultimately borne by consumers through higher prices. And it could harm nurses and their families, who would forgo salary and benefits for the duration of a strike.

When they meet Thursday, the hospital and union should make every effort to reach an agreement to defer the strike, now scheduled for Oct. 14, while they continue negotiating.

The biggest gap appears to be on wages. Nurses at Brigham and Women's are among the top-paid nurses not just in Boston but nationally, according to Brigham officials — perhaps justifiably, since it's one of the nation's top teaching hospitals that serves patients with complex needs. A starting nurse earns $86,700 a year, and nurses get a 5 percent step increase each year for their first two decades of work. Around one-third of nurses have at least 20 years of experience and earn the top of the pay scale, which is $220,000 for a staff nurse and higher for other advanced practitioners.

For the upcoming contract, Mass General Brigham is offering to raise salaries for nurses at the top of the wage scale by 2.5 percent but provide no additional raises beyond the 5 percent step increases to those lower on the wage scale.

The nurses are seeking a 3 percent cost of living increase for all nurses in the first year of the contract and a 4 percent increase the second year, in addition to the step increases. The hospital says this would raise its total nursing budget by $90 million annually, plus $11 million in one-time ratification bonuses.

The nurses justify their request by citing inflation, arguing that the cost of living has increased, particularly around Boston. Kelly Morgan, who chairs the Massachusetts Nurses Association bargaining committee, told the editorial board that between the increased cost of living and an additional hospital proposal that employees pay a larger proportion of their health insurance premiums, nurses could end up effectively taking home less money next year than this year. "We want people to take home today's wages, not lose money," Morgan said.

CHRISTIAN KANTOSKY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Nurses walked and chanted during the first day of the nurse's strike outside Brigham and Women's Hospital in Boston on Wednesday, July 8.

But hospital officials told the editorial board that compensation — for all positions — is set based on the market. Nurses are earning 55 percent more than they did five years ago because for several years, the hospital needed to raise wages significantly to attract and retain nurses. Now there are few vacancies and low turnover rates, suggesting wages are in line with the market. Additionally, the hospital is facing its own financial pressures, with rising costs and an operating margin that's effectively break-even.

In addition to the wage issue, nurses are seeking greater choice in health insurance plans. They also want limits on the hospital's use of temporary nurses, restrictions on on-call hours, and higher pay for nurses who float between units, on-call nurses, and per-diem nurses, among other proposals.

The nurses already held a one-day strike July 8, and the hospital only let them return July 13 because it had to sign a five-day contract with replacement nurses. An open-ended strike would be far more disruptive.

When Tufts Medical Center nurses went on strike for a day in 2017, it was the area's first nursing strike in 30 years.

Since then, nurses at Saint Vincent Hospital in Worcester went on strike in 2021 for an unprecedented 301 days. Last month, nurses at Boston Medical Center authorized a three-day strike, although a date has not yet been set. Earlier this year, nurses at Baystate Franklin Medical Center and UMass Memorial Medical Center separately threatened 14-day strikes before reaching deals to avert them.

The growing reliance on strikes as a negotiation tactic scares patients — and potential patients — needlessly. The hospital and nurses should return to negotiations and seek a contract agreement that makes one unnecessary.

KIMBERLY ATKINS STOHR

Why Alito's future on the bench matters

Justice Samuel Alito is not retiring any time soon.

But the fact that the topic of if and when the 76-year-old Supreme Court jurist may hang up his robe keeps grabbing headlines says a lot about him, the court, public perception, and the state of American democracy.

This past week, Alito sat down with various media outlets to promote his latest book, "So Ordered." But the question interviewers like CBS News's Jan Crawford really wanted to know was whether his tenure would soon come to an end.

"I thought about it, and I will continue," Alito said, causing Crawford to interrupt.

"You did? You considered it?" Crawford asked.

"Well, it's something I think that somebody at my age has to think about every term," Alito replied, matter-of-factly. "But I thought that I could still make a valuable contribution, which is why I became a justice and a judge in the first place. So that was basically it."

Or so he may have thought. An excerpt of the interview, which aired Friday night, caused a flurry of weekend headlines, including this screamer from Politico based on the CBS interview: "Justice Alito confirms he is considering retirement."

That headline was misleading at best. At worst, it was clickbait meant to capitalize on high court palace intrigue.

One would have thought news organizations would have learned a lesson from NPR's longtime Supreme Court reporter Nina Totenberg back in June, when she misheard a bystander about retirement announcements and in a rush to beat other organizations with the news put out an erroneous story that Alito was stepping down. The story was quickly retracted, and Totenberg reached out to Alito to apologize. It was not NPR's best moment.

Later, Alito would tell USA Today in a statement that he was "amused and puzzled" by the mishap.

"I wondered what had led to the erroneous report," Alito said. "And when the error was corrected, I wondered how many people were crest-fallen."

The episode demonstrates the bated breath with which even well-respected news outlets await word of another potential high court confirmation battle, particularly now when midterm polling shows Democrats with a fighting chance to take control of the Senate, and with it the Supreme Court confirmation apparatus. A headline that read: "Alito will stay put regardless of midterm election results" wouldn't be as catchy, its accuracy notwithstanding.

In an interview with Bloomberg News's Greg Stohr, Alito was clear. (Full disclosure: Stohr is my husband.)

"I intend to stick around through this term," Alito told Stohr of the court's term that began this week and runs through June. "I made that decision many months ago."

Who is "crest-fallen" by that news, to use Alito's words? The better question may be: Who isn't?

Alito sits firmly within the court's 6-3 conservative supermajority, whose rulings have sent the court's approval ratings plummeting to a near record low of 34 percent, according to Gallup. In fact, it was in 2022, after the opinion Alito wrote overturning Roe v. Wade and the right to abortion access it protected, that the court's favorability dropped below 50 percent for the first time.

For Americans on the left, that displeasure has been compounded by a slew of decisions, many issued on an expedited basis on the court's shadow docket, in the Trump administration's favor, including the recent ruling allowing the administration to resume the cruel practice of removing immigrants to countries they have no connection to.

Add the court's destruction of the Voting Rights Act and erosion of civil rights and due process protections for LGBTQ people and immigrants. On top of all that, the court has granted the president both expanded powers and immunity from prosecution for crimes committed while in office. No doubt, few tears would be shed on the left if Alito decided to leave his post. If midterm polling is a sign of an impending referendum against Republicans, surely the justices in the court's GOP-appointed majority must feel it.

> I'm certain many Republicans hoped Alito would retire before Democrats get hold of the Senate gavel in January, which would have given Trump the opportunity to secure a fourth appointment to the court, helping it to stay conservative for at least a generation.

On the right, folks are clearly reading the political trade winds. Polls suggest that the midterms will result in at least a blue ripple that flips control of the house, or a blue tsunami that washes over the Senate as well. With Democrats in charge of the powerful Senate Judiciary Committee, any new Trump high court nominee would face a hill far too high to easily scale.

I'm certain many Republicans hoped Alito would retire before Democrats get hold of the Senate gavel in January, which would have given Trump the opportunity to secure a fourth appointment to the court, helping it to stay conservative for at least a generation. That Alito and Justice Clarence Thomas, the court's most senior associate justice, chose to stay put has ruffled more than a few conservative feathers.

But the biggest reason everyone seems obsessed over Alito's future is the very reason he's likely staying put: He is one of the most powerful people in America and a part of one of its most powerful institutions. Changes to the court's makeup can feel as consequential as elections — perhaps more so because the lifetime tenure of justices makes those shifts so rare. It makes perfect sense to be concerned with when justices choose to end their careers. It's the kind of palace intrigue that none of us can afford to look away from.

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REBA SALDANHA/AP

Seth Moulton took responsibility for losing the primary, but ducked questions about why.

JOAN VENNOCHI

What Seth Moulton's loss says about the Democratic Party

When our podcast producer asked Representative Seth Moulton what he had for breakfast during the sound check for a recent "Say More" episode, he quickly answered, "Power bar and a protein shake." When I asked what I considered a fun question — whether Red Sox manager Chad Tracy pulled his starting pitcher too soon during the first Wild Card game against the Yankees, which had taken place the previous night — he declined to comment.

That, in the proverbial nutshell, is where Moulton seems to be right now — extremely disciplined and determined not to shoot from the hip and reveal too much, after a crushing primary loss to Senator Ed Markey in September. Who can blame him? As Colette Phillips, a Moulton supporter and head of a marketing and communications firm, told me via email, "defeat can be difficult. So, I would cut him some slack. He's still being reflective of why the Democrats would vote to send an 80-year-old back to Congress."

On one hand, the explanation is pretty simple and the rejection it represents must feel very personal. In an election that now seems like ancient political history, voters chose Markey, a warm and familiar octogenarian who checked all the right progressive boxes over Moulton, an edgy Gen X-er and political outsider who was essentially dead to progressive Democrats after he said he didn't want his young daughters "getting run over on a playing field by a male or formerly male athlete."

Yet there's a larger and more complicated context to Moulton's defeat, which has meaning for future Democratic candidates. They must contend with the power of incumbency and the status quo, the clubbiness of the Democratic establishment, and the absolute adherence to liberal doctrine on climate, health care, and transgender rights that progressives demand from their candidates. In Massachusetts, woke is not over, as evidenced by the recent saga of the Last Ditch Bar in Greenfield — and in its own way, by the Markey-Moulton race.

Someday, after he finishes processing this electoral loss, I hope Moulton will be up for a deeper analysis of those larger issues. For now, here are some takeaways from his recent interview with Globe Opinion editor Jim Dao and me about the race he lost:

■ He took responsibility for losing, but ducked questions about why.

Asked what went wrong with the campaign, he said he "failed to make the case" for generational change — but he wasn't specific about how. Asked how much he was hurt by his comment about transgender athletes, he said Markey effectively used it against him, "but I stand by the premise, which was that we have to be able to take on these tough conversations."

■ He defended his effort to link Markey to convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein and wouldn't admit that it bombed as a tactic.

Asked if he regretted it, he said, "It's a fair line of inquiry because [Markey] is in the files. Why shouldn't we just ask the question, right? … We can't be so afraid in our politics, have no courage whatsoever to raise questions … [or] to have challenging debates." However, Markey denied any link at all to Epstein, and the details put out about it by the Moulton campaign were murky at best.

■ On the woke front, Moulton rejected the idea that he tried to convince progressives he was one of them by repeatedly telling voters there were no differences between him and Markey.

"What I said is that there are no major differences on policy, right? There are a lot of differences in approach," he said. As examples, he cited his lack of support for Senator Chuck Schumer of New York as minority leader and his campaigning for fellow veterans in races across the state.

But those aren't the issues that progressives fault him on. While it is being, as he said, "a Monday morning quarterback" to suggest he could have made a stronger case for more centrist positions, that choice is exactly what Democrats will be facing in the next presidential election cycle.

Ideologically, where will Democrats end up in a national campaign? And who will be their standard-bearer? Someone new, or someone from its more conventional ranks?

Massachusetts is a microcosm of that challenge. "The party's all about structure, seniority, and waiting your turn," Doug Rubin, an adviser to the Moulton campaign, told me in an interview. "That's part of the problem. There are not enough people willing to challenge the status quo and the structure of the party." While that certainly sounds like it's coming from someone on the losing side of a campaign, there's truth to what Rubin said.

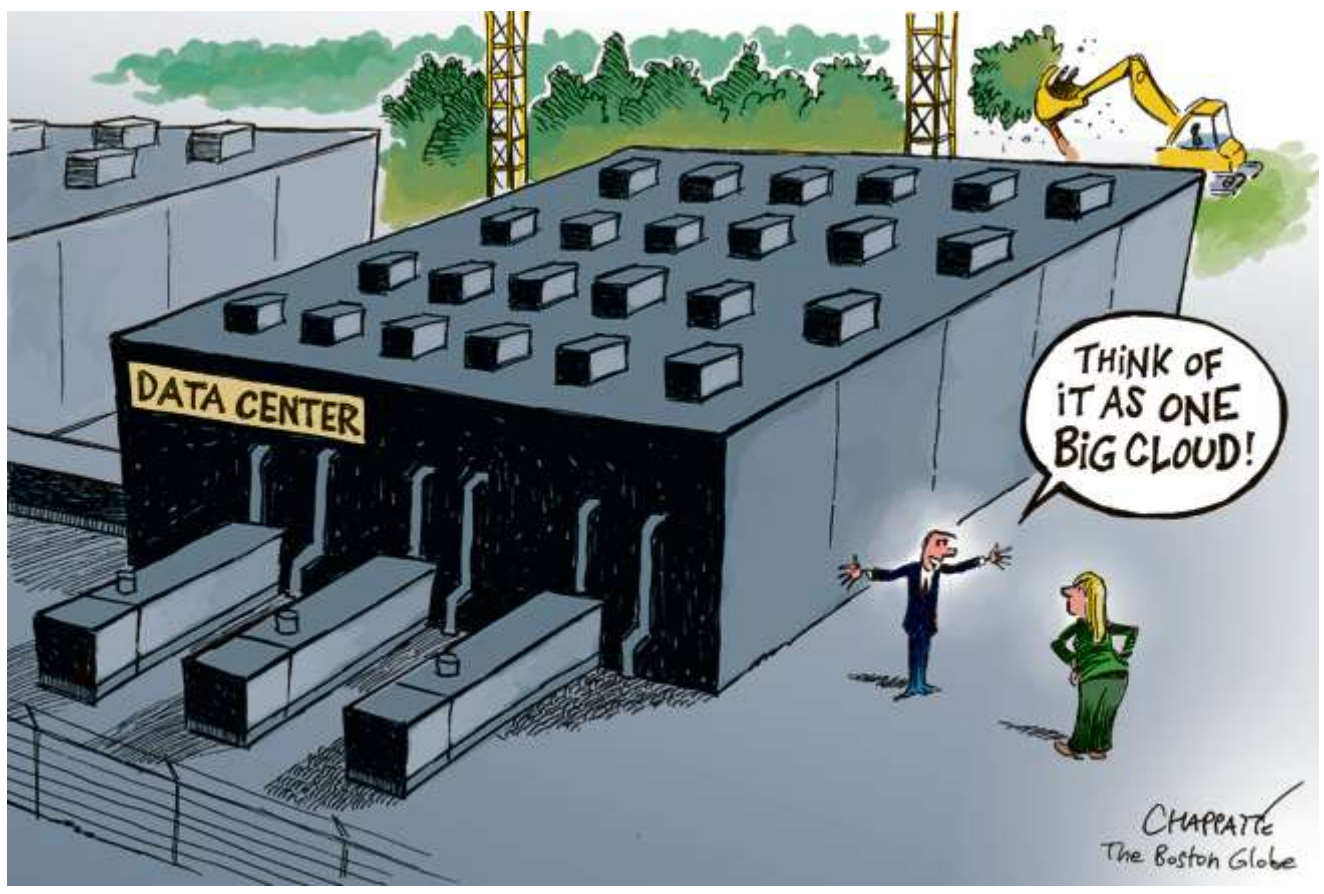
From her perspective as a Moulton supporter, Phillips also noted that the party "needs to be able to have honest, sometimes uncomfortable conversations about where it's going and whom it hopes to bring along."

Will Moulton be part of that conversation? He said he hasn't ruled out another run for elected office.

But to do it, he would have to carve out a place in a party that in this moment did not see him as the face or voice of generational change. Unless the politics around here change a great deal, that won't be easy.

Joan Vennochi is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at joan.vennochi@globe.com. Follow her @joan_vennochi.

PATRICK CHAPPATTE



INBOX

Don't fall for Trump's voucher scheme, Governor Healey

There's no guarantee that students in need would reap benefits

We are appalled that the Globe is recommending that Governor Maura Healey buy into President Trump's tax-credit school voucher scheme ("Take the money, Healey," Editorial, Oct. 2). The editorial board rightly points out the funding struggles facing our public schools. It also makes note of the bureaucratic hurdles a school district would need to clear to get any benefit from this ruse. Yet what the Globe is tacitly endorsing is a long-running right-wing attack on public education that has found an ally in Trump, who has been systematically dismantling public education since his return to office.

> The tax-credit scheme is simply a fresh way to create vouchers that divert public money to private schools.

The Globe's instructions to districts to set up and operate scholarship granting organizations that can accept donations is akin to suggesting that schools mass produce bake sales to fund education. The tax-credit scheme is simply a fresh way to create vouchers that divert public money to private schools, with no guarantee that students in need reap any benefit. We believe that public money belongs in the service of students attending public schools and that our state must ensure that students have access to the staff and resources they need to succeed.

If Healey needs to use a bully pulpit, as the editorial suggests, it should be for admonishing the federal government's ongoing undermining of public education.

MATT BACH
President
DEB GESUALDO
Vice president
Massachusetts Teachers Association
Quincy

Siphoning public money off for private schools would widen gaps

The Boston Globe acknowledges that the Federal Scholarship Tax Credit is a "backdoor voucher program that lets public money subsidize private school tuition," but it paints a misleadingly rosy picture of what it would do for Massachusetts students ("Take the money, Healey").

There is no mechanism to "ensure that as much of the money as possible is directed to public schools." Governor Maura Healey has no control over which students or schools are prioritized — the regulations released expressly prohibit it.

Siphoning public money off for private schools, which are exempt from teacher licensure, curriculum standards, and the benchmarks required of our public schools, would harm communities with the greatest needs, including Gateway Cities and rural areas without private schools.

The Globe notes that "only a handful" of states with Democratic governors have opted in but does not mention that it was despite their vetoes in several of those states.

In Massachusetts, publicly subsidizing private schools that pick and choose who they educate violates our state constitution. Moreover, it would widen persistent opportunity gaps.

To protect the education of all students, Healey must opt out.

JESSICA TANG
President
American Federation of Teachers Massachusetts
Boston

What Trump is promising sounds too good to be true

The last thing Massachusetts public school students need in this time of severe fiscal crisis is for Governor Maura Healey to opt into a disastrous, deeply misleading federal voucher scheme. It's true, as the Globe says in its editorial, that public schools are "struggling with teacher layoffs and program cuts," but the Federal Scholarship Tax Credit would almost certainly make these problems worse.

The regulations released last week confirm the suspicions of many public education advocates that the federal voucher program is designed to divert public funds to private education uses. For example, the regulations would actually bar states from requiring the groups that provide the vouchers, known as scholarship granting organizations, to give them to public school students or to low-income students.

So even if Healey wanted to ensure that these funds are equitably distributed to the students with the greatest needs, she could not do so.

This is clearly an example of the old adage that if it sounds too good to be true, it probably is — especially coming from a federal administration that has demonstrated over and over again its desire to reduce funding for public education and target vulnerable student populations.

LISA GUISBOND
Executive director
Citizens for Public Schools
Brookline

Trump wants voters to pretend he's on the ballot. Ah, but he is.

President Trump is flying around the country telling his voters to close their eyes and pretend he's on the ballot for the midterms ("Trump puts on show for crowd that's already sold," Page A7, Oct. 3). Many Democrats and independents have a knee-jerk negative reaction to all of his ideas, but I say we can find common ground on this one. In every election, from Oklahoma to Maine, from Idaho to Michigan, from the heartland to the city, and in every race, from US senator to tax collector, from attorney general to agricultural commissioner, let us unite and honor the president's wishes by closing our eyes and pretending he's on the ballot.

ANDREW GOLDSTEIN
Concord

'This is one of the proudest things we do as a police department.'

SERGEANT RYAN CALTER, *an 18-year veteran of the Kingston force*

Fighting addiction with compassion, not judgment

▶**ADDICTION**
Continued from Page A1

than a criminal one.

Such an intervention literally changed Daniel Wood's life, another recovering opioid user, who recalled the day when people from the outreach program showed up on his doorstep out of the blue.

"I didn't know any of these people," Wood said of the visit, which occurred a few days after an overdose. "I wanted to stop using, and they pointed me in the right direction. They wanted me to get clean, but they weren't forcing me."

Sober for months, Wood now regularly visits the Kingston drop-in center of Plymouth County Outreach. If not for the intervention, he said, "I'd still be using or dead. I thought I'd be using for the rest of my life."

Woods is one less grim statistic. Last year, Massachusetts recorded 978 confirmed and suspected opioid-related overdose deaths, according to the state Department of Public Health. Although that's nearly a 60 percent decline since a record high of 2,364 deaths in 2022, "we're still saving lives every day," said John Rosenthal, a real estate developer and community activist who cofounded PAARI in 2015.

A decade ago, Rosenthal said, "if you had an illness below the neck, you were treated with respect. But if you had an illness above the neck, you were shamed, blamed, and sent back to the street to die."

BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

From left, Vicky Butler, director of Plymouth County Outreach, Daniel Wood, who is in opioid recovery, and Kayla Phillipo, recovery coach.

PAARI collaborates with 800 police departments in 47 states, according to Zoe Grover, its executive director. Tens of thousands of people have been placed in treatment. And more than 17,000 free doses of naloxone, an overdose-reversing drug marketed as Narcan, have been distributed to police departments, first responders, construction workers, and others.

Free training also has been provided to more than 4,300 public safety and public health professionals nationwide, Grover said.

PAARI's coast-to-coast profile emerged from its beginnings in Gloucester, where former police chief Leonard Campanello launched the Angel Program in 2015 to address a scourge of escalating drug use in that historic fishing port.

Under the program, which soon morphed into PAARI with Rosenthal's help, anyone could walk into the police station—with drugs or without, under the influence or not — and ask to be connected to treatment.

And help, Campanello recalled, was provided "on the spot."

The effort involved "arranging transportation, dealing with health agencies and insurance companies, and detox and rehabilitation facilities. It was a monumental amount of work," he said.

But it paid dividends. In its first year in Gloucester, 600 people showed up at the police station seeking treatment for substance abuse.

"It was crazy to say to the world: If you're addicted to illegal drugs, we don't care. We will get you treatment," said Rosenthal, who also has been an outspoken advocate against gun violence and homelessness.

Now, half of the the 351 cities and towns in the state are involved with PAARI, and the initiative has made deep inroads elsewhere in New England.

In Watertown, Conn., the entire police department has received PAARI certification to assist and communicate with people affected by addiction.

And in Somersworth, N.H., a police officer trained by PAARI devotes nearly his entire work week to help the vulnerable. They include four people with varying disabilities who live out their days crammed among a crush of soiled belongings in a battered car with barely any gas.

One of them, Michael, steps from the car and ticks off their worries: homeless, penniless, plagued by cockroaches, and unsure what tomorrow holds. But Somersworth police check on them regularly, notify them of a warming shelter, and ask what else they need.

"They genuinely care here," Michael said.

Today, heroin no longer is a leading cause of overdose deaths. Instead, many fatalities can be traced to drugs such as cocaine, stimulants, and opioid pain relievers that have been laced with fentanyl, a synthetic opioid that can be 100 times more powerful than morphine.

"The work never ends," said Butler, whose network collaborates with 28 public safety departments in Plymouth County and dozens of community organizations and treatment providers.

Part of that journey brought Butler to the small home in Kingston. The overdose victim would not come to the door, but his grandmother patiently listened to Butler and Calter.

Maybe the young man will seek help; maybe he won't, Calter said. But at a minimum, they had notched one more possible connection.

"This is one of the proudest things we do as a police department," said Calter, an 18-year veteran of the force.

Butler said the Plymouth County outreach team had made 175 visits in 2025 to overdose victims, usually within 72 hours of the emergency. Plainclothes police officers, similar to the Kingston visit, often accompany the outreach workers.

The team includes representatives from the schools, police, and the district attorney's office, among others. They meet regularly to discuss new cases, plan follow-up, and update a countywide database of at-risk people. In the past, those people might have fallen through the cracks.

"There have been a ton of situations that we've been able to help," Butler said. "When we can make an impact, when we can make someone feel valued and loved, that's what keeps me going."

It's an approach that PAARI has championed since its inception, and the effect has been game-changing, said Frederick Ryan, a former Arlington police chief and one of its earliest proponents.

Previously, "the only tool on a police officer's belt to deal with addiction in a community was handcuffs," Ryan said. "In a post-PAARI world, police officers have Narcan, access to mental-health clinicians on call and available to respond, and an improved health-care system."

The news is buoying: Fatal overdoses are declining, more police know of the complexities of addiction, and public empathy seems on the rise.

Still, according to those in the fight, falling overdose numbers do not equate to triumph.

"I'm an activist, and in order to be an activist, you have to be an optimist and a restless malcontent," said Rosenthal, whose nephew died of a fentanyl overdose in 2016. "I'm super-proud, but I'm still super-frustrated."

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Despite vows, some gamblers cross Encore casino picket line

▶**ENCORE**
Continued from Page A1

heard all the way up to the entrance where people call rideshares and board shuttle buses to and from Boston's South Station.

Inside the resort, the lobby was hushed, a pungent fragrance wafting through the room. Rising from the gaming floor was the familiar sound of slot machines, the hum of hundreds of voices crowded around the table games, and the sportsbook TV broadcasts in the background.

Encore, operated by Las Vegas-based Wynn Resorts, resumed negotiations with the Teamsters and UNITE HERE Local 26, the union representing the majority of workers on strike, on Sept. 26. The parties also came to the bargaining table multiple times last week. While the casino described the conversations as more productive than previous meetings before the strike began, Local 26 president Carlos Aramayo said the sides remain far apart on the unions' key issues: wages, health benefits, and job security.

It's not clear how Encore is making up for its lost labor, with more than a third of its staff on strike. An Encore spokesperson wrote that the casino resort had "prepared for every possibility and put plans in place" before the strike began.

Aramayo wrote in a statement that the workers "are what make Encore five-star." And, he wrote of gamblers crossing the picket line, "Every dime you spend there keeps the workers on the street a little longer."

With no end in sight to the strike, it's possible Boston-area gamblers will make longer treks to other Massachusetts casinos, or across state lines.

Even so, a steady stream of cars flowed through Encore on a few recent visits since the strike began. And crossing the picket line means driving past the workers; patrons don't have to confront them walking into the casino, said Bill Werner, a hospitality labor relations specialist and professor at the University of Nevada Las Vegas. He suspects most people driving to Encore would pass through the picket line, and few would actually turn around because of it.

"There are people who won't cross the picket line," Werner said, "but not so much that it destroys the business."

The opinions from Encore's patrons seem to vary.

The "Low Rollers of Encore," a 9,700-member, private Facebook group, polled members in August on whether they'd still come to the casino if there was a strike. Of the 202 people who participated in the poll, 41 voted in favor of going or potentially going; 161 voted against it.

JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Encore Boston Casino workers marched last month. A steady stream of cars flowed through the area during a few recent visits as the strike continued.

Even on Encore's Facebook page, comments are mixed under a post boasting more than $1.5 million in jackpots from a recent weekend night.

"Wish I could come over but there is a picket line," the most liked comment on the post reads. "Negotiate with your workers."

"Low Rollers" member Gina Avellani is one of many who vowed not to cross the picket line. She said she normally goes to the casino once or twice a week with her aunt to gamble and eat at Fratelli, one of a few higher-end restaurants on the gaming floor that has remained open through the strike.

"People don't look at the whole picture. They go, 'Oh, I'm going to go gamble,' " Avellani said. "It doesn't sit well with me."

Avellani has a membership card at Encore and said the casino increased her free play by $20 for October. It's a typical move, Werner said. Casinos try to offer players incentives, like rewards and promotions, to draw them back in, especially if traffic is down.

"How much more would they have to offer you before you cross the picket line?" Werner said. "There's a breaking point for people."

Avellani said she doesn't feel the need to go back until the strike is resolved. Her aunt takes a different view and is still at the casino every week, she said.

Boston resident Rich West has been to the casino three times since the strike began, but said his interest has been "significantly curtailed" by the picketers. He typically calls a ride-share driver to get to Encore from the North End. One of his drivers honked his horn in support of the workers as they entered the casino driveway. But the one who drove him home told West he thought the workers should get back to their jobs.

West, who mentioned that he comes from a union family, said he's spoken to several workers on the picket line before entering the casino and feels "a huge amount of empathy" for them. At the same time, once inside, he said, "I find no stress going to play a slot machine."

West said he's never been a regular at any other casino. "I don't know anything else other than Encore," he said.

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PERFECTING THE PUMPKIN PITCH

JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Workers at Verrill Farm in Concord tossed large pumpkins as they gathered and arranged them closer together so they can cover them with a large tarp to ward against a possible overnight frost. A record-setting grower looks back on his work. **B3.**

DEBATES

Healey, Minogue to face off in their first meeting

By Chris Van Buskirk and Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey and her Republican challenger, former Abiomed executive Michael Minogue, will face off in their first televised debate on WBZ-TV on Thursday. The matchup, the first of two scheduled debates in the span of one week, comes as some voters already have their general election mail-in ballots in hand ahead of the Nov. 3 election.

Here's what to watch for when Healey and Minogue take the stage in Brighton:

Pump politics

As voters feel the pinch of rising gas prices, both Healey and Minogue have pitched relief plans in the final stretch ahead of Election Day.

Last month, Healey proposed a two-month moratorium on the state's 24-cents-a-gallon tax on gas and diesel, announcing her plan just days after Minogue called for a broader "gas tax holiday" whenever prices top $4 a gallon. (A gallon of regular unleaded costs on average $4.34 as of Wednesday, per AAA.)

Both ideas were immediately met with resistance in the Legislature, which would have to approve any change. But it also opened Healey up to shots from Republicans that she was cribbing from Minogue's idea. As recently as March, Healey shot down the idea of suspending the tax, telling WBZ she didn't think it was "going to get us very far right now."

"An incumbent copying a challenger, by flip-flopping on her own stances, is a sign of desperation," said Amy Carnevale, chair of the Massachusetts Republican Party.

Trump card

President Trump has defined much of Healey's campaign pitch, in which she's cast herself as playing necessary defense against the Republican administration and Minogue as a faithful Trump supporter. The state Democratic Party paid for one ad this summer that dubbed the GOP nominee "MAGA Mike," a reference to Trump's Make America Great Again movement and Minogue's past support of the president, who remains deeply unpopular among the wider Massachusetts electorate.

But Minogue has at times sought to distance himself from Trump and focused his efforts on convincing unenrolled voters in the state to back him. In interviews, Minogue has repeatedly said he

GOVERNOR, Page B4

Three takeaways from Collins-Jackson, round one

By James Pindell
GLOBE STAFF

NEWS ANALYSIS

The national political universe was waiting for Tuesday night's Maine Senate debate between Republican incumbent Susan Collins and her Democratic challenger Troy Jackson – and rightly so.

This is one of the most consequential Senate races of the 2026 midterms, and Tuesday night was the first of four debates over two weeks. While the number of competitive Senate contests has expanded in recent weeks and now includes places like Kansas and Alaska, Maine began the election cycle as it enters the final weeks: on paper, the easiest place for Democrats to flip a Senate seat, but in reality, arguably the hardest to win.

Why? On paper, it is the only state where a Republican senator is seeking reelection in a state that President Trump lost in 2024. In reality, that Republican senator is Collins, who has defied the odds before with her special bond with the state, dating back to her first election three decades ago.

The debate between Republican incumbent Susan Collins and her Democratic challenger, Troy Jackson, was the first of four debates the candidates will have before Election Day.

In her last reelection, in 2020, Trump lost Maine by nine points while Collins won by nine points – even as every poll going into the election showed her done-zo.

So was the hype worth it?

Going into Tuesday night, the race was tied. But rarely do debates fundamentally move the needle. Neither candidate is particularly great on a debate stage. And one hour on local television might drive news coverage, but this race is on track to have $400 million spent on it. That money may drive opinions – or confusion – far more than one debate ever could.

That said, here are three takeaways:

Both candidates failed to do what they needed to do

If a Maine voter turned on the debate hoping to learn from the candidates why they should vote for them or why they should not vote for their opponent, well, they came to the wrong place.

Let's say this early: this debate was pretty much a mess.

The polling already provided the clues for what this debate was supposed to solve. Asked who would be the most effective senator, Collins wins easily. Asked who Mainers want to control the Senate, Democrats and Jackson win easily.

That's the rub.

SENATOR, Page B4

Another small Mass. school has cash woes

College in Springfield could lose accreditation

By Chloe Craft
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

American International College is facing financial issues so severe, the Springfield school could be placed on probation, or lose its accreditation entirely, its accrediting agency announced this week.

The New England Commission of Higher Education, the accrediting body for many Massachusetts colleges, published a joint statement Tuesday with the college disclosing that it projected $17.1 million in operating losses through 2028. According to the letter, American International College risked not meeting the accrediting group's standard for financial stability.

$70,255
amount of unrestricted endowment funds left at the end of the 2025 fiscal year for American International College. The endowment stood at $5.9 million the year before and $10.9 million at the end of 2023 fiscal year.

As a result, the college has taken out an $8 million line of credit, relied on one-time cash funding, and drawn significantly from its endowment in order to continue operating.

According to American International College's annual financial reports, the amount of unrestricted endowment funds left at the end of the 2025 fiscal year was about $70,255.

At the end of the 2024 fiscal year, the endowment stood at $5.9 million in unrestricted funds, according to the records. The year before that, the college had more than $10.9 million.

According to its website, American International College has a population of 973 undergraduate students, nearly all of whom receive some form of financial aid. Around 67 percent of those include federal financial aid.

The accrediting commission made the decision Sept. 24 that the college must prove at its January meeting why it should not be placed on probation or lose its accreditation.

If the college loses its accreditation, it risks losing federal funding, in which case its students could lose access to federal financial aid and find their degrees and credits rejected by other institutions they apply to.

Nicolle Cestero, president of the college, said Wednesday she doesn't believe the school is in jeopardy of losing accreditation.

In an interview with the Globe, Cestero said the school had started a planning process to grow revenue and mitigate expenses in 2024.

"We are going to get it [the planning process] done within the next six weeks, so that we have plenty of time to have meetings internally, model out what this looks like, determine the best course of action for [the college's] future," Cestero said.

Overall, Cestero said, the college is making "considerable progress" to fix its financials. She cited a 13 percent growth in enrollment over the last year, a $4 million increase in tuition revenue, and a 25 percent increase in fund-raising since last year.

Cestero said the US Department of Education's most recent evaluation of the college's finances determined it was stable enough to remain eligible for financial aid. She also noted that there is the potential to switch accreditors, which she said is "certainly something that is in our minds" ahead of the January meeting.

"As you look across the country at schools that are struggling, not all schools are in as positive of a position, and so I think that we

COLLEGE, Page B5

INSIDE

Birchmore trial
A judge excused almost a third of the 411 prospective jurors summoned in the federal murder trial of Matthew Farwell, the former detective accused of killing Sandra Birchmore. **B2.**

Death in facility
An 86-year-old resident of a Hopkinton assisted-living facility was found dead in her bedroom, where the thermostat was showing 99 degrees. **B3.**

MBTA looks to bring in hawks

Raptors would ward off pigeons, 'nuisance birds' from T

By Abby Patkin
BOSTON.COM

The MBTA is looking to the skies for a possible answer to longstanding issues with pigeons and other "nuisance birds" camping out in T stations.

The agency is now exploring whether trained raptors such as falcons and hawks could be used to scare off other birds whose droppings and haphazard roosts have been a perennial issue for the T.

"Pigeons, sea gulls, starlings, and other invasive and nuisance birds are drawn to MBTA stations and facilities in search of food and shelter," officials said in an August request for information, first reported by Streetsblog-MASS. "Bird droppings can carry diseases, corrode critical infrastructure, and create unsanitary conditions for the public and MBTA employees."

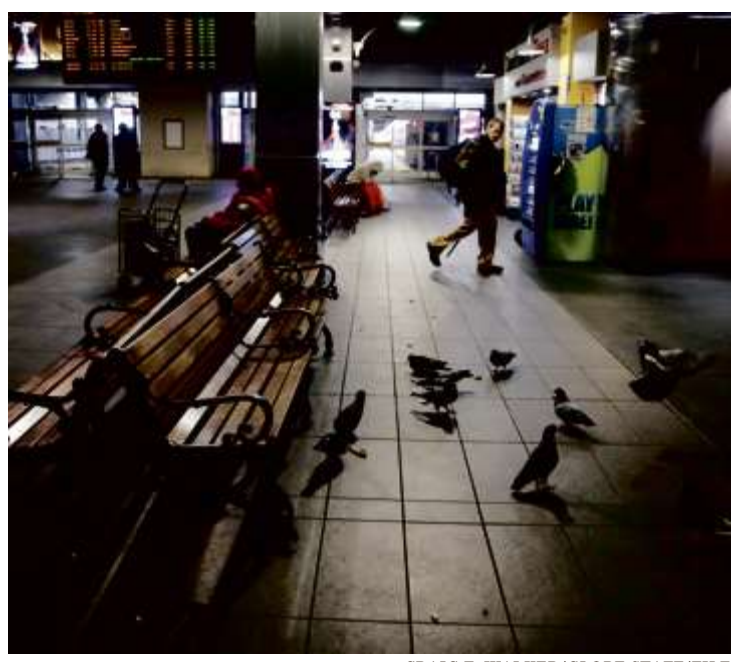
The request for information asks falconry experts to weigh in on the feasibility of a birds of prey program across a transit agency with more than 200 stations.

"For effective bird deterrence, how often should falconers/birds of prey visit?" the request inquires, for example. A follow-up question asks, "What are industry standards regarding carcass removal?"

The MBTA currently uses netting and spikes to keep bothersome birds out of its facilities, though it is also piloting a pigeon trapping program at maintenance sites, according to the document.

A T spokesperson said the pilot has resulted in 218 pigeons being trapped and relocated by the US Department of Agriculture Wildlife Ser-

HAWKS, Page B4



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Pigeons, whose droppings can pose a health risk, fed on discarded bread at North Station in Boston in 2020.

Nearly a third of prospective jurors excused in Farwell trial

Judge looks to seat 12 jurors, four alternates

By Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

A judge on Wednesday excused just under a third of the 411 prospective jurors summoned in the federal murder trial of Matthew Farwell, the former Stoughton police detective accused of killing Sandra Birchmore.

Chief US District Court Judge Denise J. Casper dismissed 116 members of the jury pool based on joint recommendations from the prosecution and defense. She then agreed to excuse more than a dozen others, most of whom the defense had challenged.

Both sides based their recommendations on how prospective jurors responded to questionnaires they completed on Tuesday, the first step in the selection process.

The court has not revealed the questions, and lawyers referred to them only by the number they were assigned on the questionnaires.

In one instance, attorney Kimberly C. Stevens, who represents Farwell, said a potential juror gave "disturbing" answers to a pair of questions. Casper eliminated the person from the pool.

Another time, Stevens flagged comments a prospective juror made about the agency that was first on scene when Birchmore was found dead.

Stevens didn't name the agency, but asked for the person to be eliminated from the jury pool. "It cuts against us," she said.

Casper declined.

On Thursday, Casper, prosecutors and the defense are slated to begin questioning those who advanced through the initial screening.

While the questioning will take place in public, Casper said the court has technology to discuss sensitive topics with prospective jurors in a more private setting.

Casper said she plans to pick 16 jurors: 12 who will participate in deliberations and four alternates. She told prosecutors and the defense to be ready to deliver opening statements on Friday.

Farwell, 40, is accused of strangling Birchmore, a young pregnant woman he allegedly began sexually exploiting after meeting her when she was a teenager in a youth police Explorers program and he was a police officer and program instructor. She was found dead in her Canton apartment on Feb. 4, 2021.

Farwell has pleaded not guilty and asserts that Birchmore, 23, killed herself, citing what he says is her history of mental illness and suicide attempts. He has twice tried, and failed, to have his trial moved outside Massachusetts, arguing that news coverage has tainted the potential jury pool and fostered "widespread public belief" that he is guilty.

Farwell's case is the first high-profile trial in Massachusetts since a jury deadlocked last month in the Lindsay Clancy case.

Legal analysts have said the intense scrutiny of jurors that followed could complicate the selection process here.

Testimony is expected to last about five weeks. More than 100 possible witnesses and hundreds of possible exhibits are expected, including thousands of text messages between Farwell and Birchmore.

The key dispute is whether Birchmore was strangled or died by suicide. Prosecutors allege Farwell killed Birchmore to cover up years of crimes: grooming her for child sexual abuse, initiating an illegal sexual relationship with her when he was 27 and she was 15, and meeting her for sex while on duty.

But Farwell's defense attorneys argue that she was upset because he was ending their relationship. DNA testing has excluded Farwell as the father of Birchmore's fetus.

Jurors are expected to spend a lot of time listening to expert witnesses describe Birchmore's injuries and their conflicting opinions about what caused them.

They will also be shown photographs of Birchmore's body from inside her Canton apartment. On Wednesday, Casper asked prosecutors to offer justification for each photograph it wants to display for the jury.

"I'm not sure they're all necessary," she said.

The investigation into Birchmore's death has figured prominently in public discourse about criminal justice in Massachusetts and law enforcement misconduct as a whole.

Farwell's case carries particular complexities, with questions about whether the initial investigation into Birchmore's death was adequate and whether his police background shielded him from scrutiny.

Norfolk District Attorney Michael W. Morrissey led the first investigation into Birchmore's death. That probe determined Birchmore died by suicide and there was "no evidence of foul play." Morrissey did not file criminal charges.

In 2024, the FBI stepped in and arrested Farwell. They allege he strangled Birchmore, pointing to medical experts who reviewed her autopsy and found evidence that she was killed.

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Fugitives from NYC captured in Lynn

Wanted in alleged stabbing of officer

By John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF

Two men wanted for stabbing an off-duty New York City police detective waived extradition in Lynn District Court Wednesday, clearing the way for their return to New York City to face an attempted murder charge, court records show.

D'Angelo Caraballo, 25, and Sneider Mejia, 24, were arrested in a Lynn residence overnight by federal, state, and New York City law enforcement, ending a search that began Oct. 2 in the Bronx, officials said.

Caraballo and Mejia allegedly attacked Jose Mercedes, 33, on Friday, stabbing him multiple times, officials said.

"The suspects were hiding in the basement of a house when they were apprehended," police in New York said on social media. "If you come for one of us, you'll have the full force of the NYPD coming for you."

Caraballo and Mejia allegedly fled the scene on an e-bike. Authorities in New York said both men will face multiple charges, including attempted murder, when they return.

The two men were arraigned Wednesday in Lynn District Court on fugitive from justice charges and pleaded not guilty, court records show. Both filed waivers of extradition, giving up their right to contest their return to New York.

Caraballo and Mejia were committed to the Essex County House of Correction, pending their return to New York, according to court records. Both are scheduled for video hearings Oct. 20 if they have not been transferred to New York before then.

"According to the NYPD, the two suspects stabbed the off-duty detective seven times during an attempted robbery on Oct. 2 in the Bronx," Massachusetts State Police said. "The detective was treated in a local hospital and released on Oct. 6."

State Police said the agency's "Violent Fugitive Apprehension Section, as part of a Regional Fugitive Task Force, drove an extensive statewide investigation, involving multiple addresses and associates, after receiving information that the suspects may have fled to Massachusetts."

The Department of Homeland Security, which oversees Immigration and Customs Enforcement, said the two men entered the United States illegally through Arizona.

Caraballo was arrested by the Border Patrol in February 2023, and Mejia was taken into custody in December 2022, the agency said.

Travis Andersen and Nick Stoico of the Globe Staff contributed to this report.
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SEND IN THE CLOUDS

JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

People walked to the top of Spectacle Island late in the summer to take in a view of the city skyline. Now, the foliage is popping in the Boston area.

This day in history

Today is Thursday, Oct. 8, the 281st day of 2026. There are 84 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Actor Paul Hogan is 87. Comedian Chevy Chase is 83. Author R.L. Stine is 83. Actor Sigourney Weaver is 77. Musician Robert "Kool" Bell (Kool & the Gang) is 76. Producer-director Edward Zwick is 74. NASCAR Hall of Famer Bill Elliott is 71. Comedian Darrell Hammond is 71. Actor Kim Wayans is 65. Gospel singer CeCe Winans is 62. Olympic gold medal swimmer Matt Biondi is 61. Singer-producer Teddy Riley is 59. Actor Matt Damon is 56. Singer-songwriter Bruno Mars is 41. Actor-singer Bella Thorne is 29. Actor Gordon Cormier is 17.

►In 1774, the First Continental Congress resolved to support residents of Massachusetts Bay colony in their opposition to the Intolerable (Coercive) Acts, which punished the colony for the Boston Tea Party by closing the port to trade and dissolving representative government.

►In 1872, a crowd of 10,000 climbed to the top of Captain's Hill in Duxbury to watch the cornerstone being laid for a monument to Myles Standish, military leader of the Plymouth Colony, (When it was finally finished in 1898, the 116-foot tall shaft, with a 14-foot statue of Standish at the top, was rivaled only by the Washington Memorial as a US monument to an individual citizen.)

►In 1862, Union forces beat back a Confederate offensive in the Battle of Perryville, Kentucky's biggest and bloodiest engagement of the Civil War, leading to hundreds of casualties but ensuring the state would remain under Northern control.

►In 1871, the Great Chicago Fire began; more than 300 people died and more than 17,000 structures were destroyed during the three-day blaze.

►In 1956, Don Larsen pitched the only perfect game in a World Series as the New York Yankees beat the Brooklyn Dodgers in Game 5, 2-0.

►In 1967, Bolivian forces wounded and captured guerrilla leader Ernesto "Che" Guevara, who was attempting to spark a revolution in the South American country. He was executed the next day.

►In 1982, all labor organizations in Poland, including Solidarity, were banned.

►In 1985, the hijackers of the Italian cruise ship Achille Lauro killed American passenger Leon Klinghoffer, who was in a wheelchair, and threw his body overboard.

►In 1997, scientists reported that NASA's Mars Pathfinder had yielded what could be the strongest evidence yet that Mars might once have been hospitable to life.

►In 2002, a federal judge approved President George W. Bush's request to reopen West Coast ports, ending a 10-day labor lockout that was costing the US economy an estimated $1 billion to $2 billion a day.

►In 2005, a magnitude 7.6 earthquake on the Pakistan-India border killed an estimated 86,000 people.

►In 2016, Hurricane Matthew made landfall on the South Carolina coast, triggering heavy flooding and several deaths in the Carolinas only days after a devastating rampage through the Caribbean where it killed more than 500 people in Haiti alone and others elsewhere.

►In 2022, an explosion caused the partial collapse of a bridge linking the Crimean Peninsula with Russia, damaging an important supply artery for the Kremlin's war effort in southern Ukraine.

►In 2024, two pioneers of artificial intelligence — Canadian John Hopfield and American Geoffrey Hinton — won the Nobel Prize in physics for helping create the building blocks of machine learning that is revolutionizing the way people work and live.

The Boston Globe

News

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Lottery

WEDNESDAY MIDDAY 1980

Payoffs *(based on a $1 bet)*

EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits	$3,561
First or last 3	$499
Any 2 digits	$43
Any 1 digit	$4

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits	$148
First 3	$83
Last 3	$83

WEDNESDAY NIGHT 7132

Payoffs *(based on a $1 bet)*

EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits	$4,906
First or last 3	$687
Any 2 digits	$59
Any 1 digit	$6

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits	$204
First 3	$114
Last 3	$114

MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE

Oct. 6 **16-25-27-41-46 MB 3**

Jackpot: $1 million per year

MASS CASH

Oct. 7 **1-3-10-13-24**

Jackpot: $100,000; one winner

MEGABUCKS

Oct. 7 **2-6-13-14-18-37**

Jackpot: $1,463,600; no winners

MEGA MILLIONS

Oct. 6 **26-32-42-51-54**

Megaball 22

Jackpot: $345 million; no winners

PREVIOUS DRAWINGS

	Midday	Night
Tuesday	7963	7057
Monday	1324	2977
Sunday	6810	0908
Saturday	4974	5332
Friday	1640	3253

WEDNESDAY NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND

Maine, N.H., Vermont

Day: 3-digit **100** 4-digit **1074**

Eve: 3-digit **531** 4-digit **1792**

Wed. Tri-State Megabucks

2-3-6-21-23-6

Rhode Island **3862**

Powerball **11-13-14-21-65**

Powerball **19**

DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

NO SAIL — A small boat was tied up in Wickford, R.I., soon to be stored away for the season.

Woman found dead in hot room at care facility, police say

By Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

An 86-year-old resident of a Hopkinton assisted living facility was found dead last week in her bedroom, where the thermostat was showing 99 degrees, police said.

Emergency responders were called to Golden Pond Assisted Living & Memory Care on West Main Street shortly before 10 a.m. on Sept. 30 after Sheila Szczypinski was found unresponsive in her bed, a police report said. The room was stiflingly hot and firefighters opened windows to provide ventilation.

"A member of the fire department observed that the thermostat in the room was reading 99 degrees Fahrenheit," the report said.

A nurse told police that she thought the last time anyone had seen Szczypinski was the previous afternoon on a Walmart trip, and that she was trying to find out if anyone had seen her later that night at dinner, authorities said.

"I also spoke with the facilities manager for Golden Pond who stated that the building had been switched from A/C to heat the previous day," police said.

The manager told police none of the other rooms in the building were having heat issues. But he said "it was possible that Sheila could have attempted to use the 'cool' setting on her thermostat, which would have continued to blow warm air into the room," the report said.

Her death remains under investigation, officials said.

Middlesex District Attorney Marian T. Ryan's office couldn't immediately be reached for comment.

In a statement, Golden Pond said it is "closely cooperating" with authorities "regarding the death of a resident last week."

"Our HVAC system is professionally maintained by a licensed contractor on both a seasonal and as-needed basis and was working properly at the time of this incident," the statement said.

Szczypinski formerly lived in Medway and Milford and graduated from Lowell High School in 1958, according to her obituary.

She had worked at various points in her life in a cookie factory in Lowell, a bank in Pittsfield, and as a realtor in the Milford area, the notice said. In retirement, she volunteered at Milford Regional Hospital.

Szczypinski's death comes during renewed scrutiny on nursing homes, which are different from assisted living facilities like Golden Pond, following a Globe Spotlight report on out-of-state nursing home operators providing allegedly substandard care in Massachusetts.

Travis Andersen can be reached at travis.andersen@globe.com.

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MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Woody Lancaster and his record-setting 2,598-pound pumpkin in Topsfield.

It's the great pumpkin indeed: Grower retires on top of the field

By Madyline Swearing
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

TOPSFIELD — Eighty-year-old Woody Lancaster hauled his giant gourd to the Topsfield Fair for the 42nd All New England Giant Pumpkin Weigh-Off.

A longtime co-chair of the fair's signature event, Lancaster said the weigh-off would be his last.

And he went out a champ.

His 2,598-pound pumpkin set a new record at the fair, which drew 21 entries Friday. (The record had been set last year by Alex Noel of Abington, Conn., whose pumpkin weight 2,507 pounds.)

"It feels great," the Topsfield resident said of ending his backyard hobby on top.

After he was announced as the winner, family, friends and fellow growers surrounded him.

"Hurry up, my son's back is giving out," Lancaster quipped, as he was hoisted on friends' and family's shoulders for celebratory pictures.

Lancaster also won the title in Topsfield in 2013 with a 1,746.5 pound pumpkin and in 2017 with a 2,003.5 pounder.

In addition to bragging rights, Lancaster won more than $10,000 in prize money. His pumpkin and four runners up are on display throughout the fair, which ends next Monday.

The weigh-off is open to dues-paying members of New England Giant Pumpkin Growers Association, which accepts members from outside the region.

But special bonus prize money is given to top winners from New England.

Larry and Shauna Masters, who live just over the Mass. line in New York state, placed second with their 2,220-pound pumpkin named "Toad."

"I'm very disappointed," Larry Masters said, noting he hoped to tip the scales at 2,500.

Third place went to a 2,197-pounder grown by Joe Jutras of Rhode Island.

Eleven-year-old Alistair Lehto of Fitchburg took home fifth place and $500 for junior grower of the year. His pumpkin weighed 1,815 pounds.

The weigh-off kicked off the fair, run by the nonprofit Essex Agricultural Society. Lancaster feels good about the future of competitive pumpkin growing.

"Fortunately we get young folks [competing]...a lot of us are aging out," said Lancaster, who is also a New England representative to the Great Pumpkin Commonwealth, the global governing body of the competitions.

He's mentored Henry Swenson, 24, who grows pumpkins on Lancaster's land. Swenson started growing pumpkins soon after seeing the giants at Topsfield when he was 13. He has competed at the fair eight times.

Lancaster spent the better part of 30 years growing. The hobby can take up to four hours out of his day.

"I can take a seed the size of your thumbnail and turn it into a 2,500-pound pumpkin," he said.

For his last stand at Topsfield, Lancaster changed up his fertilizer mix. His gourd pollinated in July, and gained about 58 pounds each day, he said.

"Being my last year I took a chance ... and pushed them," Lancaster said. "I did everything I could this year."

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

OFF AND RUNNING — A runner cruised along the Charles River on the Cambridge side during a recent early morning run as the sun rose over the city of Boston.

Collins, Jackson fail to move needle in Senate debate

▶SENATOR
Continued from Page B1

But these themes only came up during the scripted opening and closing statements, and maybe if you paid super close attention to the hourlong debate.

But let's go further: Was Trump a theme? Not really. Was specific money that Collins brought back to the district a theme? Also, not really. Did a recent bombshell story about Collins explicitly doling out government contracts to a contributor to her past campaign come up? Like, sorta. Did Graham Platner, the former Senate candidate and one-time Jackson ally, come up? Not at all. Is this particular race part of a national change election? Didn't hear it, if so. If it is about how Collins is uniquely a bipartisan senator everyone wants in theory, that came up precisely once.

To be fair, a Marist College poll released hours before the debate found that only one percent of likely Maine voters were undecided. However, there is evidence in other polls that some support for both candidates is soft and some voters are struggling.

If that's true, then the struggle continues.

They said what?

If the debate is remembered beyond tomorrow, it's because of some of the more odd statements both candidates made – and the moderator is part of the story here also.

Yes, Jackson repeatedly falsely claimed that Collins voted for the One Big Beautiful Bill last year. But that appeared to be an intentional lie to provoke Collins, and he largely got away with it. But he did seem genuinely unaware that the Senate passed a housing bill that would severely limit the amount of real estate that could be bought by private equity – something Massachusetts Senator Elizabeth Warren co-wrote and Collins voted to pass. Collins called him out, and it was early in the debate before some may have changed the channel.

Collins, meanwhile, may have just made one of the oddest gaffes of her career. During an exchange about health care, Jackson said, "Senator Collins has been a government employee her entire life. She has always had health care."

Collins, 73, responded, "I have not been insured my whole life. I spent a year when I was running for governor in 1994 where I could not afford health insurance."

One entire year. When she chose to run for office. This, as she seeks to once again represent one of the poorer states in the country, where the number of uninsured is expected to go up by 50 percent in Maine as a result of the One Big Beautiful Bill.

And then there is the moderator, who asked Jackson for his thoughts on the Keystone XL pipeline, a project canceled in 2021.

He then decided that the lightning round was the right spot to ask for a simple answer to: "AI guardrails, President Trump says he doesn't want them. Yes or no?" He also asked yes-or-no questions about the obviously not-so-simple question of Israel.

Where the debate matters

The real impact of this debate will be in amplifying the weird things said above.

As a clip, even in full context, Collins could use the moments to show her argument that Jackson isn't up for the job, particularly by pointing out a number of factual statements that just weren't true, especially the one on housing, where Collins might argue she was an effective senator. She might even use smaller moments, like how she claims Jackson got the amount of funding for ICE incorrect, though no one really knows that number offhand.

But the 1994 line is meant for an ad suggesting Collins is out of touch. It sort of writes itself.

For Jackson, he was able to land some memorable moments when the debate shifted to health care.

Jackson, who supports Medicare for All, said "an unavoidable death is being able to go into the hospital and get service and not know that you're going to go bankrupt because the health care industry is trying to rook you out of everything that you have."

Jackson also delivered a potentially viral line during the debate over tariffs with Canada, which Collins has fought since they were imposed. She pointed to the fact she got salt for winter roads removed from the tariff list by working with the administration, as proof she was an effective leader.

"Well, Mainers cannot afford to pay their bills with a press release or a strongly worded letter," said Jackson. "We cannot eat road salt."

Then again, maybe the ad makers will wait for what they see in the next debate, which is coming up on Thursday.

James Pindell is a Globe political reporter who reports and analyzes American politics, especially in New England.

Healey, Minogue expected to spar over Trump, issues

▶GOVERNOR
Continued from Page B1

disagrees with Trump on some issues, such as the president's effort to cut funding for life sciences or his trade dispute with Canada. Minogue has also sought to shun party labels, saying in a recent television interview that he's "not a politician."

"I cheer for all my presidents because I want them to do well, whether Democrats or Republicans," he said.

Wendy Wakeman, a Republican political strategist, said to successfully "capture her audience," Healey needs to tie Minogue to Trump and "paint him as [coming] out of the mainstream conservative" movement.

Jane Rayburn, a Massachusetts-based Democratic pollster, said Minogue must give voters an "acceptable answer" as to why he supported Trump. Minogue has said he voted for Trump and in 2024 hosted a fund-raiser for the GOP ticket in Gloucester with now-Vice President JD Vance.

"He's really got to convince voters, particularly these unenrolled voters who are a little bit more moderate, that he's not 'MAGA Mike' and in Trump's pockets," Rayburn said.

Governor Maura Healey and her Republican challenger Michael Minogue will face off in their first televised debate Thursday night. Inflation, including rising fuel costs, is likely to be a key issue.

Stage act

As the chief executive of a publicly traded company for nearly two decades, Minogue has plenty of public speaking experience. He's also faced probing questions from analysts during earnings calls for Abiomed, the Danvers-based medical device company he led as chief executive.

He's also a first-time candidate who did not debate his GOP opponent, Brian Shortsleeve, during their GOP primary. So it's unclear what kind of posture he'll take on the debate stage, where anything can happen.

Both Minogue and Healey will look to score clippable one-liners against each other, or provoke the other into saying something that can later be used in a TV advertisement. Healey, who has been in elected office for more than a decade, has more experience sparring on the public stage.

"It's hard to translate any other kind of communication to political debate," Wakeman said. "You're not looking to win right or wrong with your views; you're looking to make yourself palatable. And there is a hair's breadth of difference there."

Elizabeth Hopkins, a spokesperson for Minogue, did not explicitly say how Minogue was prepping for the debate. Healey enlisted Warren Tolman, a former state senator whom she defeated in her 2014 Democratic primary for attorney general, to serve as a stand-in for Minogue during her debate practice.

"Mike does not need practice to be authentic and speak the truth," Hopkins said in a statement.

Bills, bills, bills

Healey has made affordability and her efforts to address the cost of utilities central to the campaign, rolling out an executive order this week that includes a new program that could send about $700 to eligible "middle-income" families who rely on heating oil, among other temporary and one-time steps.

She also publicly pressed the Trump administration to speed up its review of a $300 million gas pipeline project into Massachusetts, a notable moment given that, as a candidate four years ago, she touted her efforts to slow or stop pipeline projects in the state.

The posturing will likely push energy talks to the fore Thursday, and Healey to underscore her assertions that rising energy costs are because of the Trump administration's war in Iran.

Minogue, for his part, has put forward his own energy proposals, including a promise to eliminate the gas tax "completely," slash what he called "climate taxes" on utility bills, and eliminate the requirement that the state effectively zero out emissions by 2050.

He criticized Healey's effort as a last-minute campaign push over "real relief," he said.

"While Maura Healey rushes from one last-minute press conference to another in the final 30 days of her term, Massachusetts families are still waiting for real relief," he said in a statement earlier this week.

Money talks

Minogue made a small fortune when Abiomed was sold to Johnson & Johnson in 2022, and he's used his wealth to bankroll his campaign, pouring more than $17 million into the race, which already is a record for a gubernatorial candidate's self-financing.

Healey has accused Minogue of trying to "buy" the election. Minogue has largely shrugged off the attacks, and instead argued that they show Healey is not focused on key issues affecting voters in the state.

His considerable resources have allowed Minogue to blanket television and social media with ads going back nearly a year. But the debate could give him a high-profile platform to convince voters he's best equipped to address — and understand — the financial pain animating many voters' attitudes toward candidates this election.

Kelly Garrity of the Globe staff contributed reporting.
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MBTA weighs deploying hawks

▶HAWKS
Continued from Page B1

vices as of Sept. 4.

As for the potential birds of prey program, the MBTA received two responses to its information request and is weighing next steps, the spokesperson said. The T will issue a request for proposals if it decides to move forward with a birds of prey pilot.

In the meantime, the MBTA is also taking note of a similar program already in effect in San Francisco's public transportation system, BART. After first turning to highly trained hawks in May 2022, BART said it now deploys birds of prey and their handlers at 12 stations on a rotating basis. The hawks scare pigeons away from transit stations without harming them, the transit agency noted.

Raptors have even been

JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

The mere presence of a raptor can quickly convince smaller birds to look elsewhere for food and shelter.

used successfully to shoo birds away from planes at New York's John F. Kennedy International Airport and to scare off feisty sea gulls at the New Jersey Shore.

Jim Gwiazdzinski, a Rhode Island-based Master Class falconer who serves as northeastern director of the North American Falconers Association, also relayed the story of Bob Alex, a falconer who used raptors to keep nuisance birds away from his Connecticut blueberry farm.

"What he found was with the falcon, if he flew that bird for basically two weeks straight, it broke the pattern that all these birds had to basically forage all these blueberries," Gwiazdzinski explained. "And in that regard, that worked really well for him."

He said becoming a trained falconer takes years of sustained effort and strict adherence to state and federal regulations.

"The sport itself just, it ends up being, really, a lifestyle," Gwiazdzinski added. "Every day you're doing something with the bird."

He also said falconers end up forming a strong hunting bond and something of a symbiotic relationship with their trained birds of prey.

"There's a fine dance that goes to that, and I think as you get better at it, you truly start to dabble into the art form of it," Gwiazdzinski said. "You see some of these really experienced Master Class falconers [who] have been doing it and are really good at it — it's almost like watching a conductor conduct."

Using falconry for nuisance bird abatement is "definitely a niche that can be fulfilled," Gwiazdzinski acknowledged, though he added that depending on the state, there may be more regulatory hoops to jump through where profit is involved.

But at the end of the day, Gwiazdzinski said, the mere presence of a raptor can quickly convince smaller birds to look elsewhere for food and shelter.

"Anything that's got wings and feathers, it sees a falcon dropping from the heavens [and] looks at it like, 'Oh man, this is my last day on this planet,'" he said.

"So you do that enough, they're like, 'All right, this is an unsafe place to be. Let's go find somewhere else.'"

Another college in financial trouble

▶COLLEGE
Continued from Page B1

have a good basis to move forward from," she said.

Other Massachusetts colleges have faced similar predicaments.

Anna Maria College in Paxton announced it would close in April after letters from the accrediting commission said it risked not meeting institutional resources. In June, it filed for bankruptcy with less than $55,000 left in available funds.

Hampshire College in Amherst was also issued a notice to show cause to save its accreditation in March, but shortly after announced its plan to close.

A Boston-based LLC filed a $29.5 million loan for Hampshire College in August, which will buy the school more time to pay off its debts owed to commercial banks and to finish its fall 2026 semester before closing.

Saint Michael's College in Vermont was issued a similar notice by the accrediting commission in June after facing declining enrollment numbers. Some estimates have projected more than 25 percent of private colleges could be at risk of closing over the next decade.

The Massachusetts Department of Higher Education screens the finances of all accredited institutions in the state under the Financial Assessment and Risk Monitoring law, which was passed after the closure of Mount Ida College in 2018. However, the closure announcements of Anna Maria and Hampshire last spring raised concerns over whether that law does enough to prevent such abrupt closures.

In September, the department said it planned to require colleges to provide earlier notice if they are at risk of closing. Under new regulations, colleges "at risk of imminent closure" would be required to publicly disclose so by Dec. 31 each year.

On April 25, American International College announced an initiative to support new transfer students affected by the closure of Anna Maria College at the conclusion of the spring 2026 semester with financial support and a dedicated, expedited application portal.

"It's easy to say, 'Oh no, you're not going to be able to survive this,'" Cestero said. "But in reality, many other institutions have survived this and have been successful moving forward, and so can we."

American International College was founded as the French Protestant College in 1885 by a French Canadian pastor who sought to provide higher education to the local French Canadian minority community.

In 1892, it became the first college in Western Massachusetts to enroll women alongside men. As its enrollment expanded to other immigrant and minority communities, in 1905, it was renamed as American International College. It was first accredited in 1933.

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JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF/FILE 2023

American International College's leader says it's making progress on fixing its finances.

Ex-school worker gets six months for theft

Took food to stock snack shop

By Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

For more than a decade, and unbeknownst to the district, Plymouth Public Schools footed the bill for the ingredients for the ham and turkey sandwiches and burgers sold at the Snack Shack on Sandy Neck Beach on Cape Cod, court filings show.

Now, the district's former head of food services, Patrick Van Cott, has until Dec. 16 to surrender to the federal Bureau of Prisons to begin serving a six-month sentence for stealing everything from hamburgers and deli meats to refrigerators and an outdoor grill from his job to use and sell at his side business, prosecutors said.

Van Cott, 64, who lives in Sandwich, was sentenced Wednesday in federal court in Boston. In May, he pleaded guilty to theft from a program that receives federal funds.

In Massachusetts, meals for all students are free. Schools are reimbursed through a USDA funds and state funds.

US District Judge Julia E. Kobick sentenced Van Cott to six months in prison, followed by two years of supervised release. Kobick also imposed a $2,000 fine and restitution, in an amount to be determined, court records show.

The sentence was announced in a statement issued by Massachusetts US Attorney Leah B. Foley; Ted E. Docks, special agent in charge of the Federal Bureau of Investigation in Boston; and Charmeka Parker, special agent in charge of the US Department of Agriculture — Office of Inspector General in the Northeast.

"Valuable assistance was provided by the Plymouth Police Department," the statement said.

Van Cott was director of food services for Plymouth Public Schools for 22 years. After an anonymous tip was made to authorities, he was arrested and fired in June 2025.

Van Cott opened the Snack Shack in 2014 in Barnstable, as a summertime side business. For the better part of a decade, he pilfered goods from the school district to turn a profit at his beachside snack bar, charging documents said.

Federal prosecutors said $30,0000 is a "conservative calculation" of how much Van Cott cost taxpayers.

He bought refrigerators valued at $2,200 and two-door freezers that cost $3,950, along with hot plates, griddles, a char-grill, and convection oven. He also stole chicken, hot dogs, cooking oil, coffee, and other supplies from the schools.

Once a week, every summer, Van Cott would have cafeteria workers slice deli meats, 9 pounds of turkey and 4½ pounds of ham, for him to take to the Cape, prosecutors said.

Assistant US Attorney Kristina E. Barclay sought a prison sentence of 10 months for Van Cott's "calculated and deliberate betrayal of trust."

"His crimes were driven by pure greed, not need," she wrote.

Van Cott earned more than $100,000 a year and owned two homes, one in Sandwich and one in Hyannis, the memo said.

In his own memo, Van Cott asked for a sentence of 24 months probation, saying he was deeply ashamed and remorseful.

"No child went without a meal during his scheme," Van Cott's lawyer, Nathaniel Amendola, said in the memo.

"Patrick broke the trust he spent 22 years earning," Amendola wrote. "Patrick's criminal conduct stands in stark contrast to the other side of him: the side that he is known and loved for."

Van Cott also has a pending case on larceny charges in state court.

Tonya Alanez can be reached at tonya.alanez@globe.com.

Uxbridge school postpones dance after student's death

By Lauren Albano
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Uxbridge High School postponed its homecoming dance scheduled for this week after a 15-year-old student died in a car crash over the weekend, schools officials said.

The student, whose name has not been released, was ejected from a vehicle that crashed into a utility pole, the Uxbridge Police Department said Sunday.

"Our thoughts and deepest sympathies go out to the student's family, loved ones, and friends as they navigate this painful loss," Principal Michael Rubin said in a message to families Sunday. "Our community, as a school and town alike, will do its best to be cohesive and strong in its resolve."

The school postponed the homecoming dance, which was planned for this week, "out of respect for the situation," Rubin said. It may also make adjustments to the athletic schedule.

Rubin shared resources with families, including grief-coping resources, the 988 Lifeline, and Riverside Community Care in Milford. Support personnel and counselors were on-site at the high school starting Monday to assist students and staff.

On Saturday, emergency crews responded to the area of 685 Chocolog Road at about 8:50 p.m., where a Ford Focus carrying three people struck a utility pole and left the roadway, the police said. The teenager was taken to Rhode Island Hospital in Providence and pronounced dead there, police said. Police did not disclose whether the two other occupants were injured.

Lauren Albano can be reached at lauren.albano@globe.com.

MATT PORTER/GLOBE STAFF

Owen Coyne's parents, Brian Coyne and Angela Paradise, held a photo of their son playing for the Marblehead High School football team, where he was co-captain.

Funeral set for Marblehead athlete

By Lauren Albano
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The life of Owen Paradise Coyne, the Marblehead High School athlete and football co-captain who died suddenly last week, will be honored on Thursday.

A funeral service will be held at 11:30 a.m. Our Lady Star of the Sea Church in Marblehead, followed by a gathering at Tedesco Country Club, Coyne's family wrote in a tribute published on the website of a local funeral home.

His family has established the Owen P. Coyne Scholarship Fund, and are asking people to donate instead of sending flowers.

Coyne, 17, died on Oct. 1 from a sudden brain hemorrhage that was not caused by impact in football, his family wrote. He played in Marblehead's Week 1 opener against Lynn English and did not suit up in the Magicians' next two games.

A wave of tributes to Coyne washed over the North Shore after his death. National Grand Bank flew its flag at half-staff. Swampscott, the town's traditional rival, posted its condolences, on an electronic message board on Humphrey Street.

Hundreds of people gathered Sunday night at Piper Field for a vigil in Coyne's honor. At the center was his No. 18 football jersey surrounded by battery-powered candles and glow sticks.

A senior, Coyne played wide receiver and safety for the Magicians last season and committed to play football at Williams College. He also starred in baseball, where he was a Northeastern Conference All-Star, and ran indoor track. Coyne came close to a state championship in the high jump last winter, and finished as a Top 10 sprinter in Marblehead track history, per coach Nolan Raimo.

"He was an unbelievable athlete, but you wanted to root for him, because he tried so hard and did everything right," Raimo told the Globe this past weekend. "He took full advantage of his gifts."

Known as "Owie" to his family and "OC" to friends, teammates, and coaches, Coyne "was a true gift to everyone who ever had the privilege of meeting him," according to his family's tribute. He is survived by his parents, Brian Coyne and Angela Paradise, and his three younger siblings, Grady, 15, Landon, 12, and 8-year-old Ella — as well as his four grandparents and several aunts, uncles, and cousins.

Coyne was a respected student-athlete.

He took nearly all AP and honors classes and maintained a 4.0 GPA, and Coyne's proudest accomplishment was receiving the Charles Lovely Student-Athlete Award at the end of last year's football season, his family said.

Coyne was a sailing instructor and volunteer sports coach for various sports camps and clinics over the years.

"Quite simply, Owen was a proud Magician, fiercely loved Marblehead, and Marblehead loved him back," his family wrote.

Lauren Albano can be reached at lauren.albano@globe.com. Follow her on X @LaurenAlbano_.

notices & more
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LEGAL NOTICES LEGAL NOTICES

City of Watertown

The Traffic Commission members voted to recommend the following changes to the Traffic Rules and Orders Issued by the Manager under the authority of Section 22 and 22A of Chapter 40 of the General Laws, and Section 7 of Chapter XI of the Watertown Ordinances. Adopted May 7, 1991, with Amendments to June, 2026.

1. **SCHEDULE I – PARKING**

a. Add to Schedule I and Appendix 6 of the Traffic Rules and Orders 15 Berkeley Street, one space, Handicap Only Parking

b. Delete from Schedule I, Parking, Westminster Avenue, east side from a point 40' south of the crosswalk at Bemis Street to a point 20' south of the crosswalk at Bemis Street, No Parking Police Vehicles Only When School is in Session.

c. Delete from Schedule I, Parking, Westminster Avenue, east side from a point 450' south of Bemis Street to a point 219' south of Bemis Street, No Parking Bus Stop from 8:00AM-3:30PM When School is in Session.

d. Add to Schedule I Parking, and Appendix 3 Miscellaneous Signs of the Traffic rules and Orders, Columbia Street south side, one parking space immediately east of the crosswalk at 50 Columbia Street to No Parking Police Vehicles Only When School is in Session.

e. Add to Schedule I Parking and amend Appendix 6 HP Parking Zones of the Traffic Rules and Orders, Columbia Street south side, two parking spaces immediately west of the crosswalk at 50 Columbia Street to Handicap Only Parking.
f. Add to Schedule I, Parking, Columbia Street south side, from a point 42 feet east of Common Street to a point 107 feet east of Common Street, No Parking Drop-off and Pick-Up Only, 7:30am-2:30pm When School is in Session.

2. **ARTICLE VII, SECTION 26 – DO NOT ENTER**

a. Delete from Article VII, Section 26, Do Not Enter Westminster Ave at Bemis Street in a southerly direction from 7:30AM-4:00PM when school is in session.

b. Delete from Article VII Section 26, Do Not Enter Linden Street from Waverley Avenue in a westerly direction from 7:30AM-4:00PM when school is in session, except residents.

October 5, 2026

George J. Proakis, City Manager

Noelle Gilligan, City Clerk ATTEST

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The Boston Globe

LEGAL NOTICES

The City of Waltham Purchasing Dept. is releasing Bids and RFPs beginning on or around October 1st, 2026 for Lease of 48 & 50 Mt. Walley Rd, Common St Garage Renovations. See https://www.city.waltham.ma.us/category/tags/purchasing-bids-open-0 or call 781-314-3240. The City reserves the right to reject any and all Bids/Proposals if it's in the best interest of the City.

LEGAL NOTICES LEGAL NOTICES

MORTGAGEE'S SALE OF REAL ESTATE

By virtue of and in execution of the Power of Sale contained in a certain mortgage given by Patrick Tauro to Option One Mortgage Corporation, dated November 21, 2005 and recorded in Middlesex County (Southern District) Registry of Deeds in Book 46583, Page 368 (the "Mortgage") of which mortgage Wells Fargo Bank, National Association, as Trustee for Carrington Mortgage Loan Trust, Series 2006-OPT1, Asset Backed Pass-Through Certificates, Series 2006-OPT1 is the present holder by Assignment from Option One Mortgage Corporation to Wells Fargo Bank, N.A., as Trustee for the Certificateholders of Carrington Mortgage Loan Trust, Series 2006-OPT1, Asset Backed Pass-Through Certificates dated February 27, 2008 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 50844, Page 290, and Assignment from Wells Fargo Bank, N.A., as Trustee for the Certificate Holders of Carrington Mortgage Loan Trust, Series 2006-OPT1, Asset Backed Pass-Through Certificates to Wells Fargo Bank, N.A., as Trustee for Carrington Mortgage Loan Trust, Series 2006-OPT1, Asset Backed Pass-Through Certificates, Series 2006-OPT1 dated October 24, 2012 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 60709, Page 513, and Assignment from Wells Fargo Bank, National Association, as Trustee for the Certificate Holders of Carrington Mortgage Loan Trust, Series 2006-OPT1, Asset Backed Pass-Through Certificates to Wells Fargo Bank, National Association, as Trustee for Carrington Mortgage Loan Trust, Series 2006-OPT1, Asset Backed Pass-Through Certificates, Series 2006-OPT1 dated June 6, 2013 and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 62088, Page 392, for breach of conditions of said mortgage and for the purpose of foreclosing the same, the mortgaged premises located at 100 Temple Road, Somerville, MA 02145 will be sold at a Public Auction at 2:00 PM on October 22, 2026, at the mortgaged premises, more particularly described below, all and singular the premises described in said mortgage, to wit:

A certain parcel of land together with buildings thereon known and numbered as 100 Temple Road, Somerville, Middlesex County, Massachusetts, being Lot 146 on a plan showing land in Somerville owned by J.A. Walker and F. Walker, Subdivision Plan. East Side Ten Hills Road to Shore Drive, recorded with Middlesex Southern District Registry of Deeds, Plan Book 379, plan 12 and bounded:

NORTHEASTERLY by lots 144 and 145 on said plan, ninety (90) feet;

NORTHWESTERLY by lots 155 and 154 on said plan, forty (40) feet;

SOUTHWESTERLY by lots 147 on said plan, ninety (90) feet;

SOUTHEASTERLY by Temple Road on said plan, forty (40) feet.

For mortgagor's title see deed recorded with the Middlesex County (Southern District) Registry of Deeds in Book 46583, Page 366.

The premises will be sold subject to any and all unpaid taxes and other municipal assessments and liens, and subject to prior liens or other enforceable encumbrances of record entitled to precedence over this mortgage, and subject to and with the benefit of all easements, restrictions, reservations and conditions of record and subject to all tenancies and/or rights of parties in possession.

Terms of the Sale: Cashier's or certified check in the sum of $10,000.00 as a deposit must be shown at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder (the mortgage holder and its designee(s) are exempt from this requirement); high bidder to sign written Memorandum of Sale upon acceptance of bid; balance of purchase price payable by certified check in thirty (30) days from the date of the sale at the offices of mortgagee's attorney, Korde & Associates, P.C., 900 Chelmsford Street, Suite 3102, Lowell, MA or such other time as may be designated by mortgagee. The description for the premises contained in said mortgage shall control in the event of a typographical error in this publication.

Other terms to be announced at the sale.

Wells Fargo Bank, National Association, as Trustee for Carrington Mortgage Loan Trust, Series 2006-OPT1, Asset Backed Pass-Through Certificates, Series 2006-OPT1
Korde & Associates, P.C.
900 Chelmsford Street
Suite 3102
Lowell, MA 01851
(978) 256-1500
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LivingArts

Phoebe Bridgers banned phones at her current tour. The rule made her Boston show even better.

MUSIC REVIEW

PHOEBE BRIDGERS
With Alex G. At TD Garden, Tuesday

By James Sullivan
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

It's no secret that arena concerts by big-name artists cost a lot of money in 2026. Fans try to squeeze every drop from their tickets, shooting selfies and videos of themselves preening with the stage as their backdrop.

But some artists have pushed back. Halfway through her first of two sold-out nights headlining TD Garden, the ethereal songwriter Phoebe Bridgers thanked the audience for agreeing to lock their mobile phones in padded pouches.

"It means the world to me," she said. "It made this room feel so different."

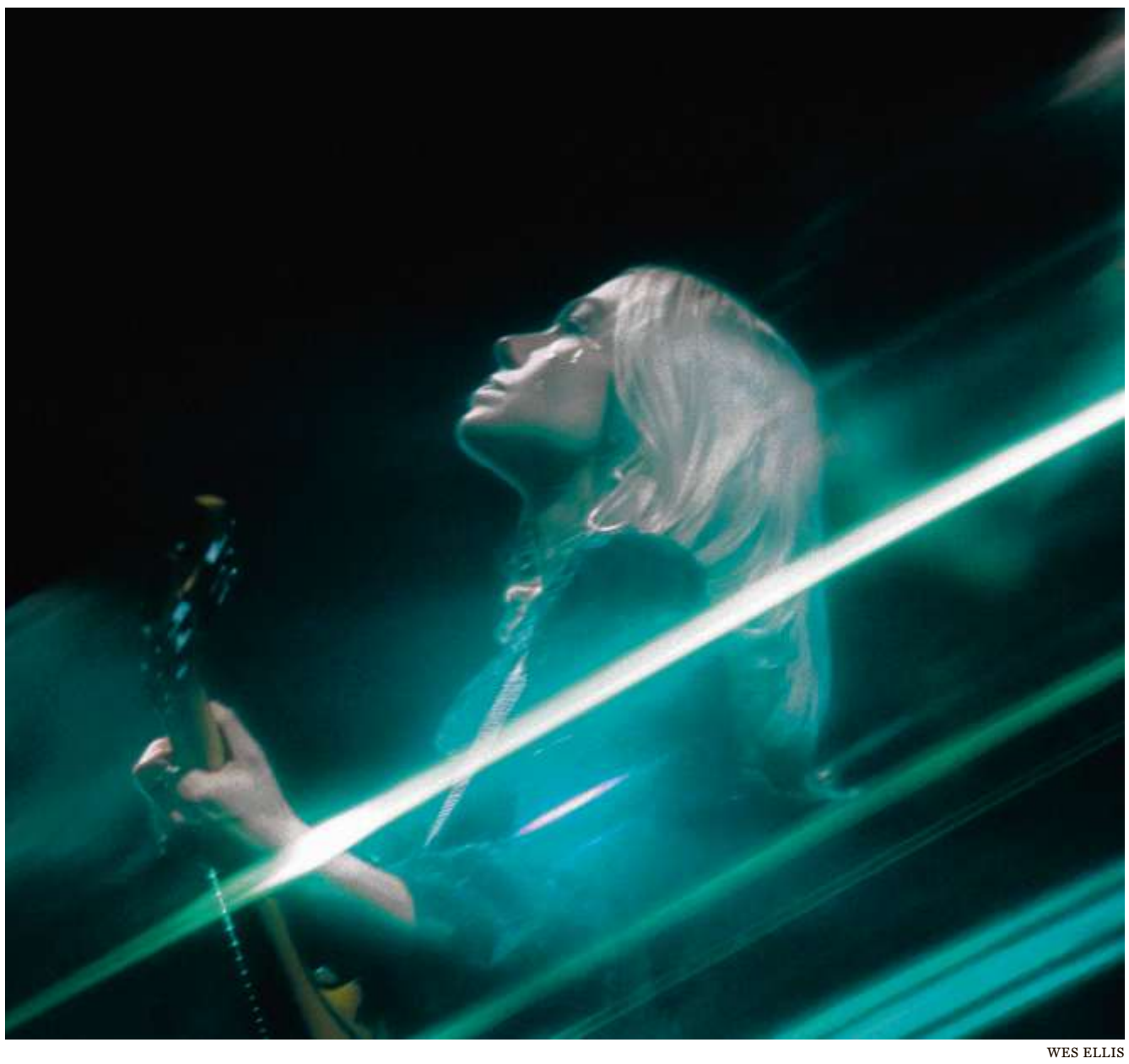
It did indeed. Before she took the stage, fans gazed up toward the Garden's famed rafters, rather than down into their laps.

That sense of wonder permeated the show. Bridgers debuted her breakthrough third album, "Lost Weekend," this summer with a series of listening parties at planetariums. The staging on her current tour features an intergalactic theme, with a huge cloth dome that rose to reveal the band and a literal satellite stage over which loomed an orb that radiated laser beams and other visual effects.

Bridgers, who released her debut album, "Stranger in the Alps," in 2017, has become a bit of a surprise superstar, as a member of boygenius (with Lucy Dacus and Julien Baker), frequent collaborator (with Taylor Swift, Conor Oberst, and more), and a solo act. Her music has the intimacy of late-night, one-on-one conversations, either with a friend or oneself. That closeness of contact feels essential in our present age of noise.

Not that her band doesn't make noise. "Kill Me," from the new album – as the chorus goes, "This is gonna kill me" – opens with a sleepy vocal and a softly strummed acoustic guitar. But the band, full of multi-instrumentalists and a prominent string section, built it to an ominous crescendo.

"On Video," a new song from the soundtrack of "Primetime," in which Bridgers recently made her acting debut, combined dream-pop with grunge. "I Know the End," from Bridgers's second album, 2020's "Punisher," culminated in a cathartic scream.



WES ELLIS

Phoebe Bridgers performing at TD Garden on Tuesday.

Life, death, and eternity are running themes in Bridgers's music. She has said that her recent music has been deeply impacted by the death of her father.

"All songwriter music is supposed to be personal, but this was insane," she said about writing the songs for "Lost Weekend."

Yes, she sang "Liberty Tree," the song inspired by a visit to the "dying" mall in Danvers, which she has evidently visited with her reported paramour, the comedian and filmmaker Bo Burnham, who is from nearby Hamilton. But the song is paradoxically upbeat, a celebration of mundanity.

For the show's middle section, Bridgers appeared on the secondary stage. She sat cross-legged to play a church organ on the title track of her new album. That segued into "Funeral," from her debut: Joined by the string performers on banjo, stick bass, mandolin, and fiddle, she led a somber hootenanny on "Haunted."

Later, for the closing segment, Bridgers reappeared on the satellite stage for a reprise on the legless organ, this time having changed from her gauzy black gown to white. The lighting made her tear-shaped face paint glow neon.

Having opened the show with "Motion Sickness," a standout from her debut, she left the stage with another. "Scott Street" is about the fleeting conversations we have upon chance meetings with acquaintances.

At the part of the show when another audience would have pulled out their phones and shone their flashlights, instead the house lights came up. A sea of arms waved back and forth in unison, like some sort of disembodied life force.

"Don't be a stranger," Bridgers cooed.

James Sullivan can be reached at jamesgsullivan@gmail.com.

Smoke, mirrors, and illusions

Horror is everywhere in theater these days. Directors are using tricks of the trade to craft genuinely eerie shows.

By Christopher Wallenberg
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

There will be blood — not to mention spine-tingling screams, bone-chilling special effects, and startling jump-scares. You'll find that fusillade of frights in a slew of nightmare-inducing stage spectacles that have been scaring the bejesus out of Boston-area audiences recently. They include the haunted house horror-show "Paranormal Activity," which ran at the Emerson Colonial Theatre last summer and is now playing on Broadway, and the musical adaptation of the cinematic psychological thriller "Black Swan," set in the world of ballet and presented by the American Repertory Theater last spring.

We've often thought of horror as a quintessentially cinematic genre, so it comes with complications when depicted on stage: The audience is right there in the room with the performers, and theaters can't use some of the technology that filmmakers do. So how do you create genuine scares in a live setting? Can you pull off the illusions?

The horror-tinged thriller has a long and illustrious history in live theater — from "The Woman in Black," "Wait Until Dark," and "Deathtrap" to "Sweeney Todd," "The Pillowman," and "Misery." The chilling "Let the Right One In," inspired by the harrowing Swedish vampire film, was produced by Actors Shakespeare Project in 2022. Now running on Broadway, "Stranger Things: The First Shadow," a prequel to the hit television series, showcases nerve-jangling tension and truly terrifying illusions and special effects.

And here in Boston, just in time for Halloween, audiences can prepare their nerves for more shows filled with bloodcurdling scares. "Covenant," produced by SpeakEasy Stage Company at the Calderwood Pavilion through Oct. 17, finds a young woman becoming possessed by a supernatural force, as her God-fearing mother attempts a terrifying exorcism to cast out the ostensible demon. "Blackhollow: A Gothic Tale of Possession," premiering at Greater Boston Stage Company in Stoneham Oct. 23-Nov. 8, unfolds inside a lunatic asylum in 1830s London where a doctor is performing terrifying medical experiments on patients. Inspired in part by "Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde," the macabre tale is written by GBSC artistic director Weylin Symes and features a single performer, Anna Slate, playing all eight characters.

BENJAMIN ROSE PHOTOGRAPHY

Crystin Gilmore as Mama in "Covenant" at SpeakEasy Stage.

"I think there's more desire and appetite for these shows now, so there's more space being made for them," says Dawn M. Simmons, who directed "Covenant." "Entertainment can be a comedy filled with laughter, it can be a good musical where you leave tapping your toes, and it can also be that thing where your heart's racing and you're like, 'How did they do that? What just happened? That was intense.'"

Fear is contagious in a live setting, so those outsize, fright-filled reactions can rub off on other audience members. "It's so much about sharing the experience with a group of other live humans," says Symes, of Greater Boston Stage. "One of my favorite aspects of 'Paranormal Activity' was the very visceral responses of the audience and how much that played a role in the experience. I know someone who saw it and said somebody sneezed at one point, and the entire audience screamed."

"It just feels more dangerous because you're watching a real human undergo these very scary experiences," Symes adds. "So it's different than watching it in a movie."

What techniques do these shows use to elicit genuine scares? Lulling audiences into a false sense of security is key, often by adding moments of levity and laughter. Restraint can be a powerful tool, says "Paranormal Activity" director Felix Barrett, who also co-created the haunting immersive show "Sleep No More" that made its Stateside premiere in 2009 at Brookline's Old Lincoln School (courtesy of the ART). "My favorite thing to do in any show is to let it settle for slightly too long until people almost forget that something's going to change, and then you whip that rug out from underneath them," he says. "Then if you're very lucky, as they're falling back, you can hit them again. So it's the architecture of the piece that brings the true fear factor."

Part of that architecture involves building a mounting sense of dread that something sinister is afoot, with the roller coaster tension wearing down the audience's nerves. "We have to slowly start to undermine your belief that our heroes are going to be OK," Simmons says. "What is that first pinch point of danger? And then how do people cope with the new reality of, 'Oh, is this the world that we live in now?' and then building to, 'Oh no, it can get so much worse'?"

It's also pivotal to create compelling and relatable characters that audiences can invest in emotionally. In "Paranormal Activity," the central couple, James and Lou, clearly love each other, but they're also at odds. Lou has been battling depression and has suffered from blackouts, and James struggles to be supportive. Both are carrying soul-scarring baggage from their past. Soon, an otherworldly entity seems to take over their house.

Smoke and mirrors have always been part of live theater. "You can't do a jump-cut surprise on stage like you can in film, so you have to find different ways to scare people," Symes says. "We don't have the money of a Hollywood studio or Broadway. But we have all these other tools — lights, haze, and a great sound design — to create a really scary environment."

Indeed, the soundscape, lighting design, illusions, and special effects are vital to giving the audience goosebumps. "Sound just does so much of the heavy lifting," Barrett says. "It's our secret weapon." "Paranormal Activity" relies on droning reverberations, sudden bursts of loud noise, shadow magic, swirling haze, and eye-popping effects to create a nerve-rattling atmosphere. At one point, a character appears to be in two places at once.

All of the shows play into our fear of the dark, because the unknown is often the most unsettling. "It's like 'Jaws,'" Simmons says. "There is something under there that you cannot see, you don't know what it is, and you don't know when it's going to strike."

In "Paranormal Activity," the set is a two-floor house, and audience members scan the rooms for signs of the supernatural — mysterious shadows, moving and falling objects, terrifying sounds. "If there's a pool of darkness, and you can't see how far it stretches, suddenly your imagination starts to fill in the gaps," Barrett says.

With "Covenant," Simmons and her creative team are using a lot of what she calls "attic magic," including sound and lighting techniques, a few magic tricks, and timeworn theatrical devices to amplify the fear factor. "It's like a bunch of kids who are like, 'We're going to go upstairs into the attic and get into Grandma and Grandpa's things, and we're going to put on a show. So this piece of fabric can do this, this pulley line can do this.' What are the low-tech ways for us to get some of these really incredible effects?"

Barrett says he leaned into the science about how to flood the audience's bodies with adrenaline and keep them on the edge of their seats. He's heard audiences warning the characters, aloud, not to go upstairs, and has seen people ducking down behind the seat in front of them. At one performance, a stranger sitting next to him spontaneously grabbed his arm during one of the many jump scares.

"We laughed about it at [intermission]," he says. "You really feel allied with your fellow human. When the world is so polarized, and there's a lot of negativity out there, I think finding solace in all the humans that surround you in this shared experience is something that's deeply needed."

TV HIGHLIGHTS

MLB playoffs: Guardians-White Sox, 5 p.m., TBS
NHL: Mammoth-Bruins, 7 p.m., NESN
NBA preseason: Celtics-Cavaliers, 7 p.m., NBCSB
NFL: Buccaneers-Cowboys, 8:15 p.m., Amazon
Listings, C7

Sports

THE BOSTON GLOBE THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS

TARA SULLIVAN

This team loves being cast as an underdog

The defining mantra from the Patriots' weekend win in Buffalo was shouted repeatedly as players entered a victorious locker room.

"We're not dead yet."

The sentiment spoke to the obvious disaster awaiting on the other side of a potential loss, to the fate the now 2-2 Patriots avoided had they not managed to topple the then-undefeated, touchdown-favorite Bills. But it spoke to something deeper, too, about the mind-set the players channeled to get their season back on track.

Cast them as the underdog — they love nothing more.

The landscape of our greatest sporting memories is filled with tales of underdog victory, of teams and players who overcame odds and obstacles on their way to glory. From Miracle on Ice to Hoosiers, from the 2001 Patriots to Rocky, there is

SULLIVAN, Page C5

NFL WEEK 5
RAIDERS AT PATRIOTS
Sunday, 1 p.m., CBS

FILE/DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Special teams ace Brenden Schooler, shown making a tackle in the AFC Championship game, is not expected back Sunday.

Help for Patriots is on the way, sort of

Players coming off IR not ready

By Christopher Price
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — The Patriots have five players eligible to return from injured reserve this week, but it doesn't sound like any are quite ready for game action.

Special teamer Brenden Schooler, punter Bryce Baringer, linebacker Khalil Jacobs, offensive tackle Marcus Bryant, and outside linebacker Harold Landry are eligible to return after starting the season on the physically unable to perform list or non-football injury list.

However, before practice on Wednesday, coach Mike Vrabel indicated the group will remain sidelined, at least for Sunday's game against the Raiders, saying there's some "uncertainty" regarding a timeline for their potential return.

"I just think that with the uncertainty here, that probably won't happen," Vrabel said. "I wouldn't anticipate that happening.

"Those guys have all worked really hard to get back. It's just kind of where the situation is

PATRIOTS, Page C5

FRANK FRANKLIN II/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Sonny Gray, who has a $30 million mutual option for 2027, would leave a huge hole in the Red Sox rotation if he took a $10 million buyout.

A Red Sox roster reset

BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

The Red Sox will be taking a close look at outfielder Jarren Duran's contract option.

Front office has work cut out to make improvements, particularly to lineup

By Tim Healey
GLOBE STAFF

For the Red Sox, 2027 begins now.

They opened another offseason this week, earlier than they wanted, with plenty on the agenda for the coming months, impending lockout notwithstanding. With the lineup in particular again meriting supplements, in the view of chief baseball officer Craig Breslow, it figures to be another interesting go-around for the front office.

"We obviously have a lot of work to do," Breslow said at the Red Sox' season-end news conference.

Let's start that work with a rundown of the contract status of all 47 players on the roster.

Players who are eligible to become free agents (3): Sonny Gray, Patrick Sandoval, Isiah Kiner-Falefa.

This is a stunningly small group — and hints at a strong foundation for an organization that wants to build on a second consecutive fleeting postseason appearance.

The biggest name — and the player who would leave the biggest hole should he not return — is Gray, who stepped up as the rotation's No. 1 performer in the injury-induced absence of Garrett Crochet. Gray had a 2.72 ERA and 1.15 WHIP and led the team with 29 starts and 169 innings.

Technically, Gray has a $30 million mutual option for 2027, but that is merely accounting. He is a virtual lock to get the $10 million buyout instead and hit the open market . . . as he considers retirement.

If he does pitch, would he want to return to the Red Sox?

RED SOX, Page C4

Sturm reshuffles his lines

Bruins' offense struggling with Mammoth up next

By Jim McBride
GLOBE STAFF

Marco Sturm continued his mixing and matching Wednesday morning in hopes of finding a recipe for success for a Bruins team struggling to generate offense.

Sturm overhauled his top three lines for the high-tempo practice at Warrior Ice Arena, including reuniting a former top line with Pavel Zacha centering Morgan Geekie on the left and David Pastrnak on the right.

The new-look second line had Fraser Minten in the middle with Marat Khusnutdinov and JJ Peterka. Elias Lindholm was the pivot on the third line with Casey Mittelstadt on the left and James Hagens on the right.

The fourth line remained the same from Monday's loss to the Senators, with Matt Poitras centering Tanner Jeannot and Mark Kastelic. Sean Kuraly was again the spare forward.

Though Sturm wouldn't fully commit to the changes for Thursday's home game against the Mammoth, it's likely he will at least start with them after investing an entire practice with the makeover.

"I want to change a little bit, but we'll see. Tried something today," said Sturm. "We'll see [Thurs-

BRUINS, Page C2

INSIDE

SARAH STIER/GETTY IMAGES

All in perspective
What a difference a year makes as Jayson Tatum prepares for full season with Celtics. **C2**

Diamond dandies
Rays (above) sweep Yankees on way to ALCS, Guardians alive, and Dodgers in NLCS again. **C4**

On the way up
Newcomers boost Winchester girls' soccer on its climb to No. 9 in Globe Top 20 poll. **C6**

BC phenom Mara 'one in a million' as a dual-sport D1 athlete

By Emma Healy
GLOBE STAFF

In November 2025, more than a dozen coaches, athletic trainers, nutritionists, and medical professionals gathered in a conference room in Chestnut Hill to answer one question:

What do we do about Emily Mara?

Only 1 percent of the approximately 200,000 athletes in NCAA Division 1 compete in multiple sports. Mara, a sophomore at Boston College, is the only athlete competing in both women's soccer and hockey.

The Winchester native's unusual physical talent, combined with seemingly boundless energy and a cerebral approach to her sports, makes her uniquely positioned to do what many told her was impossible, her coaches explained.

"Her body can take it. Her psyche can take it, too, with all the ups and downs, and her shoulders can take it with the load she bears mentally," BC women's soccer coach Chris Watkins said. "She's one in a million."

Increasingly, the landscape works against athletes like Mara.

Single-sport specialization begins at an earlier and earlier age, pushed by parents and coaches, but also young athletes themselves. And soccer and hockey are among the most time-consuming and financially demanding sports — particularly at the club level.

But Mara excelled in both at Phillips Academy, Andover, and went through the recruiting process for both soccer and hockey.

Some schools flat-out rejected the idea that Mara could play both at the Division 1 level. Either they wanted her undivided attention or they were worried about injury risk, or both.

BC was the exception. Watkins and women's hockey coach Katie Crowley wanted her on board no matter what.

"They were probably two of the most supportive coaches I've ever spoken to," Mara said.

There weren't many options for Mara to play at the highest level, either. Just 45 schools sponsor Division 1 women's hockey programs, and most don't have a high-level women's soccer program. BC soccer plays in the ACC, the most competitive conference in the NCAA. On the ice, the Eagles are a pe-

MARA, Page C7

COURTESY/BOSTON COLLEGE ATHLETICS

Winchester's Emily Mara will play a second season for the Boston College women's hockey team once her sophomore soccer season finishes up.

MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE GLOBE

Jayson Tatum, entering his 10th season with the Celtics, says he has become more reflective on his career.

GARY WASHBURN

ON BASKETBALL

Tatum has 'a totally different perspective'

CHARLESTON, S.C. — The Celtics will embark on a new era Thursday at Rocket Arena in Cleveland, opening up the preseason with a revamped roster led by a healthy Jayson Tatum, who has spent the past five months feverishly working his body into pre-injury form.

This time last year, Tatum was beginning to do light running, five months removed from surgery to repair an Achilles rupture. While his teammates were training for the season, Tatum was on his own workout schedule, simply trying to regain confidence and strength in his right leg, feeling like an outsider because his body would not allow anything more than just than a light jog or small jumps.

Fast forward to this week at The Citadel, Tatum is working with assistant coach Tony Dobbins on post-ups and pick-and-roll jumpers. The burst is there. The confidence is back. The role is larger with the departure of Jaylen Brown, and Tatum said he is more reflective on those day-to-day experiences now that he's in Year 10.

He is approaching the second half of his career and nothing is promised to high-usage NBA players when they hit 30. Very few stories turn out to be as illustrious as LeBron James or even Tatum's hero, Kobe Bryant, who each logged two decades in the game.

"It's a totally different perspective," Tatum said of this training camp. "Last year was really tough for me. I kind of remember these days of training camp [last year] and I would be in the weight room the whole time watching the team practice. It was just tough to digest and go through it.

"So now being on this side and knowing what it felt like to have to watch the whole time. It's a different level of appreciation of being a part of everything and the game that I love with my teammates, it's a different type of joy that I have now than I did my first eight seasons."

That joy has spread to the golf course, where Tatum has become an avid golfer, organizing outings with his teammates, including a nine-hole stop at Bulls Bay Golf Club on Monday. The coherent theme of training camp has been galvanizing off the floor, enjoying teammates' company and capitalizing on time away from Boston.

It appears the shock and disbelief from the Brown trade has dissipated, replaced by the embrace of this new reality with the likes of Paul George, Mitchell Robinson, and Mike Conley. Tatum is at the head of this campaign to bond, knowing how critical chemistry will be to having a better than projected season.

"It's really allowed us even more of an opportunity to connect with each other — team dinners, team activities, watch football together, golf, practice," Tatum said of the stretch in South Carolina. "Just another really good opportunity to get to know each other. We can still hang out in Boston but everybody's got their lives, kids. Now we're in a different environment, a different city and it's just us. It gives us an opportunity to get to know each other better."

Tatum got an opportunity to share court time with George over the past 10 days and that combination will be critical to the Celtics' success. Tatum said last month that he was a George fan during his younger days and adopted some of the nine-time All-Star's moves. Their first noted one-on-one clash on the floor occurred on Nov. 20, 2019, when a third-year Tatum traveled to Los Angeles to play George's Clippers.

With 13.1 seconds left in regulation, Tatum took a dribble handoff from Marcus Smart, drove right, gave a shoulder to George, who fell on his backside and then drained a tying 3-pointer.

While it appeared Tatum stepped on George's foot, the two had different perspectives of the play.

"Yeah I stepped on his foot," Tatum said. "Inadvertently, I didn't try to. I stepped on his foot when I made the move. I remember that was the first time Kawhi [Leonard] and PG played together that season. I just remember it was a fun game, overtime game. I just learned a lot from it."

When asked about the crossover, George offered all credit to Tatum.

"No [he didn't step on my foot], I can't take that away from him," George said. "He got me on a good play. He was strong. I didn't understand how strong he was. So he had me off balance, and how strong his body is, it knocked me back. And so I can't take nothing away from that. That was just a great play, and that was his arrival."

Tatum vividly recalled that game, it's significance and how it elevated his NBA status. And it's those moments he cherishes more since the game was briefly taken away from him.

"I just remember it like a big-time game," he said. "That was my first time I made All-NBA, first time I made All-Star that year. I very much felt like I was coming into my own that year when I was coming in to the level where I could compete with the other best players in the world."

Gary Washburn is a Globe columnist. He can be reached at gary.washburn@globe.com. Follow him @GwashburnGlobe.

Sturm reshuffles lines to try to spark Bruins

▶BRUINS
Continued from Page C1

day] when we wake up and meet again with the coaching staff and see if we like it or not and go from there."

Sturm believes in consistency but acknowledged that with a shorter training camp schedule — the first practice was just three weeks ago — and several new faces in the lineup, it's been challenging finding clicking combinations. He warned, however, that it's too early to be jumping to too many conclusions.

"I also looked back a year ago, we talked [a lot] about the [consistency of the] Zacha line with [Viktor] Arvidsson and Mittelstadt. That was not after [one] game. [It was after] eight or nine [when they clicked]," said Sturm. "So, we've still got time to try things out. It's not going to happen overnight. It's hopefully with that short training camp, hopefully in the next little while it's going to play out and hopefully there's some lines or pairs who are going to come up and shine and will be good for our hockey team because we need it. We're just, like everyone else, we're just trying to figure it out right now and see how it goes."

Zacha has moved around plenty during his time in Boston. From wing to center and from line to line. He has plenty of minutes with Pastrnak and said, "We know where we are on the ice, we know how to play together."

That history should make for an easy transition.

"I'm lucky I've been able to play with most of the guys, most of the wingers ... I think we have a great winger group, so whoever you get as a center there to play with, it's great," said Zacha. "We just have to find chemistry in a way that [will help us] be more connected on the ice."

Zacha, who is coming off a season in which he had career highs in goals (30) and points (65), has been snakebitten this season. He's created chances and gotten some good looks but has yet to collect a point.

He said it's important not to put added pressure on yourself when the puck isn't going in.

"I think if you see we score only two goals in four games, you want to be that guy to help the team," said Zacha. "But on the other hand, it's still the start of the season. I've played in the league for a while, so I know there's ups and downs with points. It's just all you can control a little bit. If you play good, if you create chances, it's going to come eventually. Every season has ups and downs a little bit with points. And I just need to find a way to keep creating and not get frustrated with it."

One of the more intriguing changes is Hagens swapping from left wing to right. Sturm was hoping it will open up some shooting space for the rookie.

"With him, he ends up for some reason on that side. Anyway, even when I watched him at Boston College, as a centerman or when he played left wing, I feel like he likes that right side anyway," said Sturm. "Maybe on the right side it gives him a better opportunity to shoot more pucks."

. . .

Rookie defenseman Frederic Brunet worked as the quarterback on the top power-play unit. Boston is 0 for 10 with the man advantage. "We tried Bruno out the last game a little bit and he was fine," said Sturm. "It's just when the power play is struggling, most of the time you want to try something different, and he was good. So, he is going to get some action [against Utah] and we'll see how he does." Brunet received some pointers from Charlie McAvoy, who will assume that role next week in San Jose after his suspension ends . . . Peterka, who played for the Mammoth last season, led the pre- and post-practice stretches.

Jim McBride can be reached at james.mcbride@globe.com. Follow him @globejimmcbride.

Mammoth thumbnails

- **When, where:** Thursday, 7 p.m., at TD Garden.
- **TV, radio:** NESN, WBZ-FM (98.5).
- **Goals:** Nick Schmaltz 5, Dylan Guenther 3, nine players tied with 1.
- **Assists:** Clayton Keller 6, Mikhail Sergachev 5, Logan Cooley 4.
- **Goaltending:** Karel Vejmelka (2-1-0, 2.02 GAA), Sebastian Cossa (1-0-0, 1.00).
- **Head to head:** This is the first of two meetings. Boston went 1-1 vs. Utah last season.
- **Miscellany:** Utah (3-0-1) entered Wednesday atop the Central Division . . . Schmaltz entered Wednesday leading the NHL in goals . . . Utah entered Wednesday with the top power play (61.5 percent) in the NHL and the fourth-best penalty kill (92.9 percent) . . . Sergachev exited Tuesday's win over the Devils after being struck in the back of the helmet by a puck.

JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Pavel Zacha (above) will center Morgan Geekie and David Pastrnak in a reunion of the Bruins' top line.

WNBA SEMIFINALS

Reese, Hillmon lead Dream to OT win

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Angel Reese scored 23 points, **Naz Hillmon** made the go-ahead layup with 20.8 seconds left in overtime, and the Dream beat the Liberty, 101-98, Wednesday night in Atlanta to take a 2-0 lead in the best-of-five WNBA semifinal series.

Reese scored 6 of her team's 13 points in overtime. She made two free throws with 4.3 seconds left after **Sabrina Ionescu** overthrew a pass as the Dream moved within one win of their first WNBA Finals appearance since 2013.

Jordin Canada also scored 23 points and had eight assists for Atlanta.

Breanna Stewart scored 35 points for the Liberty, including 25 in the first half. She missed a desperation attempt on the final play.

New York hosts Game 3 on Friday.

With the Liberty trailing, 86-80, with under two minutes remaining in regulation, Ionescu cut the deficit in half with a deep 3-pointer.

An Atlanta shot clock violation with 31 seconds remaining opened the door for the Liberty to get closer, and Stewart hit a quick layup in traffic to make it 86-85.

JONATHAN BACHMAN/GETTY IMAGES

Angel Reese's 23 points for the Dream in Game 2 included 6 of the team's 13 in overtime.

After New York fouled to extend the game, Reese knocked down both free throws to give the Dream an 88-85 advantage with 14.5 seconds left. **Marine Fauthoux** knocked down the game-tying 3-pointer with 10.3 seconds to go, boiling the game down to one final Atlanta possession.

Rhyne Howard's midrange floater rimmed out just before the buzzer, sending the game to overtime.

Valkyries in command

Tiffany Hayes scored 21 points off the bench, **Gabby Williams** was right behind with 20, and the Valkyries held off a late charge by the defending champion Aces to win, 83-81, in San Francisco and take a commanding 2-0 lead in their semifinal series.

Former Newton South star **Veronica Burton** hit a deep 3-pointer that put Golden State ahead with 41 seconds left and converted two free throws in the closing seconds.

Las Vegas outscored Golden State, 26-17, in the fourth quarter and in a wild finish, **Jackie Young** missed the second of two free throws with six seconds left to give the visitors one last chance. **Chelsea Gray** grabbed the rebound and droved under the basket for a layup attempt. **Kiah Stokes** blocked the shot and Burton corralled the ball. Burton then held possession until the final buzzer sounded.

A'ja Wilson had 24 points to lead Las Vegas.

The Aces will look to stay alive in the series in Game 3 on Friday at home.

NHL

EASTERN CONFERENCE

ATLANTIC	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Florida	4	2	0	2	6	2	8	8
Ottawa	3	2	1	0	4	2	10	8
Tampa Bay	3	2	1	0	4	2	8	7
Buffalo	3	2	1	0	4	2	10	11
Toronto	4	2	2	0	4	2	11	11
Boston	4	2	2	0	4	2	9	11
Montreal	3	1	1	1	3	1	12	14
Detroit	3	1	2	0	2	1	7	8
METROPOLITAN	**GP**	**W**	**L**	**OL**	**Pts.**	**ROW**	**GF**	**GA**
NY Rangers	5	4	1	0	8	4	16	8
Carolina	4	2	1	1	5	2	11	12
Washington	3	2	1	0	4	2	11	8
Pittsburgh	4	2	2	0	4	2	18	13
Columbus	2	1	1	0	2	1	7	7
NY Islanders	3	1	2	0	2	1	9	7
New Jersey	3	1	2	0	2	1	6	13
Philadelphia	4	0	2	2	2	0	5	17

WESTERN CONFERENCE

CENTRAL	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Winnipeg	4	3	0	1	7	3	12	10
Utah	4	3	1	0	6	3	17	8
Minnesota	3	2	0	1	5	2	9	5
Colorado	3	2	1	0	4	2	16	8
Nashville	3	1	1	1	3	1	7	9
Dallas	3	1	2	0	2	1	6	6
St. Louis	3	1	2	0	2	1	7	10
Chicago	4	1	3	0	2	1	9	17
PACIFIC	**GP**	**W**	**L**	**OL**	**Pts.**	**ROW**	**GF**	**GA**
Vegas	4	3	1	0	6	3	17	10
*Edmonton	3	2	0	1	5	2	17	14
*Anaheim	2	2	0	0	4	2	7	5
San Jose	3	2	1	0	4	2	9	12
Seattle	4	2	2	0	4	2	15	11
Vancouver	4	2	2	0	4	2	19	18
Los Angeles	3	0	2	1	1	0	9	15
Calgary	3	0	3	0	0	0	3	16

* — Not including late game; ROW — Regulation plus overtime wins

WEDNESDAY'S RESULTS

At Washington 5	Pittsburgh 3	Edmonton	at Anaheim
At Winnipeg 3	Colorado 2		

THURSDAY'S GAMES

Utah at Boston	7	Vancouver at Carolina	7
Philadelphia at Ottawa	7	Chicago at NY Islanders	7:30
Minnesota at Tampa Bay	7	San Jose at St. Louis	8
Nashville at Montreal	7	Colorado at Calgary	9
Dallas at Buffalo	7	Toronto at Vegas	10

TUESDAY'S RESULTS

Carolina 6	at Montreal 4	At NY Rangers 5	NY Islanders 2
Utah 5	at New Jersey 3	At Chicago 4	St. Louis 2
At Detroit 5	Ottawa 3	Vegas 6	at Seattle 2
At Toronto 5	Nashville 4 (OT)	Florida 2	at Los Angeles 1
At Buffalo 3	Minnesota 2 (OT)		

CAPITALS 5, PENGUINS 3

Pittsburgh	1	2	0	— 3
Washington	2	2	1	— 5

First period — 1. Washington, Beauvillier 1 (Strome), 0:23. 2. Pittsburgh, Rust 1 (Kindel, Girard), 1:19. 3. Washington, Wilson 1 (Dubois), 11:51. Penalties — Koivunen, PIT (tripping), 5:31. Robertson, PIT (delay of game), 6:47. Leonard, WSH (roughing), 13:45.

Second period — 4. Washington, Dubois 1 (Wilson), 4:42. 5. Washington, Tuch 3 (Wilson), 13:14. 6. Pittsburgh, Novak 3, 14:05. 7. Pittsburgh, Robertson 3 (Korczak, Lizotte), 18:01. Penalties — Chychrun, WSH (holding), 18:53.

Third period — 8. Washington, Leonard 2 (Kyrou, Hutson), 3:55 (pp). Penalties — van Riemsdyk, PIT (hooking), 1:58. Lizotte, PIT (tripping), 6:55. Dubois, WSH (boarding), 10:38. Chychrun, WSH (slashing), 20:00.

Shots on goal — Pittsburgh 4-13-13 — 30. Washington 14-5-8 — 27.

Power plays — Pittsburgh 0-3; Washington 1-4.

Goalies — Pittsburgh, Silovs 2-1-0 (27 shots-22 saves). Washington, Thompson 2-0-0 (30 shots-27 saves).

Referees — Garrett Rank, Kelly Sutherland. Linesmen — Kilian McNamara, Libor Suchanek.

A — 18,347 (18,398). T — 2:28.

JETS 3, AVALANCHE 2

Colorado	0	1	1	— 2
Winnipeg	0	2	1	— 3

First period — None. Penalties — Samberg, WPG (hooking), 9:26. Svechkov, COL (delay of game), 16:39.

Second period — 1. Colorado, Schwartz 1 (Svechkov, Burns), 2:51. 2. Winnipeg, Connor 4 (Pionk, Samberg), 4:01. 3. Winnipeg, Perfetti 3 (Samberg, Scheifele), 18:16. Penalties — None.

Third period — 4. Colorado, Svechkov 1 (Schwartz, Kulak), 12:35. 5. Winnipeg, Connor 5 (Scheifele), 19:00. Penalties — Nelson, COL (cross check), 8:19.

Shots on goal — Colorado 17-10-7 — 34. Winnipeg 6-11-2 — 19.

Power plays — Colorado 0-1; Winnipeg 0-2.

Goalies — Colorado, Blackwood 2-1-0 (19 shots-16 saves). Winnipeg, Skinner 2-0-1 (34 shots-32 saves).

Referees — Graham Skilliter, Furman South. Linesmen — Trent Knorr, Jesse Marquis.

A — 14,006 (15,294). T — 2:35.

PANTHERS 2, KINGS 1

Tuesday night game

Florida	0	1	1	— 2
Los Angeles	1	0	0	— 1

First period — 1. Los Angeles, Laferriere 1 (Haula), 19:00. Penalties — Anderson, LAK (roughing), 10:03. Luostarinen, FLA (tripping), 15:37. Luostarinen, FLA (interference), 19:04. Kulikov, FLA, double minor (high stick), 19:43.

Second period — 2. Florida, Jones 1 (Eller), 3:49. Penalties — Turcotte, LAK (tripping), 5:19. Hathaway, FLA, major (fighting), 7:40. Edmundson, LAK, major (fighting), 7:40. Clarke, LAK (interference), 8:53. Clarke, LAK, double minor (high stick), 19:07.

Third period — 3. Florida, MaTkachuk 2 (Bennett), 11:20. Penalties — Panarin, LAK (tripping), 6:33. Bennett, FLA (slashing), 6:37.

Shots on goal — Florida 7-12-9 — 28. Los Angeles 6-10-4 — 20.

Power plays — Florida 0-6; Los Angeles 0-5.

Goalies — Florida, Markstrom 2-0-1 (20 shots-19 saves). Los Angeles, Kuemper 0-2-0 (28 shots-26 saves).

Referees — Tom Chmielewski, Jordan Samuels Thomas. Linesmen — James Tobias, Daniel Kelly.

A — 18,145 (18,230). T — 2:41.

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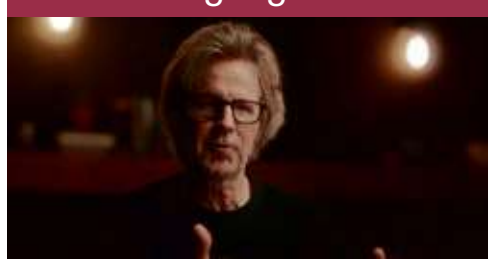

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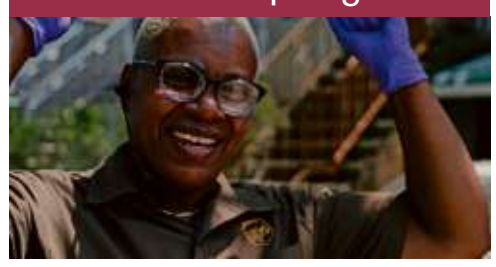

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Baseball

NOTEBOOK

Rays complete sweep of Yankees to reach ALCS

Mesa's first homer in postseason proves to be pivotal in 4-3 win

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Victor Mesa Jr. hit a tiebreaking, two-run homer off **Max Fried** in the sixth inning, and the Rays beat the Yankees, 4-3, on Wednesday night in New York with the help of a fan interference call for a three-game sweep of their AL Division Series.

Ryan Vilade also homered for the Rays, who reached the AL Championship Series for the first time since 2020 and host the White Sox or Guardians in the opener Monday.

After Mesa's first career postseason homer gave the Rays a 4-2 lead, **Anthony Volpe** appeared to hit a two-run shot against **Griffin Jax** with two outs in the bottom half as a fan reached over the left-field wall and caught the ball over the glove of a leaping Mesa.

A video review determined the ball would not have been over the wall and would not have been caught by Mesa. Volpe was awarded an RBI double and **George Lombard Jr.** was allowed to score from first. Jax recovered to strike out **Spencer Jones**.

Baseball's adaptation of video technology was key to the inning.

Lombard reached with a one-out walk when a 3-1 pitch called a strike by plate umpire **Dan Bellino** was ruled inside on an ABS challenge. **Austin Wells** then walked on full-count changeup but an ABS challenge by Rays catcher **Liam Hicks** ruled the pitch caught the inside corner for a strikeout, bringing up Volpe.

Quite a change from 1996, when umpires did not have technology to assist and **Derek Jeter's** homer for the Yankees helped turn around the ALCS opener despite **Jeffrey Meier** reaching over the right-field wall where the Orioles' **Tony Tarasco** was set to catch the ball. MLB began using video for home run calls in 2008 and allowed challenges to ball/strike decisions starting this year.

Ian Seymour, the former Saint John's of Shrewsbury standout, pitched 1⅓ scoreless innings, **Kevin Kelly** struck out pinch-hitter **Giancarlo Stanton** to strand a runner in the eighth and **Bryan Baker** pitched the ninth for his third save of the series.

Seeking its first World Series title, the Rays celebrated on the field of the big-spending Yankees for the second time in two weeks after clinching the AL East on Sept. 22. The Yankees opened the season with MLB's third-highest payroll at $303 million while the Rays were 26th at $91 million.

Swept in a best-of-five postseason matchup for the first time since the 1980 ALCS against the Royals, the Yankees ended their 17th straight season without a World Series crown. That equaled their longest drought since winning their first championship in 1923, a gap between titles in 1978 and '96.

Yankees captain **Aaron Judge** missed the postseason after straining a calf Sept. 16. The three-time AL MVP played just seven games after May 31 because of a fractured rib and the leg injury, an absence the team couldn't overcome.

CALEB BOWLIN/GETTY IMAGES

Junior Caminero, who singled and scored in the sixth inning, celebrated after the Rays made the final out of an ALDS sweep of the Yankees.

After sweeping the Red Sox in the Wild Card Series, the Yankees never led against the Rays and have not advanced past a higher-seeded team in the postseason since 2020.

Guardians force Game 4

Jo Adell and **José Ramírez** powered the Guardians with a pair of two-out triples to avoid a sweep in the other AL Division Series by cooling off the White Sox with a 9-3 victory in Game 3 in Chicago.

Adell's three-run triple gave Cleveland a 4-1 lead in the third inning. Ramírez's three-bagger drove in **Travis Bazzana** and **Patrick Bailey** for a 7-3 advantage in the eighth.

"We continued to pile on," said Guardians manager **Stephen Vogt**. "I think that's been the difference of the first couple games to today was Game 2, we were able to get a couple runs but weren't able to add on. But really good job by our guys today."

The Guardians hit two triples in a postseason game for the first time in franchise history. They became the first major league team to accomplish the feat since the Dodgers in Game 1 of the 2024 World Series against the Yankees.

Adell, Ramírez, Bailey, and **Brayan Rocchio** each had two of the team's 11 hits — a complete turnaround for the AL Central champions after they managed just three runs and seven hits in the first two games of the series combined.

Game 4 is Thursday in Chicago, with the White Sox leading, 2-1, in the best-of-five matchup. Once again, they'll try to clinch a postseason series at home for the first time since the 1906 World Series against the Chicago Cubs.

"Today has nothing to do with tomorrow. Nothing," said White Sox catcher **Kyle Teel** said. "We come ready to go like we always do tomorrow."

The White Sox struck out 19 times and went 2 for 11 with runners in position. Their bullpen faltered after coming up big during their fast postseason start.

Dodgers advance to NLCS

Andy Pages drove in two runs with a bases-loaded single in the seventh inning to help the Dodgers surge to the lead in a 4-1 victory over the Braves to clinch their NL Division Series.

The Dodgers won back-to-back games in Atlanta to take the best-of-five matchup, 3-1, and advance to the NLCS as they seek to become the first NL team to win three straight World Series. They await the Padres-Brewers series winner.

Pages lined a 3-2 pitch from Robert Suarez up the middle to drive in **Teoscar Hernández**, who singled off starter **Tyler Mahle**, and pinch-runner **Tommy Edman** for a 3-1 lead. **Didier Fuentes** walked pinch-hitter **Josue De Paula** and **Kyle Tucker** to load the bases. Edman ran for De Paula.

Max Muncy's solo shot off **Raisel Iglesias** in the ninth padded the lead and gave the slugger 19 postseason homers with the Dodgers, extending his franchise record.

Dodgers righthander **Tyler Glasnow**, making his first start since Sept. 24, allowed only one hit but walked five batters in 4⅔ innings. After he issued two walks in the fifth, lefthander **Alex Vesia** ended the inning on **Matt Olson's** groundout to second base.

The missed opportunity left the Braves with 18 walks in the series, and none scored.

Glasnow and four relievers combined to give up just three hits. **Tanner Scott** pitched a perfect eighth before **Edwin Díaz** got three quick outs for the save.

Cora: no interest in Philly

Former Red Sox manager **Alex Cora** will not pursue the Phillies managerial opening, according to USA Today. He told Phillies president of baseball operations **Dave Dombrowski** he is opting to sit out next season despite interest in the position.

Cora was offered the Phillies job in April but told Dombrowski he wanted to spend the rest of the summer with his family.

The Red Sox fired Cora on April 25 after the team got off to a 10-17 start. He was 620-541 as Red Sox manager, taking the job before the 2018 season and leading the team to the World Series championship that fall.

THURSDAY'S GAME

	Odds	2026 W-L	2026 ERA	Team rec.	2026 vs. opp. W-L	2026 vs. opp. IP	2026 vs. opp. ERA	Last 3 starts W-L	Last 3 starts IP	Last 3 starts ERA
CLEVELAND AT CHICAGO WHITE SOX, 5 p.m.										
Messick (L)	-115	12-9	2.56	18-15	2-1	25.2	2.81	0-1	12.1	2.92
TBA	-105	—	—	0-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	0.0	—

Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season

Baseball playoffs

Division series

American League

CHICAGO WHITE SOX VS. CLEVELAND

White Sox lead series, 2-1
Saturday, Oct. 3
Chicago White Sox 3.....at Cleveland 0
Monday, Oct. 5
Chicago White Sox 4.....at Cleveland 3
Wednesday, Oct. 7
Cleveland 9.....at Chicago White Sox 3
Schedule
Thu., Oct. 8 at Chicago White Sox.....5
*Sat., Oct. 10 at Cleveland.....5

NY YANKEES VS. TAMPA BAY

Rays win series, 3-0
Saturday, Oct. 3
At Tampa Bay 1.....NY Yankees 0
Monday, Oct. 5
At Tampa Bay 5.....NY Yankees 2
Wednesday, Oct. 7
Tampa Bay 4.....at NY Yankees 3

National League

ATLANTA VS. LA DODGERS

Dodgers win series, 3-1
Saturday, Oct. 3
At LA Dodgers 5.....Atlanta 3
Sunday, Oct. 4
Atlanta 3.....at LA Dodgers 2
Tuesday, Oct. 6
LA Dodgers 3.....at Atlanta 1
Wednesday, Oct. 7
LA Dodgers 4.....at Atlanta 1

SAN DIEGO VS. MILWAUKEE

Brewers lead series, 2-1
Saturday, Oct. 3
At Milwaukee 3.....San Diego 2
Sunday, Oct. 4
At Milwaukee 4.....San Diego 3
Tuesday, Oct. 6
At San Diego 4.....Milwaukee 3
Wednesday, Oct. 7
Milwaukee.....at San Diego
Schedule
*Fri., Oct. 9 at Milwaukee.....4:30

* If necessary

RAYS 4, YANKEES 3

TAMPA BAY	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Díaz dh	4	0	1	0	0	2	.250
Aranda 1b	3	0	1	1	0	0	.333
Caminero 3b	4	1	1	0	0	1	.300
Mesa Jr. lf	4	1	1	2	0	2	.200
Vilade rf	2	1	1	1	0	0	.500
Mullins ph-cf	2	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Hicks c	4	0	0	0	0	2	.100
DeLuca cf-rf	3	1	1	0	0	0	.200
Palacios 2b	3	0	0	0	0	2	.200
Walls ss	3	0	1	0	0	0	.100
Totals	**32**	**4**	**7**	**4**	**0**	**9**	

NY YANKEES	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Grisham cf	5	0	0	0	0	3	.000
Rice dh	4	0	1	1	0	2	.300
García Jr. 1b	3	0	1	0	0	1	.100
Goldschmidt ph-1b	1	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Bellinger lf	4	0	0	0	0	0	.083
Lombard Jr. ss	3	1	2	0	1	0	.200
AuWells c	3	0	0	0	0	1	.222
Stanton ph	1	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Sánchez c	0	0	0	0	0	0	—
Volpe 2b-3b	4	1	2	1	0	2	.500
Jones rf	2	1	1	1	2	1	.111
Caballero 3b	2	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Chisholm Jr. ph-2b	2	0	0	0	0	0	.000
Totals	**34**	**3**	**7**	**3**	**3**	**12**	

Tampa Bay.....001 102 000 — 4 7 1
NY Yankees.....001 101 000 — 3 7 0

E—Caminero (1). **LOB**—Tampa Bay 2, NY Yankees 7. **2B**—Volpe (1), Jones (1). **HR**—Mesa Jr. (1), off Fried, Vilade (1), off Fried. **SB**—Chisholm Jr. (2). **DP**—Tampa Bay 1; NY Yankees 1.

Tampa Bay	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Martinez	3⅔	5	2	2	1	3	4.91
Seymour W 1-0	1⅓	1	0	0	0	2	2.08
Jax	2	1	1	1	1	4	4.50
Booser	⅔	0	0	0	0	0	0.00
Kelly	⅓	0	0	0	0	1	0.00
Baker S 3	1	0	0	0	1	2	0.00

NY Yankees	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Fried L 0-1	5⅔	7	4	4	0	7	6.35
Blackburn	1⅔	0	0	0	0	0	0.00
Bednar	1⅔	0	0	0	0	2	0.00

Inherited runners-scored—Seymour 1-1, Kelly 1-0. **HBP**—by Bednar (Aranda). **NP**—Martinez 63, Seymour 23, Jax 32, Booser 8, Kelly 5, Baker 17, Fried 80, Blackburn 7, Bednar 22. **Umpires**—Home, Dan Bellino; First, Ben May; Second, D.J. Reyburn; Third, Ryan Wills; Left, Shane Livensparger; Right, Jeremie Rehak. **T**—3:04. **A**—48,865 (46,672).

DODGERS 4, BRAVES 1

LA DODGERS	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Betts ss	4	0	0	0	0	0	.214
Freeman 1b	4	0	0	0	0	0	.267
WillSmith c	4	0	0	0	0	2	.063
Ohtani dh	3	1	0	0	1	1	.154
THernández lf	4	1	1	0	0	2	.188
HyKim 2b	0	0	0	0	0	0	—
Muncy 3b	4	1	1	1	0	0	.250
KHernández 2b	2	0	0	0	0	0	.167
De Paula ph	0	0	0	0	1	0	.000
Edman pr-2b-lf	1	1	0	0	0	0	.000
Tucker rf	3	0	1	0	1	0	.333
Pages cf	3	0	2	2	0	0	.286
Totals	**32**	**4**	**5**	**3**	**3**	**5**	

ATLANTA	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Harris II cf	3	1	2	0	1	1	.375
Acuña Jr. rf	3	0	0	0	1	2	.133
Olson 1b	4	0	0	0	0	1	.125
Albies 2b	4	0	1	0	0	0	.200
Baldwin dh	4	0	0	0	0	2	.071
Yastrzemski lf	1	0	0	0	1	0	.000
LaneThomas ph-lf	1	0	0	0	0	0	.143
Tellez ph	1	0	0	0	0	1	.000
Dubón ss	3	0	0	0	1	0	.154
Riley 3b	3	0	0	0	1	1	.000
SeaMurphy c	3	0	0	0	0	0	.143
Totals	**30**	**1**	**3**	**0**	**5**	**8**	

LA Dodgers.....010 000 201 — 4 5 0
Atlanta.....100 000 000 — 1 3 2

E—Dubón (1), SeaMurphy (1). **LOB**—LA Dodgers 4, Atlanta 7. **2B**—Harris II (2), Albies (2). **HR**—Muncy (3), off Iglesias. **SB**—Ohtani (1), Harris II (1). **DP**—Atlanta 1.

LA Dodgers	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Glasnow	4⅔	1	1	1	5	5	1.93
Vesia	⅔	1	0	0	0	0	0.00
Henriquez W 1-0	1⅔	1	0	0	0	0	3.38
Scott	1	0	0	0	0	2	6.75
Díaz S 2	1	0	0	0	0	1	0.00

Atlanta	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Mahle L 0-1	6⅓	3	2	1	1	4	1.42
Fuentes	⅓	0	1	1	2	0	4.50
Suarez	⅓	1	0	0	0	0	0.00
Lee	1	0	0	0	0	1	0.00
Iglesias	1	1	1	1	0	0	3.86

Inherited runners-scored—Vesia 2-0, Henriquez 1-0, Fuentes 1-0, Suarez 3-2. **WP**—Glasnow. **NP**—Glasnow 78, Vesia 9, Henriquez 15, Scott 13, Díaz 8, Mahle 85, Fuentes 14, Suarez 8, Lee 16, Iglesias 17. **Umpires**—Home, Tripp Gibson; First, Jim Wolf; Second, Mike Estabrook; Third, Roberto Ortiz; Left, Chris Guccione; Right, James Hoye. **T**—2:54. **A**—41,173 (40,819).

GUARDIANS 9, WHITE SOX 3

CLEVELAND	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Kwan cf-lf	6	1	1	1	0	1	.154
Ramírez 3b	4	2	2	2	1	0	.200
DeLauter rf	4	1	1	1	1	0	.250
Adell dh	4	0	2	3	1	1	.273
Lowe 1b	2	1	0	0	3	0	.125
Martínez lf	4	0	0	0	0	3	.000
Halpin cf	0	1	0	0	1	0	—
Bazzana 2b	2	2	0	0	2	0	.111
Genao 2b	1	0	1	1	0	0	1.000
Bailey c	4	1	2	0	1	1	.333
Rocchio ss	4	0	2	1	0	0	.222
Totals	**35**	**9**	**11**	**9**	**10**	**6**	

WHITE SOX	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.
Antonacci dh	2	1	1	1	1	1	.143
Vargas 3b	4	0	1	0	1	2	.375
Murakami 1b	4	0	0	0	0	3	.250
Teel c	4	0	1	1	0	2	.182
Meidroth 2b	4	1	1	0	0	2	.250
Peters cf	4	0	1	1	0	3	.250
BMontgomery rf	3	1	0	0	1	2	.100
Grichuk lf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.143
CMontgomery ss	3	0	0	0	0	3	.222
Totals	**32**	**3**	**6**	**3**	**3**	**19**	

Cleveland.....004 010 022 — 9 11 0
Chicago.....100 101 000 — 3 6 0

LOB—Cleveland 10, Chicago 8. **2B**—Ramírez (1), Genao (1), Teel (1), Meidroth (1), Peters (1). **3B**—Ramírez (1), Adell (2). **SB**—Ramírez (1), Rocchio (1). **S**—Rocchio. **DP**—Cleveland 1; Chicago 3.

Cleveland	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Espino	⅔	2	1	1	1	2	6.75
Griffin W 1-0	2⅔	2	1	1	0	7	3.38
Armstrong	⅔	0	0	0	0	1	0.00
Cantillo	1⅔	1	1	1	2	1	5.40
Gaddis	⅓	1	0	0	0	0	0.00
Herrin	1	0	0	0	0	3	0.00
CaSmith	2	0	0	0	0	5	0.00

Chicago	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Newcomb	2	1	0	0	0	1	0.00
Hudson L 1-1	⅓	2	3	3	1	0	40.50
HaSmith	⅔	1	1	1	2	1	2.70
Schultz	3	2	1	1	2	1	3.00
Davis	1	1	0	0	1	1	0.00
Sandlin	1	2	2	2	2	1	18.00
Martin	1	2	2	2	2	1	18.00

Inherited runners-scored—Griffin 2-0, Armstrong 1-0, Gaddis 1-1, HaSmith 2-2. **IBB**—off Sandlin (DeLauter). **HBP**—by Griffin (Antonacci), by Gaddis (Antonacci, CMontgomery). **Balk**—Davis. **WP**—Schultz. **NP**—Espino 20, Griffin 53, Armstrong 5, Cantillo 25, Gaddis 12, Herrin 18, CaSmith 19, Newcomb 22, Hudson 16, HaSmith 21, Schultz 45, Davis 21, Sandlin 22, Martin 31. **Umpires**—Home, Todd Tichenor; First, Jansen Visconti; Second, Vic Carapazza; Third, Tom Hanahan; Left, Cory Blaser; Right, Gabe Morales. **T**—3:16. **A**—40,590 (40,615).

Red Sox roster reset: Work cut out to make '27 improvements

▶RED SOX
Continued from Page C1

"I don't know," Gray said last week, after he was pulled in the fifth inning of what became the Red Sox' last game of the year.

Of note: Gray is not eligible for the qualifying offer, a one-year contract worth the mean salary of the 125 highest-paid players. He received the qualifying offer from the Twins (and declined it) after the 2023 season, and players are allowed to be tagged with it only once in their careers.

The Red Sox don't have any qualifying-offer candidates.

Kiner-Falefa was about what the Red Sox thought he would be when they signed him to a one-year, $6 million contract in February: a capable glove-first utility infielder (who provided an offensive boost during a monthlong stretch into mid-June). Although he expressed enjoyment regarding his time with the Sox, including an interest in continuing Driveline-inspired hitting training methods, the Red Sox have a bunch of utility types who can fill his role.

Sandoval wound up making more than $1.2 million per appearance on his two-year, $18.5 million deal.

Players who have contract options (1): Garrett Whitlock.

The guaranteed seasons on Whitlock's four-year contract are over. The Red Sox hold an option worth $8.25 million ($1 million buyout) on his deal for 2027. That would seem to be an easy call, given the going rate for high-end setup relievers, but the Sox have until early November before they need to decide.

(Whitlock's deal also contains a $10.5 million team option for 2028, but they can figure that out next year.)

Players who are under contract (10): Trevor Story, Garrett Crochet, Masataka Yoshida, Willson Contreras, Aroldis Chapman, Ranger Suarez, Brayan Bello, Roman Anthony, Ceddanne Rafaela, Kristian Campbell.

How much production the Red Sox get from this group is anybody's guess. Earning a collective $169 million, as calculated for the current luxury-tax system, they will go a long way toward determining the club's 2027 fate.

There is a mix of theoretical cornerstones who spent most of 2026 injured (Crochet and Anthony), players in their mid-30s entering the last year of a contract (Story and Yoshida), All-Stars at risk of age-related regression (Contreras and Chapman), total enigmas (Bello and Campbell), the least-stressed pitcher you'll ever see (Suarez), and an elite center fielder whose September leg issues are a footnote for now (Rafaela).

Chapman, who will be 39 next season, triggered the vesting option in his contract by reaching 40 innings (finishing at 51⅔) and passing his end-of-season physical. He may well be Breslow's best free agent signing through three years on the job.

Players who are eligible for arbitration (17): Jarren Duran ($11.1 million), Adley Rutschman ($9.1m), Tanner Houck ($4.1m), Kutter Crawford ($2.8m), Triston Casas ($1.7m), Romy Gonzalez ($1.8m), Johan Oviedo ($1.8m), Connor Wong ($2m), Wilyer Abreu ($4.6m), Andruw Monasterio ($1.6m), Greg Weissert ($1.2m), Justin Slaten ($1.2m), Tyron Guerrero ($1.1m), Jahmai Jones ($900,000), Zack Kelly ($800,000), Erik Miller ($1.5m), Eli White ($1.4m). Arbitration projections via MLBTradeRumors.com.

This is a massive group of arbitration-eligible players, who don't have signed contracts or agreed-upon salaries but are under the team's contractual control. The Red Sox are tied with the Rays for the most such players in baseball. They likely will prune this list a bit by the time the arbitration process begins (which normally is in January but will be later than that this time, assuming the lockout still will be in effect).

Among the most interesting names: Duran, who is due a raise from the $7.7 million he earned in 2026, even though his poor season represented another major step backward from his 2024 peak. The Red Sox and Duran have a history of sorting out salary stuff without needing arbitration.

And then there is Rutschman, who is heading into a contract year. He is positioned to be the Red Sox' most significant pending free agent in 2027 — unless the sides agree to an extension before then.

"When we acquired Adley, we did so because he was a really good player, at a position of need [catcher], and we felt like he could add to our 2026 outlook," Breslow said. "Obviously, he's under control for 2027, which is great. Beyond that, I think best just to keep conversations between Adley and me."

Players who are not yet eligible for arbitration (16): Caleb Durbin, Jovani Moran, Anthony Seigler, Jake Bennett, Raymond Burgos, Tsung-Che Cheng, Nate Eaton, Alec Gamboa, Mickey Gasper, Curtis Mead, Wyatt Olds, Jedixson Paez, Eduardo Rivera, Tyler Samaniego, Nick Sogard, Payton Tolle.

These players — known as pre-arbitration or 0-to-3 players — have fewer than three years of service time in the majors. They have no leverage regarding or control over their salaries, which usually are at or marginally above the league minimum ($780,000 in 2026, to be determined for 2027). As key cogs, Tolle, Durbin, Mead, and potentially others look like big-time bargains.

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Football

Some help for Patriots is on the way

▶PATRIOTS
Continued from Page C1

with the roster, and trying to figure out what we need to do. So, we'll probably not start those guys practicing."

There are a few things to consider when bringing players back from injured reserve, including the timeframe and how it might impact the roster.

Players on the NFI and PUP lists are now eligible to resume practicing after the second week of the regular season. However, no roster activation can occur until after the fourth week.

Once players return to practice, the team has 21 days to decide whether to activate them to the 53-man roster (during that time, they do not count against the roster limit). If the team chooses not to activate the player in that window, he needs to be placed on season-ending IR.

One player whose window opened last week was Schooler, who started the summer on the NFI list with a back issue, has been at practice for a week-plus, and is working mostly in a scout-team role.

The former undrafted free agent out of Texas has appeared in 66 games for the Patriots and is a former first-team All-Pro.

"Just chomping at the bit to get back," he said Wednesday. "It's been a long time. It's felt like an eternity. I'm super excited to get back out here with these guys soon. Just let loose, especially on Sundays."

In more immediate terms, the Patriots had four players listed as DNPs on Wednesday: cornerback Carlton Davis (neck), cornerback Christian Gonzalez (shoulder), wide receiver Mack Hollins (calf), and cornerback Karon Prunty (hamstring).

In addition, nine players were limited, including running back Rhamondre Stevenson (knee), defensive tackle Christian Barmore (shoulder), linebacker Dre'Mont Jones (shoulder), cornerback Charles Woods (shoulder), and safety Craig Woodson (shoulder). Quarterback Drake Maye (shoulder) was a full participant.

Hollins and Stevenson sustained injuries in last Sunday's win over the Bills, while Gonzalez missed that game with a shoulder injury.

Hollins hopped off the field after suffering what the team called a calf injury. On Wednesday, he didn't appear to be limping when he walked through the locker room.

"Everything we do is day by day, but I feel good," Hollins said in a brief exchange with reporters at his locker. "We'll just progress from there."

Vrabel said there's a "chance" Stevenson could play Sunday. While Gonzalez wasn't available on Wednesday, defensive tackle Christian Barmore, who also missed last Sunday's game, was back at practice in a limited role.

Looking ahead, it's worth noting more players will be eligible to return soon.

After sustaining a high ankle sprain in the opener against the Seahawks, wide receiver A.J. Brown can return starting next week. Safety Dell Pettus and rookie edge rusher Quintayvious Hutchins can return the week after that. Brown's return could prove to be a boon for quarterback Drake Maye and the passing game, which found its form for the first time this season against the Bills.

While Vrabel was careful to keep any potential timelines for other players returning vague, he was clear when it came to Brown's short-term status.

"He won't be out there today," Vrabel said. "I can promise you that, because he's not eligible."

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MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Wide receiver Mack Hollins didn't practice Wednesday because of a calf problem.

BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Rhamondre Stevenson (knee) was listed as a limited participant in practice.

ABBIE PARR/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Odell Beckham Jr. played three games with the Giants this season before he was released and signed with the Vikings.

NFL NOTEBOOK

Beckham signs with Vikings

ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Vikings signed wide receiver **Odell Beckham Jr.** to their practice squad Wednesday, adding some skill position depth and experience for their lagging offense.

Beckham, the 2014 Associated Press Offensive Rookie of the Year award winner, made the Pro Bowl in each of his first three seasons with the Giants. He has 7,987 receiving yards and 59 touchdowns over 122 career regular-season games in the league.

The Vikings (4-0) rank last in the NFL in passing yards. Top wide receiver **Justin Jefferson** missed the last game with a sprained ankle.

Beckham's return this year to the Giants at age 33 after being out of football in 2025 lasted three games, with just one target and no catches. Beckham served a six-game suspension last year for failing a performance-enhancing drug test and did not sign with a team after that.

Traded to the Browns in 2019, Beckham joined the Rams midway through their 2021 Super Bowl championship season. He played there for current Vikings head coach **Kevin O'Co**nnell, who was offensive coordinator of the Rams. Beckham had 21 catches for 288 yards and two touchdowns in four games in the playoffs that year.

Beckham played for the Ravens in 2023 and the Dolphins in 2024.

Eagles trade Jurgens

The Eagles traded offensive lineman **Cam Jurgens** to the Ravens for second- and fifth-round draft picks.

Philadelphia receives a fifth-round selection in 2027 and a second-rounder in 2028. Baltimore also gets a seventh-rounder in 2027 in the deal. The 27-year-old Jurgens has played center and guard, and the Ravens can use help at both.

Baltimore's top three options at center are out with long-term injuries. The Ravens moved rookie guard **Vega Ioane** over to center, but now guard **Andrew Vorhees** is also injured.

Jurgens was a Pro Bowler the past two seasons, but 2026 has been a struggle for the Philadelphia offensive line, him included. **Lane Johnson** was a late scratch for Sunday's loss to the Rams, and then he retired after 14 seasons.

Jurgens has started games at left guard and center this season after starting exclusively at center in his two Pro Bowl years. He started at right guard in 2023.

Juszczyk wins appeal

San Francisco 49ers fullback **Kyle Juszczyk** won his appeal over the fines issued by the NFL for what it deemed an "offensive" celebration when he imitated drinking a beverage, which the league said looked like he was chugging a beer.

Juszczyk was initially fined $29,852 for two infractions of the league's sportsmanship rules after celebrating two catches in the third quarter of a Week 2 win over the Dolphins by doing the celebration he has done for years while the fans at Levi's Stadium cheered "Juice!" for his nickname.

The Harvard product appealed the fine and an appeals officer ruled in his favor, the league said Wednesday. ESPN first reported that the fine had been rescinded on appeal.

The league has vowed to crack down on celebrations this season and initially ruled that the "imitation of chugging a beer constituted an offensive demonstration and could reasonably be construed as being in poor taste."

The NFL has issued 21 fines in the first three weeks for illegal celebrations or obscene gestures totaling more than $300,000. It's not clear how many others have been rescinded on appeal.

Juszczyk has been doing a version of that celebration throughout his career in San Francisco in response to 49ers fans chanting his nickname after catches or other big plays. He argued in the appeal that he was imitating drinking juice.

"I don't know how else to say it. I wasn't drinking beer in my celebration," Juszczyk said on Sept. 24. "I think you guys all know my nickname is Juice. I have Juice on my pads. The stadium yells 'Juice!' when I catch the ball. When I celebrate, I celebrate by drinking juice, and it's been that way for years. So I was surprised as anybody when I got a fine this week."

Jackson sits out

Lamar Jackson was not at practice for the Ravens during the portion open to reporters. Jackson also wasn't available before practice — Wednesday is when he usually talks — after injuring his ankle in Sunday's win over Tennessee. Jackson's ankle appeared to roll under an opposing player near the end of the first half, and he did not return. Baltimore plays at Atlanta on Sunday night. **Tyler Huntley** is Jackson's backup. He led the Ravens to wins over Chicago and Green Bay last season.

Disney+ to stream SB

ESPN announced that its broadcast of Super Bowl 61 will also be streamed on Disney+. Disney+ will stream the ESPN/ABC broadcast as well as the Spanish-language telecast on ESPN Deportes in the United States. Disney+ will also stream two "Monday Night Football" games this season — Dallas at Philadelphia on Oct. 26 and a later contest yet to be announced. This will be the first time ESPN will produce and carry the Super Bowl, while the big game also airs on ABC for the first time since 2006. Walt Disney Company announced in August that all advertising inventory for the game is sold out.

This team like being cast as an underdog

▶SULLIVAN
Continued from Page C1

something so satisfyingly resonant in watching an underdog succeed.

The question isn't why the attitude works so well. There are inherent benefits of believing it's "us against them." The interesting angle is why the mind-set is so particularly applicable in football, where the phrase "Any Given Sunday" is more than just another Hollywood script, but a reality that happens often enough to give even the biggest of underdogs hope of silencing their doubters.

No one knows that better than Mike Vrabel, whose conga line of handshakes and hugs after the Buffalo win gave us this season's first real glimpse of the buoyancy that helped carry the Patriots all the way to last season's Super Bowl. Among current coaches in the game, Vrabel has the highest winning percentage as a Las Vegas underdog since 2018. It points to his ability to tap into the emotional vein players understand so well — proving people wrong.

Given a chance to explain that particularly statistical success on Monday, Vrabel gave away no secrets and took no credit, saying blandly, "I just try to get the team prepared each and every week the best that I can, get them to understand what it is that they need to do to win the game, what we all need to do and the role that we all play in the game."

But it was in another answer about wide receiver Romeo Doubs that Vrabel revealed some of his methods. The veteran free agent had heard plenty about his failures to deliver in the first three games, including an egregious drop in the season opener at Seattle. He bounced back with two touchdowns Sunday.

"I think that for him to not have a great play and to be able to come back is everything that we want to be able to do," Vrabel said. "We have the power to choose our response. When things happen, there's a moment in there where we get to choose."

Say that again: We get to choose. It's the essence of the underdog mentality. Control what you can control, especially in attitude, effort, and energy.

Why does it work? Well, to begin with, it removes a level of pressure, with expectations landing much more heavily on the favored team. It sharpens the focus. It fosters team unity, built around a common goal and the feeling of all being in something difficult together. It emboldens the proverbial chip on the shoulder, where motivation is born from the skepticism of others.

It can open up creativity, a let-it-fly approach we saw Sunday in particular with embattled quarterback Drake Maye. Vrabel made it clear that with the presence of everybody's favorite QB on the other side of the field, he was ready to give his own offense freedom to take chances.

"When you play Josh Allen, you're going to have to be aggressive," Vrabel said Monday. "We can hope and wish we can stop him, and sometimes you do, we got some huge three-and-outs, sometimes we got the drive stopped and sometimes we didn't. That's what elite players do — he's never out of it, and we wanted to stay aggressive at our moments, and the guys rewarded us by converting."

Last season, the players found their formula in the mantra, "We all we got, we all we need," and rode it through their deep and unexpected playoff run. Maybe they found another enduring identity last weekend. "We're not dead yet" might stick. It's the fuel behind it that matters. As veteran safety Kevin Byard knows, having reunited with his former Titans coach when he signed a one-year, $9 million contract to join the Patriots this past offseason, Vrabel always seems to find the right words.

"We've never, since I've been with Vrabes, we've never been a front-running team, ever," Byard was quoted by the Boston Herald after Sunday's game. "We've never been a team where we get down, you lose a couple games, and all of a sudden, guys are like, 'Ah, here we go again.' It's never been that. He's always keeping us present in the moment, and I think that plays a big part in the culture of a team and getting guys to believe that no matter what the situation is, no matter what the records are, no matter what happened last week, it's any given Sunday."

Spoken, and channeled, like a true underdog.

Tara Sullivan is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at tara.sullivan@globe.com. Follow her @Globe_Tara.

Globe staff's pro picks WEEK 5

	Las Vegas line	Chad Finn	Christopher Price	Tara Sullivan	Scott Thurston	Ben Volin	Nicole Yang
Last week		6-9-1	7-8-1	5-10-1	8-7-1	7-8-1	6-9-1
Season		28-34-2	26-36-2	21-41-2	31-31-2	25-37-2	24-38-2
Best bets		1-3	1-3	1-3	3-1	3-1	1-3
Tampa Bay at Dallas	Dallas by 8½	Dallas	Dallas	Dallas	Dallas	Dallas	Dallas

Selections are against the pointspread.

PATRIOTS MAILBAG

A positive: Maye steps up in play

By Christopher Price
GLOBE STAFF

Welcome back to the Patriots mailbag. This week, we have questions about Drake Maye, Efton Chism, the lack of traditional third-down, pass-catching backs these days, and Milton Williams. Let's get to it.

So, is Drake Maye back to being Drake Maye again, or what?

— David R., Billerica

I don't know if he's all the way back to being the guy we saw before the playoffs last year, but Sunday represented a very real positive development for the quarterback. He displayed good decision-making skills, especially when it came to tucking and running, as opposed to throwing into danger. He was careful with the football (the two turnovers weren't all his fault, particularly the tipped interception). And he displayed a sharp-eyed accuracy, particularly on the touchdown passes. It wasn't perfect, and there's still a lot to build on. But all in all, it was his best game of the season. Now he needs to keep the arrow pointed in the right direction this Sunday against the Raiders.

Kyle Williams has been MIA this season, and DeMario Douglas continues to underwhelm. Is it time for Efton Chism to start, or at least move up the depth chart after Sunday? I know Williams and Chism have different skill sets but "getting open and catching the ball" seem like usable skills within the current offense.

— Daisy D., Chicago

As you noted, there are some variations in how they've been used, so it wouldn't necessarily be a one-for-one swap. And the Patriots will likely remain a game-plan offense, which means wide receiver usage will vary from week to week. But I wouldn't be shocked to see Chism in line for more snaps, based on how he's handled his reps to this point. Coach Mike Vrabel hinted as much on Monday when he said Chism has earned more chances. "Guys continue to take advantage of their opportunities, they get more opportunities," he said in response to a question about Chism.

How do you see the Patriots navigating their (nearly) 53-man IR this year? A.J. Brown obviously gets a return slot, but that high ankle might need a lot longer than the four-game injured reserve minimum. After Marcus Bryant and Brenden Schooler, who else is realistically coming back to help? Mike Onwenu seems iffy at best. With so many players hurt, do they hold on to some return slots for later in the season?

— Jules M., Hyde Park

Right now, the only other significant player who figures to be a part of this conversation is outside linebacker Harold Landry. The veteran, who started the year on the physically unable to perform list, continues to work toward a possible return after a knee injury last season. It remains to be seen what sort of impact he might have after missing so much time, but he is eligible to return starting this week. I'd also keep an eye out for punter Bryce Baringer, who is eligible to return from an IR stint this week.

What happened to having a pass-catching option among the running backs, like James White, Kevin Faulk, or Danny Woodhead? It would seem to be a help with opening up downfield options for Drake Maye.

— Anil Adyanthaya, Newton

What, no love for Dion Lewis or Shane Vereen? In all seriousness, the pass-catching third-down back appears to be a thing of the past. Teams are favoring the do-everything back for a few reasons, not the least of which is that it saves a roster spot for another potential position of need. One of the best examples is Rhamondre Stevenson, who is tied for second on the Patriots in receptions (12 for 90 yards). The game is evolving, which means less work for those other guys. We'll see if it comes back into style.

Nice article on the defense in the wake of the Buffalo game. You and the Globe staff should do more on Milton Williams. This guy is a natural leader and may be the most important locker room player on the defense.

— Ed Saraiva, Needham

Thanks (I'd also point you to this excellent feature on Williams from colleague Nicole Yang that ran last year). I've really enjoyed covering Williams over the last year-plus: smart, insightful, and always accountable, he's as straightforward as they come. That's one of the reasons I always try to seek him out after games, as well as once or twice during the week. From a big-picture perspective, he's done as much as any player in crafting a new culture in Foxborough. I'd also echo your second point; he's one of the three or four most important players on the roster. You've got to keep him healthy if this team is going to get to where it wants to go. In the end, the best compliment you can give him is that he signed a record deal before the start of last season and no one has ever complained that he's overpaid.

Some questions have been edited or condensed for clarity.

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MICHAEL PESCATORE/WINCHESTER HIGH

Despite losing eight regulars from last year's squad, Winchester is off to a 7-1-1 start thanks to an influx of young talent and a senior class that has welcomed them into the fold. The team's sights are set on capturing a Middlesex League crown and making a run in the MIAA tournament.

HIGH SCHOOL GIRLS' SOCCER NOTEBOOK

Winchester riding a youthful wave

By Eli Cloutier
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Turnover from year to year in high school sports is a given.

Eight regular contributors from last season's 15-3-2 Winchester girls' soccer team departed either via graduation or transfer. That included starting defenders **Amanda Mitchell** (Fairfield), **Gaby Hermsdorf** (Colby), and **Charlotte Bjerke**.

At tryouts, Winchester third-year coach **Michelle Ross** said she had to wait to see what she had.

"You never know coming into the season who may look good, but then they may not transition well," she said.

Fortunately, three relative newcomers, freshman **Sophia Zuniga**, sophomore **Solana Murphy**, and junior **Lila Roeder**, have stepped in and anchored the backline in a 7-1-1 start.

Murphy is playing center back for the first time, stepping into the role Hermsdorf vacated. She has quickly earned her teammates' trust, and she's felt the weight of the job.

"There's a lot more responsibility," Murphy said. "I have the whole team in front of me, and I need to communicate more and make sure that everyone's organized."

Senior midfielder **Sophie Shapiro**, a returning Globe All-Scholastic and team captain, lauded Zuniga, Murphy, and Roeder for adapting on the fly.

"Obviously, we had some big gaps in the back line, but Sophia, Solana, and Lila have really stepped up and filled that hole pretty seamlessly," said Shapiro, who is committed to Lehigh.

Winchester, ranked ninth in this week's Globe Top 20, and seventh in the MIAA Division 1 power rankings, has yielded just four goals in nine games.

Shapiro is joined in the midfield by fellow senior captain **Emma Kiernan** (committed to Amherst) and sophomore **Stella Garcia**, a trio whose distinct skill sets complement each other.

"Emma is very strong on the ball and tracks very well," Ross said. "Sophie has an amazing ability to put herself in a position to receive the ball and play players into positions for them to best help the team, and Stella is one of the hardest workers I've seen in a very long time."

Up top, sophomore **Ashley Mitchell**, a returning starter, is joined by senior captain **GG Fantini**. Sophomores **Audrey Houllahan** and **Elise Alvares** also receiving regular playing time, and senior **Amelia Burke** and junior **Kendall McCarthy** split time in goal.

In a rematch of their Division 1 second-round loss against No. 2 Concord-Carlisle last fall, the Red & Black registered a signature 1-0 victory Saturday, reversing the playoff result.

Winchester thwarted the Patriots' vaunted attack, moved the ball comfortably, Kiernan connected for the lone goal.

"It was a really intense game," Kiernan said. "We showed a lot of strength on the field and used our play style to our advantage to move the ball around them."

Ross said her team treated the match like the postseason.

The emphasis is on taking games one at a time, but the Red & Black have their eye on winning the Middlesex League title, and advancing past the Round of 16 in the MIAA tournament.

Eleven of the 22 players on the roster are underclassmen, but the youth hasn't held Winchester back.

"Months before the start of the season, when we were learning our new schedule, we knew we had an opportunity here to do something more than we have in the past few years," Kiernan said. "We have the strength to have a strong playoff run."

Corner kicks

■ Cardinal Spellman lacks the large senior classes that many top teams rely on. In fact, the Cardinals only have one senior who sees action.

That hasn't stopped the Cardinals from racing to a dominant 9-0-1 start, outscoring opponents, 40-3.

Cardinal Spellman, ranked 20th in this week's Globe Top 20 and fifth in the MIAA Division 3 power rankings, did not allow an open-play goal until its 10th game.

An experienced group of juniors has led the defensive unit. **Norah O'Brien** has been impressive in net, and classmates **Addison Bernazzani**, **Nora Martineau**, **Bella Cunningham**, **Mia Olohan**, and **Sydney Krol** have prevented teams from getting in behind.

"They're not getting inside tight and having an easy chance to score," coach **Mike Perry** said. "Teams are shooting a lot of stuff outside the 18 [yard box]."

Offensively, the Cardinals have relied on sophomore forwards **Brynn Nickley** (14 points) and **Emerson McCann** (14 points), and freshman midfielder **Gabrielle Holdsworth** (13 points). In Monday's 3-2 victory over previously unbeaten Bishop Fenwick, Nickley netted all three goals.

"Sometimes you can have a really good player, but in the big games they can disappear, and she certainly doesn't disappear," Perry said.

Senior captain **Abbie Clark** and sophomore **Ella Osgood** have been key to controlling the midfield.

With 10 goal scorers, Perry is benefiting from his team's depth, noting he can comfortably make substitutions without worrying about a drop in quality.

"It's been a balanced team," said Perry. "I think we can be a tough team to defend because you can't focus on just one.

■ Only 11 undefeated teams remain in Eastern Massachusetts: Medfield (8-0-0), Bishop Feehan (7-0-1), Duxbury (9-0-2), Masconomet (10-0-0), Central Catholic (8-0-0), Cohasset (9-0-1), Wayland (7-0-2), and Cardinal Spellman (9-0-1) are ranked in the latest Globe Top 20. The unranked unbeatens are Greater Lowell (9-0-0), Blue Hills (9-0-1), and Pioneer Charter I (8-0-1).

Correspondent Henry Dinh-Price contributed to this story.

Globe Top 20

No.		Rec.	Last
1.	Medfield	8-0-0	1
2.	Bishop Feehan	7-0-1	3
3.	Duxbury	9-0-2	4
4.	Concord-Carlisle	7-1-0	2
5.	Masconomet	10-0-0	7
6.	Wellesley	5-1-2	5
7.	Franklin	8-1-0	8
8.	Belmont	7-1-0	10
9.	Winchester	7-1-1	14
10.	Central Catholic	8-0-0	9
11.	Hingham	9-1-0	13
12.	Needham	6-1-1	11
13.	Cohasset	9-0-1	16
14.	Norwell	5-1-3	18
15.	King Philip	5-2-2	17
16.	Wayland	7-0-2	—
17.	Beverly	6-1-1	—
18.	Acton-Boxborough	4-1-3	15
19.	Hopkinton	6-3-0	6
20.	Cardinal Spellman	9-0-1	—

Football games to watch — and our picks

FRIDAY

No. 8 North Attleborough at King Philip: Can King Philip (2-2, 1-0) follow up on back-to-back dominant defensive performances by slowing down North's elite rushing attack? Or will the visiting Rocketeers (2-1, 1-0) score a pivotal Hockomock Davenport win? **Pick**: KING PHILIP.

No. 7 St. John's (Shrewsbury) at No. 4 Xaverian: This is the big test for an experienced Pioneers team that has rolled through nonconference play, but has yet to take on a Catholic Conference titan. **Pick**: XAVERIAN.

No. 16 Tewksbury at No. 18 Billerica: Bitter rivals clash with Tewksbury (3-1, 1-1) looking to bounce back from a home loss and Billerica (4-0, 1-0) looking to build on the momentum of an overtime win at previously unbeaten North Andover. **Pick**: TEWKSBURY.

Natick at Newton North: The Tigers have had a charmed season so far and Natick has faltered in recent weeks, but we're picking the Redhawks to get back on track with a road win. **Pick**: NATICK.

Hingham at No. 17 Duxbury: After losing to their rivals for the first time in 18 years last fall, the Dragons are angling for redemption, while the Harbormen would love to play spoiler on senior night. **Pick**: DUXBURY.

Methuen at No. 3 Central Catholic: This is the first of two crucial Merrimack Valley Conference Large battles for Central Catholic, with the second coming in two weeks at Andover. First, the Raiders have to hold serve at home against the reigning league champions. **Pick**: CENTRAL CATHOLIC.

No. 9 Milford at Franklin: The Panthers (3-1, 1-0) have averaged 30.6 points while winning three straight and Milford (4-0, 0-0) has been playing lights out defensively entering this Hockomock Kelley-Rex battle. **Pick**: MILFORD.

Revere at Everett: With Everett playing an independent schedule, Revere (2-2, 1-0) is currently atop the Greater Boston League. Interim coach Jose Escobar leads the Patriots to Everett to face the former GBL power. **Pick**: EVERETT.

No. 12 Bishop Feehan at Barnstable: Two teams sporting 2-2 overall records. Feehan, playing an independent schedule, heads to the Cape looking to boost their MIAA power rankings. **Pick**: BISHOP FEEHAN.

Beverly at No. 19 Danvers: Beverly (2-2, 0-1) dropped its NEC Dunn opener to pass-heavy Peabody and looks to get back in the fray by slowing down Danvers (3-0, 0-0), a program with a great rushing attack. **Pick**: DANVERS.

NATE WEITZER

This week's high school football schedule

THURSDAY'S GAMES

EASTERN MASS.
BAY STATE — Wellesley at Framingham, 6.
COMMONWEALTH — Northeast at Whittier, 6.
MAYFLOWER — Diman at Tri-County, 7.
MERRIMACK VALLEY — Andover at Lawrence, 6.
MIDDLESEX — Woburn at Lexington, 6.
NORTHEASTERN — Saugus at Winthrop, 6:30.
PATRIOT — Whitman-Hanson at Plymouth North, 7.

WESTERN MASS.
SUBURBAN — Amherst-Pelham at Putnam, 6.

FRIDAY'S GAMES

EASTERN MASS.
BAY STATE — Natick at Newton North, 6; Milton at Needham, 6:30; Braintree at Weymouth, 7.
BOSTON CITY — East Boston at O'Bryant, 4; Tech-Boston at Latin Academy, 6; English High at Brighton, 6:30.
CAPE & ISLANDS — Nantucket at Nauset, 5; Dennis-Yarmouth at Sandwich, 6.
CAPE ANN — Essex Tech at Lynnfield, 6; Manchester Essex at Hamilton-Wenham, 6; Triton/Ipswich at North Reading, 6; Pentucket/Georgetown at Newburyport, 6:30.
CATHOLIC CENTRAL — Archbishop Williams at Arlington Catholic, 6:30; Cathedral at Bishop Stang, 6:30; Cardinal Spellman at Bishop Fenwick, 7.
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE — BC High at St. John's Prep, 6; Catholic Memorial at Malden Catholic, 6; St. John's (Shrewsbury) at Xaverian, 6.
COMMONWEALTH — Greater Lowell at Shawsheen, 7; Lynn Tech at Lowell Catholic, 7; Minuteman at Nashoba Valley Tech, 7.
DUAL COUNTY — Concord-Carlisle at Cambridge, 6; Bedford at Westford, 7; Newton South at Acton-Boxborough, 7; Waltham at Weston, 7; Wayland at Lincoln-Sudbury, 7.
GREATER BOSTON — Malden at Chelsea, 6; Medford at Lynn Classical, 7:30.
HOCKOMOCK — Foxborough at Canton, 6; Mansfield at Oliver Ames, 6; Milford at Franklin, 6; North Attleborough at King Philip, 6; Stoughton at Attleboro, 6.
MAYFLOWER — Wareham at Cape Cod Tech, 6.
MERRIMACK VALLEY — Chelmsford at Lowell, 6; Dracut at North Andover, 6:30; Methuen at Central Catholic, 7; Tewksbury at Billerica, 7.
MIDDLESEX — Arlington at Belmont, 6; Melrose at Burlington, 6; Stoneham at Wilmington, 7; Wakefield at Watertown, 7; Winchester at Reading, 7.
NORTHEASTERN — Beverly at Danvers, 6:30; Masconomet at Peabody, 7; Salem at Gloucester, 7.
PATRIOT — Scituate at Quincy, 4:30; Hingham at Duxbury, 7; Marshfield at Silver Lake, 7; Plymouth South at Hanover, 7; Pembroke at North Quincy, 7:30.
SOUTH COAST — Dighton-Rehoboth/Bristol Aggie at Old Rochester, 6:30; Greater New Bedford at Apponequet, 6:30; Seekonk at Joseph Case, 6:30; West Bridgewater at Bourne, 6:30.
SOUTH SHORE — Randolph at Mashpee, 6; Abington at Middleborough, 7; East Bridgewater at Norwell, 7.
TRI-VALLEY — Holliston at Hopkinton, 6; Westwood at Norwood, 6; Dover-Sherborn at Norton, 7; Medfield at Ashland, 7.
NONLEAGUE — Marblehead at St. Mary's, 5; Bishop Feehan at Barnstable, 6; Brockton at Taunton, 6; Monomoy/JP II at Carver, 6; Revere at Everett, 6; Sharon/Dedham at Falmouth, 6; Shrewsbury at Doherty, 6; South Shore Voc-Tech at Hull, 6; Swampscott at Greater Lawrence, 6; Brookline at New Bedford, 6:30; Dartmouth at Durfee, 6:30; Uxbridge at Fairhaven, 6:30; Wachusett at Walpole, 6:30; Groton-Dunstable/NM at Medway, 7; Rockland at Bristol-Plymouth, 7.

NEPSAC
CLASS A — Cheshire Academy at Dexter Southfield, 6.
CLASS C — St. Mark's at Roxbury Latin, 6.
NONLEAGUE — Lawrence Academy at BB&N, 6:30.

CENTRAL MASS.
MID-WACH — Fitchburg at Nashoba, 6; Oakmont at Clinton, 6; Gardner at Murdock, 6:30; Grafton at Westborough, 6:30; Algonquin at Leominster, 7; Tyngsborough at Narragansett, 7.
NONLEAGUE — Marlborough at Worcester South, 6; Ayer Shirley/Littleton at Southbridge, 6:30; Quabbin at Oxford, 6:30; Shepherd Hill at Norwich Free Academy, 6:30; Assabet at Maynard/AMSA, 7; Hudson at Auburn, 7; Lunenburg at Abby Kelley Foster, 7; West Boylston at Millbury/Sutton, 7.

WESTERN MASS.
AA — Longmeadow at Springfield Central, 6.
INTERCOUNTY — Greenfield at Franklin County Tech, 7; Hoosac Valley at Lee, 7; Ware at Mahar, 7.
NONLEAGUE — Holyoke at Easthampton, 6; Ludlow at Commerce, 6; Smith Vocational at Belchertown, 6:30; Chicopee at Frontier, 7; David Prouty at Athol, 7; Minnechaug at East Longmeadow, 7; Northampton at Springfield International, 7; Pathfinder at South Hadley, 7; Wahconah at Chicopee Comprehensive, 7; Westfield at West Springfield, 7.
SUBURBAN — Agawam at Taconic, 6.
TRI-COUNTY — Monument Mtn. at McCann Tech, 7.

SATURDAY'S GAMES

EASTERN MASS.
GREATER BOSTON — Somerville at Lynn English, 1.
MAYFLOWER — Atlantis at Upper Cape, 1.
NONLEAGUE — Martha's Vineyard at Worcester North, 1; Old Colony at KIPP, 4.

NEPSAC
CLASS A — Phillips Andover at Kent, 4.
CLASS B — St. Paul's at Milton Academy, 2:30.
CLASS C — Governor's Academy at Middlesex, 1:30; Groton at Brooks, 2:45; Hamden Hall Country Day at Rivers, 3; St. George's at Portsmouth Abbey, 3; Thayer at Greenwich CD (Conn.), 3; Berkshire at Nobles, 4; Pingree at New Hampton, 4:30.
NONLEAGUE — Brunswick at Belmont Hill, 2; St. Sebastian's at Hotchkiss, 2:30; Trinity-Pawling at Canterbury, 3.

SportsLog

Marchand injures leg in Panthers' win

Panthers forward **Brad Marchand** sustained a left leg injury in the second period of their 2-1 win against the Kings on Tuesday in Los Angeles. The former Bruins captain was not on the bench for the third period, and after the game coach **Paul Maurice** said the team would "get him looked at probably Thursday." Teammates **Brady Tkachuk** and **Niko Mikkola** had to help the veteran to the bench, with Marchand unable to put any weight on his leg. It would be a huge blow if the 38-year-old is lost for major time, only days after losing captain **Aleksander Barkov** to a left leg injury that will sideline him for 6-8 weeks . . . Islanders defenseman **Alexander Romanov** has a torn ACL in his right knee and is expected to be out 6-8 months, after the 26-year-old was injured in Tuesday's 5-2 loss at the Rangers . . . Looking to add depth to their blue line, the Penguins got defenseman **Spencer Stastney** from the Oilers for forward **Filip Hallander**.

GOLF

Rahm to leave LIV

Spanish star **Jon Rahm** won't be part of the next version of LIV Golf, dealing a setback to the beleaguered circuit as it tries to emerge from bankruptcy and forge a new path without the financial muscle of Saudi Arabia's sovereign wealth fund. **John Beck**, the attorney Rahm hired for LIV's bankruptcy proceedings, said during a Wednesday hearing in the US Bankruptcy Court of New Jersey that Rahm reviewed the proposed terms of LIV 2.0 and decided he would not be participating in 2027. The former Masters and US Open champion, and the last player to be No. 1 in the world before **Scottie Scheffler**, was among the biggest and most stunning acquisitions by LIV Golf at the end of 2023 when he was the reigning Masters champion. His signing bonus, never confirmed, was reported to be in the $300 million range. Still to come was formal separation from LIV Golf and word on where Rahm would play next . . . The LPGA Tour released its 2027 schedule featuring 33 tournaments, a record $147 million in prize money, and an itinerary that doesn't have players bouncing across the country. The FM Championship, the Tour's only stop in New England, will return to TPC Boston in Norton the weekend of Aug. 26-29.

MISCELLANY

Altman retires

Longtime University of Oregon men's basketball coach **Dana Altman** is retiring effective immediately, less than a month before the start of the season. The 68-year-old took over ahead of the 2010-11 season and is the winningest coach in Ducks history (382-182), guiding them to nine NCAA Tournament appearances, including a Final Four in 2017 . . . American tennis star **Coco Gauff**, saying she had "no energy" in her 6-3, 6-3 loss to **Elise Mertens** at the China Open, withdrew from the upcoming the Wuhan Open. Earlier, **Iga Swiatek** broke **Iva Jovic's** serve twice in the last four games to beat the 18-year-old American 6-1, 6-3 . . . EuroLeague basketball owners rejected a formal offer from the NBA to merge into a single European operation . . . Arsenal manager **Mikel Arteta** signed a new contract that will extend his stay at the English Premier League champions until 2030 . . . **George Russell** will be hit with a power unit penalty at this weekend's Singapore Grand Prix that could result in Mercedes teammate **Kimi Antonelli** extending his lead in the Formula 1 drivers' standings.

Mara relishes playing two D1 sports at BC

▶MARA
Continued from Page C1

rennial contender in Hockey East.

If it were up to her, Mara would attend every minute of every practice and play every game for both. But there was one caveat demanded by Watkins: Since Mara's education was paid for by a soccer scholarship, that team would have to be her priority.

A forward, Mara is in the thick of soccer season, where she has four goals and seven assists for the 9-2-1 Eagles. She will practice exclusively with the soccer team through the end of its season in early November, then shift gears to hockey once the postseason wraps up.

"She was lobbying all of us, saying she doesn't need a day off," Watkins said, recalling the meeting last fall. "She just wants to go, and we're trying to get her to slow down."

Last year, her soccer season ended Oct. 30, and Mara spent the next seven days studying film and skating as much as she could. She had already missed the first 10 games of the hockey season and would be damned if she missed another.

Mara made her college hockey debut Nov. 7, on less than a week of practice.

"I just don't know if I could picture what I would do with an offseason," said Mara, who this summer played for USL W League team Vermont Green FC. "Like, I'd have too much free time."

Mara committed to BC as a soccer player but had been in talks with the hockey staff throughout the recruiting process. In the summer before her freshman year, the team still had open roster spots, so Crowley figured she'd give Mara a shot.

"What Emily brings to the team, it outweighs the fact that she's not here for the first month and a half," Crowley said. "Her energy, the kind of person she is — it's worth it to have a player like her."

Adding a player to the lineup partway through the season could be a recipe for intrasquad tension, and Crowley had a few conversations early last fall to preemptively smooth things over.

If Mara's hockey teammates had any qualms about her late arrival, however, they never showed it.

FILE/JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Emily Mara was the Globe's top NEPSAC female athlete in 2025 as a senior at Phillips Andover.

Mara was a welcome addition to the room, Crowley said, and she went on to record three assists in 25 games.

"You have to be someone that your teammates really like being around, right?" Crowley said. "Because you're coming in after a month or month and a half of the season, and maybe getting in the lineup over somebody, and sometimes those things can be a little bit tricky."

This year, the soccer regular season wraps on Nov. 5. The hockey team again will already have played 10 games.

Hockey and soccer require different muscle groups — running puts more pressure on your shins and knees compared to skating, which is tougher on the hips — so overuse injuries aren't a huge concern for Mara or her coaches.

The way Mara sees it, she's just as likely to get injured playing one sport year round than she is playing two sports and splitting her time. If anything, cross-training is beneficial to her long-term health.

Her coaches tend to agree, though Watkins noted Mara covers more distance on average in a soccer game than any other athlete on the team, and because of her small frame, she often takes a beating from opponents.

"Even if she didn't play another sport, there's a lot of risk," he said. "But she's a unicorn."

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Scoreboard

★ ★ ★

Schools

GOLF

BOYS
BAY STATE
Wellesley 231 ... Framingham 260
BI-COUNTY
Easthampton 156 ... St. Mary (W) 205
CAPE & ISLANDS
Nauset 242 ... Nantucket 269
CAPE ANN
Amesbury 153 ... Ipswich 146
Newburyport 192 ... Pentucket 137
Rockport 154 ... Georgetown 93
CATHOLIC CENTRAL
St. Mary's 177 ... Bp. Fenwick 141
CMAC
Hopedale 158 ... Whit. Christian 170
COMMONWEALTH
Shawsheen 189 ... Northeast 95
DUAL COUNTY
Concord-Carlisle 238 ... Bedford 277
Weston 270 ... Cambridge 329
EIL
Beaver CD 5½ ... Pingree 0½
HOCKOMOCK
Milford 169 ... Stoughton 179
North Attleboro 147 ... Foxboro 154
MERRIMACK VALLEY
Andover 236 ... N. Andover 245
Central Cath. 242 ... Haverhill 253
Chelmsford 241 ... Billerica 251
MIDDLESEX
Lexington 39 ... Arlington 33
NORTHEASTERN
Danvers 48½ ... Saugus 23½
PATRIOT
Hanover 248 ... Scituate 251
Hingham 243 ... Duxbury 264
N. Quincy 229 ... Plymouth North 238
Pembroke 237 ... Quincy 256
PIONEER
Dartmouth 134 ... Bridge.-Raynham 132
SOUTH COAST
Old Rochester 233 ... Digh.-Rehoboth 269
SOUTH SHORE
Abington 127 ... Carver 133
TRI-VALLEY
Medfield 223 ... Westwood 225
Norwood 222 ... Medfield 223
NONLEAGUE
Bp. Stang 236 ... St. John Paul II 243
Braintree 227 ... Xaverian 229
Cath. Memorial 241 ... Brookline 245
E. Bridgewater 274 ... Whit.-Hanson 275
Ludlow 152 ... Frontier 160
Masconomet 245 ... Tewksbury 252
Middleboro 246 ... Apponequet 263
Millbury 171 ... Oxford 182
Norwell 119 ... Abp. Williams 128
Shepherd Hill 156 ... Grafton 157
Shrewsbury 160 ... N. Middlesex 172
Taunton 168 ... Sharon 179

MVADA Championship / Large at Heritage Country Club
Team
1. Tri-County, 306; 2. Shawsheen, 308; 3. Monty Tech, 313; 4. Blackstone Valley, 317; 5. Greater Lowell, 325; 6. Bay Path, 327; 7. Bristol-Plymouth, 331; 8. Southeastern, 332; 9. Diman, 338; 10. Worcester Tech, 339.
Individual
72 — Tyler Frediani, Shawsheen (Par 71).
73 — Colby Moon, Tri-County.
74 — Drew Shanahan, Blackstone Valley.
75 — Tommy McKiernan, Greater Lowell.
76 — Blake Sullivan, Assabet; Tyler Friend, Bay Path; Phin Keating, Tri-County; Tyler Alberto, Monty Tech; Will Labelle, Greater Lawrence.
78 — Andrew Polleys, Shawsheen.

MVADA Championship / Small at Heritage Country Club
Team
1. Cape Cod Tech, 315; 2. Franklin County Tech, 318; 3. Minuteman, 319; 4. Boston Latin, 334; 4. McCann Tech, 334; 4. Old Colony, 334; 7. South Shore Voc-Tech, 339; 8. Upper Cape, 340; 9. Nashoba Valley Tech, 341; 10. Smith Voc., 342.
Individual
75 — Chris Morin, Cape Cod Tech (Par 71); Jackson Day, Franklin County Tech.
76 — Grady Deery, Franklin County Tech; Matthew Fogg, Nashoba Valley Tech; Carter LaFrance, Cape Cod Tech.
77 — Henry Lysaght, Keefe Tech; Gabe Thomas, McCann Tech; Pat Dabrowski, Smith Voc..
78 — John Bongiorno, Old Rochester; Grady St. Pierre, Keefe Tech.

SOCCER

BOYS
BOSTON CITY
Latin Acad. 6 ... TechBoston 0
CAPE & ISLANDS
St. John Paul II 3 ... Sandwich 1
CATHOLIC CENTRAL
Bp. Fenwick 7 ... Arlington Cath. 0
Bp. Stang 4 ... Card. Spellman 2
GREATER BOSTON
Lynn Classical 0 ... Everett 0
ISL
Nobles 4 ... Tabor 0
St. Sebastian's 7 ... Governor's 0
Thayer 2 ... Brooks 1
MAYFLOWER
Diman 4 ... Tri-County 2
MIDDLESEX
Arlington 2 ... Woburn 0
Belmont 1 ... Lexington 0
Burlington 2 ... Wilmington 2
Melrose 3 ... Stoneham 1
Reading 1 ... Winchester 0
NORTHEASTERN
Beverly 3 ... Peabody 0
Gloucester 3 ... Winthrop 0
Marblehead 1 ... Masconomet 0
Salem 0 ... Swampscott 0
PATRIOT
Plymouth South 2 ... N. Quincy 0
SOUTH COAST
Fairhaven 0 ... Seekonk 0
Joseph Case 4 ... Bourne 1
Old Rochester 3 ... Somerset Berkley 0
W. Bridgewater 3 ... Apponequet 1
SOUTH SHORE
Randolph 0 ... Middleboro 0
TRI-VALLEY
Ashland 13 ... Millis 0
Holliston 6 ... Norton 0
Hopkinton 0 ... Dedham 0
Medfield 3 ... Dover-Sherborn 0
Medway 1 ... Norwood 0
Westwood 1 ... Bellingham 0
NONLEAGUE
Athol 6 ... Mohawk Trail 3
Auburn 3 ... Northbridge 0
Blackstone-Millville 3 ... Bartlett 1
Brighton 1 ... Somerville 0
Brockton 2 ... Dearborn STEM 1
Doherty 6 ... Burncoat 0
E. Boston 3 ... Rockland 0
English High 2 ... Cathedral 0
Frontier 1 ... Westfield 0
Gardner 9 ... Mahar 0
Granby 7 ... Ware 2
Hampshire 2 ... Taconic 1
Millbury 3 ... Tahanto 1
Oxford 2 ... Douglas 0
Saugus 0 ... Essex Tech 0
Tantasqua 3 ... Worcester North 2
Uxbridge 6 ... Worcester Tech 0
Whit. Christian 4 ... David Prouty 2
GIRLS
Austin Prep 1 ... Phillips Andover 0
CATHOLIC CENTRAL
Card. Spellman 4 ... Bp. Stang 0
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
Ursuline 7 ... Fontbonne 0
CMAC
Adv. Math & Sci. 5 ... Oxford 0
COOMBS
Westfield 3 ... E. Longmeadow 0
EIL
Dana Hall 1 ... Berwick 0
ISL
Lawrence Acad. 4 ... Middlesex 0
Nobles 1 ... Tabor 0
Thayer 3 ... Brooks 0
MIDDLESEX
Arlington 1 ... Woburn 1
Lexington 2 ... Belmont 1
Melrose 2 ... Stoneham 0
Wakefield 2 ... Watertown 1
Wilmington 2 ... Burlington 1
Winchester 4 ... Reading 1
NORTHEASTERN
Beverly 1 ... Peabody 0
Marblehead 0 ... Masconomet 0
Winthrop 4 ... Gloucester 0
SOUTH COAST
Digh.-Rehoboth 5 ... Gr. New Bedford 0
Seekonk 4 ... Fairhaven 1
Somerset Berkley 3 ... Old Rochester 0
W. Bridgewater 3 ... Apponequet 1
TRI-VALLEY
Dedham 1 ... Hopkinton 1
Medway 2 ... Norwood 0
Millis 1 ... Ashland 1
Norton 0 ... Holliston 0
NONLEAGUE
Auburn 6 ... Burncoat 0
Bp. Feehan 6 ... Westwood 0
Blackstone-Millville 4 ... Quaboag 0
Brockton 4 ... Latin Acad. 1
Brooke Charter 6 ... Madison Park 3
David Prouty 5 ... St. Paul 1
E. Bridgewater 0 ... Abp. Williams 0
Lee 1 ... Hampden Charter East 0
Lenox 3 ... Smith Voc. 1
Nipmuc 5 ... Millbury 2
Northampton 1 ... S. Hadley 0
O'Bryant 0 ... Malden 0
Palmer 2 ... Monson 1
Randolph 4 ... Maimonides 0
Tantasqua 3 ... Blackstone Valley 0
W. Springfield 5 ... Chicopee Comp. 0
Worcester South 6 ... Worcester Tech 2

■ For updated scores and highlights, go to bostonglobe.com/sports/highschools.

VOLLEYBALL

GIRLS
St. Paul's 3 ... Austin Prep 2
CAPE & ISLANDS
Dennis-Yarmouth 3 ... St. John Paul II 2
Nantucket 3 ... Rising Tide Charter 0
Nauset 3 ... Falmouth 1
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
Ursuline 3 ... Fontbonne 0
CMAC
Nipmuc 3 ... Whit. Christian 1
COMMONWEALTH
Gr. Lawrence 3 ... Lowell Cath. 0
DUAL COUNTY
Cambridge 3 ... Waltham 0
Newton South 3 ... Concord-Carlisle 0
Wayland 3 ... Boston Latin 0
Westford 3 ... Bedford 0
Weston 3 ... Acton-Boxboro 1
EIL
Berwick 3 ... Bancroft 2
GREATER BOSTON
Lynn Classical 3 ... Malden 0
Revere 3 ... Chelsea 0
Somerville 3 ... Medford 0
HOCKOMOCK
Canton 3 ... Milford 0
Franklin 3 ... Mansfield 0
Oliver Ames 3 ... Stoughton 0
Sharon 3 ... North Attleboro 1
Taunton 3 ... Foxboro 0
MAYFLOWER
Bristol-Plymouth 3 ... Blue Hills 0
Norfolk Aggie 3 ... Cape Cod Tech 2
South Shore 3 ... Bristol Aggie 1
Tri-County 3 ... Diman 1
Westport 3 ... Wareham 0
MERRIMACK VALLEY
Andover 3 ... Methuen 0
Chelmsford 3 ... Central Cath. 1
Haverhill 3 ... Billerica 1
N. Andover 3 ... Tewksbury 0
NORTHEASTERN
Danvers 3 ... Winthrop 2
Marblehead 3 ... Saugus 0
Salem 3 ... Masconomet 2
Swampscott 3 ... Peabody 0
PATRIOT
N. Quincy 3 ... Quincy 1
PIONEER
Barnstable 3 ... Dartmouth 0
SOUTH COAST
Fairhaven 3 ... Seekonk 1
Joseph Case 3 ... Bourne 0
Old Rochester 3 ... Somerset Berkley 0
W. Bridgewater 3 ... Apponequet 0
TRI-VALLEY
Bellingham 3 ... Ashland 0
Medway 3 ... Medfield 2
Norton 3 ... Westwood 2
Norwood 3 ... Millis 0
NONLEAGUE
BB&N 3 ... Phillips Andover 0
Dearborn STEM 3 ... Charlestown 0
Malden Cath. 3 ... Whittier 1
New Mission 3 ... Academy/Pacific Rim 0

CROSS-COUNTRY

BOYS
BAY STATE
Brookline 21 ... Weymouth 38
Needham 26 ... Framingham 29
Newton North 15 ... Framingham 50
Newton North 22 ... Needham 33
Walpole 20 ... Braintree 39
Wellesley 17 ... Milton 46
CAPE ANN
Amesbury 26 ... ME/Rockport 31
Ipswich 18 ... Georgetown 47
Newburyport 27 ... Essex Tech 29
N. Reading 22 ... Lynnfield 39
Triton 23 ... Ham.-Wenham 32
DUAL COUNTY
Cambridge 15 ... Acton-Boxboro 48
Cambridge 16 ... Concord-Carlisle 41
Concord-Carlisle 17 ... Acton-Boxboro 44
Wayland 21 ... Bedford 34
Weston 24 ... Boston Latin 33
GREATER BOSTON
Medford 21 ... Somerville 39
MERRIMACK VALLEY
Andover 17 ... Haverhill 44
Andover 20 ... Methuen 39
Billerica 24 ... Central Cath. 31
Chelmsford 25 ... Dracut 36
Chelmsford 15 ... Tewksbury 49
Lowell 15 ... Lawrence 49
Methuen 25 ... Haverhill 30
N. Andover 24 ... Lowell 35
Tewksbury 27 ... Dracut 28
NORTHEASTERN
Marblehead 19 ... Danvers 43
Masconomet 19 ... Beverly 41
Swampscott 18 ... Saugus 45
TRI-VALLEY
Ashland 15 ... Norwood 47
Hopkinton 19 ... Medfield 44
Norton 25 ... Dedham 41
GIRLS
BAY STATE
Milton 19 ... Wellesley 38
Needham 15 ... Framingham 50
Needham 27 ... Newton North 28
Newton North 15 ... Framingham 50
Walpole 26 ... Braintree 32
CAPE ANN
Ham.-Wenham 20 ... Triton 41
Ipswich 15 ... Georgetown 50
Newburyport 24 ... Essex Tech 35
N. Reading 22 ... Lynnfield 39
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE
Malden Cath. 25 ... Ursuline 50
DUAL COUNTY
Bedford 29 ... Wayland 30
Boston Latin 30 ... Weston 35
Cambridge 18 ... Acton-Boxboro 41
Concord-Carlisle 15 ... Acton-Boxboro 50
Concord-Carlisle 18 ... Cambridge 44
GREATER BOSTON
Somerville 23 ... Medford 33
MERRIMACK VALLEY
Andover 22 ... Haverhill 35
Andover 18 ... Methuen 45
Billerica 18 ... Central Cath. 44
Chelmsford 15 ... Dracut 50
Chelmsford 25 ... Tewksbury 31
Haverhill 21 ... Methuen 34
Lowell 15 ... Lawrence 50
N. Andover 15 ... Lawrence 50
N. Andover 15 ... Lowell 50
Tewksbury 15 ... Dracut 50
NORTHEASTERN
Marblehead 19 ... Danvers 42
TRI-VALLEY
Dover-Sherborn 15 ... Medway 50
Norton 24 ... Dedham 35
Norwood 20 ... Ashland 36

FIELD HOCKEY

Austin Prep 5 ... Kents Hill 0
BAY STATE
Braintree 4 ... Weymouth 0
Brookline 2 ... Needham 0
Milton 2 ... Walpole 1
Wellesley 1 ... Newton North 0
CAPE & ISLANDS
Falmouth 4 ... Nauset 2
Martha's Vnyd. 3 ... St. John Paul II 2
Nantucket 4 ... Sturgis East 1
Sandwich 1 ... Dennis-Yarmouth 0
CAPE ANN
Essex Tech 1 ... Pentucket 1
Ipswich 5 ... Rockport 0
Lynnfield 5 ... Triton 1
Manchester 3 ... Amesbury 0
Newburyport 3 ... N. Reading 0
CMAC
Uxbridge 7 ... Hopedale 2
COUNTY
Franklin Cty. Tech 6 ... Palmer 0
DUAL COUNTY
Acton-Boxboro 5 ... Weston 1
Bedford 6 ... Westford 0
Concord-Carlisle 7 ... Newton South 0
EIL
Berwick 3 ... Dana Hall 1
GREATER BOSTON
Revere 2 ... Everett 0
HOCKOMOCK
Canton 9 ... Milford 0
Foxboro 4 ... Taunton 1
Franklin 8 ... Mansfield 0
King Philip 4 ... Attleboro 1
North Attleboro 8 ... Sharon 4
Oliver Ames 4 ... Stoughton 1
MERRIMACK VALLEY
Andover 2 ... Chelmsford 0
Central Cath. 2 ... Methuen 1
Tewksbury 2 ... Haverhill 0
MID-WACH
Bromfield 4 ... Fitchburg 1
Grafton 2 ... Shrewsbury 2
Littleton 3 ... Tyngsboro 1
Nashoba 5 ... Wachusett 0
N. Middlesex 1 ... Oakmont 0
Quabbin 3 ... Westboro 0
Tahanto 2 ... Maynard 0
PATRIOT
Duxbury 3 ... Marshfield 0
Hanover 5 ... Pembroke 0
Hingham 11 ... Plymouth South 0
Scituate 4 ... Plymouth North 0
PIONEER
Dartmouth 5 ... Barnstable 2
NONLEAGUE
Bp. Stang 1 ... Durfee 0
Frontier 6 ... Westfield 0
Leominster 1 ... Algonquin 1
Lunenburg 5 ... Shepherd Hill 1
Malden Cath. 2 ... Arlington 1
Marlborough 6 ... Groton-Dunstable 1
Narragansett 2 ... Gardner 0
St. Mary's 2 ... Ursuline 2

Auto racing

NASCAR CUP STANDINGS

Standings are for 31 races through South Point 400, with points, wins, and top 10 finishes.

	Pts.	W	T10
Kyle Larson	2,318	2	18
Denny Hamlin	2,278	4	20
Christopher Bell	2,263	1	16
Joey Logano	2,247	3	13
Ryan Blaney	2,238	3	20
Chase Briscoe	2,234	2	16
Tyler Reddick	2,212	5	18
Ty Gibbs	2,208	2	18
Austin Cindric	2,190	0	9
Bubba Wallace	2,181	0	15
Carson Hocevar	2,160	1	11
William Byron	2,158	0	15

	THU 10/8	FRI 10/9	SAT 10/10	SUN 10/11	MON 10/12	TUE 10/13	WED 10/14
				LV 1:00 CBS			
	UTA 7:00 NESN		PHI 1:00 NESN			SJ 11:00 NESN	
	CLE (exh.) 7:00* NBCSB		PHI (exh.) 8:00 NBCSB				CHA (exh.) 7:30 NBCSB
			SEA 7:30† AppleTV				CIN 7:30† AppleTV

Home games shaded

On the radio, unless noted: Patriots, Bruins, Celtics, and Revolution, WBZ-FM 98.5; * — WROR-FM 105.7; † — WBZ-FM 98.5 HD-2.

ON THE AIR

BASEBALL PLAYOFFS		
5 p.m.	Cleveland at Chicago White Sox	TBS
PRO BASKETBALL		
7 p.m.	Exhibition: Boston vs. Cleveland	NBCSB
7:30 p.m.	Exhibition: Washington at New York	NBA
10:30 p.m.	Exhibition: Sacramento vs. LA Lakers	ESPN2
COLLEGE FOOTBALL		
7 p.m.	Missouri St. at Western Ky.	CBSSN
7 p.m.	Sam Houston St. at Liberty	ESPNU
7:30 p.m.	South Alabama at Arkansas St.	ESPN2
7:30 p.m.	South Florida at UTSA	ESPN
PRO FOOTBALL		
8:15 p.m.	Tampa Bay at Dallas	Amazon
GOLF		
8 a.m.	DP World: Spanish Open	Golf
3 p.m.	Korn Ferry Championship	Golf
11 p.m.	PGA: Baycurrent Classic	Golf
PRO HOCKEY		
7 p.m.	Utah at Boston	NESN
MEN'S COLLEGE HOCKEY		
7 p.m.	Niagara at Notre Dame	NBCSN
WOMEN'S COLLEGE SOCCER		
7 p.m.	Alabama at Florida	SEC
7 p.m.	Virginia at Notre Dame	ACC
10:30 p.m.	Illinois at USC	Big Ten
WOMEN'S COLLEGE VOLLEYBALL		
6:30 p.m.	Nebraska at Indiana	Big Ten
8:30 p.m.	Wisconsin at Illinois	Big Ten

■ **For updates, go to bostonglobe.com/tvlistings**

Transactions

BASEBALL
San Diego: P Mason Miller reinstated from paternity leave list.
NBA
LA Clippers: Point Gu Fletcher Loyer waived.
Oklahoma City: Shooting Anthony Pritchard signed as free agent. Point Gu Robert McCray V waived.
Orlando: Small Fo Johnell Davis waived.
Utah: Point Gu Terrell Brown Jr. waived.
NFL
Arizona: T Jedrick Wills Jr. active/prac. squad.
Baltimore: TE Durham Smythe on IR. RB Lucas Scott pract. squad add. C Cam Jurgens traded. TE Nick Vannett active/prac. squad.
Cleveland: RB Jaret Patterson pract. squad add.
Houston: CB Jaden Davis, LB Chad Muma, RB Deuce Vaughn pract. squad add. QB Mark Gronowski signed.
Indianapolis: DE Carl Lawson pract. squad add. TE Kenny Fletcher Jr. pract. squad del.
Jacksonville: CB Christian Braswell on IR.
Miami: RB Carlos Washington Jr. pract. squad add.
Minnesota: WR Odell Beckham Jr., WR Jeshaun Jones pract. squad add.
NY Giants: WR Braxton Berrios on IR. WR Dontae Fleming pract. squad add. QB Jake Haener active/prac. squad.
NY Jets: DE Braiden McGregor on IR. DE Nathan Voorhis pract. squad add. LB Nate Lynn active/prac. squad.
Philadelphia: C James Brockermeyer, WR Erik Ezukanma pract. squad add. RB Dameon Pierce active/prac. squad.
Pittsburgh: CB Doneiko Slaughter pract. squad add.
San Francisco: WR Xavier Smith pract. squad add. WR Dante Pettis pract. squad del.
Seattle: S AJ Finley pract. squad add.
Washington: S Darren Hall, DE T.J. Maguranyanga, WR Nick DeGennaro pract. squad add. DT Jeffrey M'ba pract. squad del.
NHL
Calgary: LW Aydar Suniev, C Jonathan Castagna called up from minors.
Chicago: C Dominic Toninato called up from minors.
Edmonton: C Filip Hallander traded.
Florida: C MacKenzie Entwistle waived.
Minnesota: RW Tyler Pitlick called up from minors.
Montreal: G Jacob Fowler called up from minors.
NY Islanders: D Vladimir Dravecky signed.
Philadelphia: LW Alex Bump sent to minors.
Pittsburgh: D Spencer Stastney traded.

MLS

EASTERN CONFERENCE

	GP	W	D	L	Pts.
Nashville	27	18	6	3	60
New England	27	14	4	9	46
Miami	27	12	10	5	46
Chicago	27	13	6	8	45
Charlotte	27	12	7	8	43
Philadelphia	27	11	6	10	39
Orlando	27	10	4	13	34
NY Red Bulls	27	9	6	12	33
NYCFC	27	8	9	10	33
Cincinnati	26	8	9	9	33
D.C. United	26	6	12	8	30
Columbus	27	8	5	14	29
Toronto	27	6	11	10	29
Atlanta	27	7	6	14	27
Montreal	27	6	6	15	24

WESTERN CONFERENCE

	GP	W	D	L	Pts.
Vancouver	27	15	5	7	50
St. Louis	27	13	8	6	47
Dallas	27	13	8	6	47
San Jose	27	13	6	8	45
Houston	27	13	5	9	44
LAFC	28	11	8	9	41
Seattle	27	10	8	9	38
Colorado	27	11	3	13	36
LA Galaxy	28	9	9	10	36
Portland	27	9	5	13	32
Real Salt Lake	27	9	5	13	32
San Diego FC	27	8	8	11	32
Austin	27	7	10	10	31
Minnesota	27	7	8	12	29
Sporting KC	27	6	3	18	21

TUESDAY'S RESULT
At Chicago 3 ... Vancouver 1

LEADERS

Not including yesterday's games
GOALS
Lionel Messi, Mia ... 21
Petar Musa, Dal ... 18
Brian White, Van ... 17
Milan Iloski, Phi ... 16
Sam Surridge, Nas ... 16
Nicolas Fernandez Mercau, NYC ... 15
Preston Judd, SJ ... 15
Prince Owusu, Mtl ... 15
Rafael Navarro, StL ... 15
Ezekiel Alladoh, Hou ... 14
Tai Baribo, DC ... 14
Denis Bouanga, LAF ... 14
Kevin Denkey, Cin ... 14
Kelvin Yeboah, Min ... 14
ASSISTS
Anders Dreyer, SD ... 13
Cristian Espinoza, Nas ... 13
Evander, Cin ... 13
Lionel Messi, Mia ... 13
Rodrigo De Paul, Mia ... 12
Joaquín Pereyra, Min ... 12
Albert Rusnak, Sea ... 12
Heung-Min Son, LAF ... 12
Joaquin Valiente, Dal ... 12
Niko Tsakiris, SJ ... 11
SHOTS
Lionel Messi, Mia ... 149
Milan Iloski, Phi ... 101
Heung-Min Son, LAF ... 92
Brian White, Van ... 87
Evander, Cin ... 84
Hany Mukhtar, Nas ... 83
Kristoffer Velde, Por ... 83
Mateusz Bogusz, Hou ... 82
Anders Dreyer, SD ... 81
Philip Zinckernagel, Chi ... 81

Premier League

	GP	W	D	L	Pts.
Manchester City	5	5	0	0	15
Arsenal	5	4	0	1	12
Brighton	5	3	1	1	10
Brentford	5	2	3	0	9
Leeds United	5	2	3	0	9
Liverpool	5	2	3	0	9
Everton	5	2	3	0	9
Hull City	5	2	2	1	8
Newcastle	5	2	2	1	8
Chelsea	5	2	1	2	7
Ipswich Town	5	2	0	3	6
Man. United	5	1	2	2	5
Nottingham Forst.	5	1	2	2	5
Sunderland	5	1	1	3	4
Crystal Palace	5	1	1	3	4
Aston Villa	5	1	1	3	4
Bournemouth	5	0	3	2	3
Coventry City	5	1	0	4	3
Fulham	5	0	2	3	2
Tottenham	5	0	2	3	2

WEDNESDAY'S RESULT
No games scheulded
THURSDAY'S GAMES
No games scheulded

NWSL

	GP	W	D	L	Pts.
Gotham FC	27	16	7	4	55
San Diego	27	16	3	8	51
Washington	27	15	4	8	49
Utah	27	14	4	9	46
Kansas City	27	13	5	9	44
Angel City	27	12	7	8	43
Portland	27	12	7	8	43
North Carolina	27	13	3	11	42
Seattle	27	12	4	11	40
Denver	27	10	8	9	38
Orlando	27	10	3	14	33
Houston	27	8	6	13	30
Boston	27	8	5	14	29
Bay FC	27	7	5	15	26
Louisville	27	7	3	17	24
Chicago	27	5	2	20	17

WEDNESDAY'S RESULT
No games scheulded
THURSDAY'S GAMES
No games scheulded

NFL

THURSDAY'S GAME
Tampa Bay at Dallas ... 8:15
SUNDAY'S GAMES
Las Vegas at New England ... 1
Philadelphiavs. Jacksonville* ... 9:30a
Chicago at Green Bay ... 1
NY Giants at Washington ... 1
Houston at Tennessee ... 1
Indianapolis at Pittsburgh ... 1
Cleveland at NY Jets ... 1
Minnesota at New Orleans ... 1
Cincinnati at Miami ... 1
Denver at LA Chargers ... 4:05
Detroit at Arizona ... 4:25
San Francisco at Seattle ... 4:25
Baltimore at Atlanta ... 8:20
* at London
MONDAY'S GAME
Buffalo at LA Rams ... 8:15
MONDAY'S RESULT
Atlanta 45 ... at New Orleans 24
SUNDAY'S RESULTS
New England 29 ... at Buffalo 26
Indianapolis 30 ... Washington 13
At NY Giants 36 ... Arizona 24
Dallas 34 ... at Houston 30
At Chicago 23 ... NY Jets 12
Green Bay 17 ... at Tampa Bay 14
LA Rams 24 ... at Philadelphia 20
Jacksonville 22 ... at Cincinnati 17
At Baltimore 24 ... Tennessee 18
At Minnesota 15 ... Miami 10
Kansas City 30 ... at Las Vegas 27
At San Francisco 24 ... Denver 14
At Seattle 30 ... LA Chargers 23
At Carolina 32 ... Detroit 26

WNBA playoffs

Semifinals
ATLANTA vs. NEW YORK
Dream lead series, 2-0
Sunday, Oct. 4
At Atlanta 92 ... New York 82
Wednesday, Oct. 7
At Atlanta 101 ... New York 98
Schedule
Fri., Oct. 9 at New York ... 7:30
*Sun., Oct. 11 at New York ... TBA
*Wed., Oct. 14 at Atlanta ... TBA
GOLDEN STATE vs. LAS VEGAS
Valkyries lead series, 2-0
Sunday, Oct. 4
At Golden State 71 ... Las Vegas 60
Wednesday, Oct. 7
At Golden State 83 ... Las Vegas 81
Schedule
Fri., Oct. 9 at Las Vegas ... 9:30
*Sun., Oct. 11 at Las Vegas ... TBA
*Wed., Oct. 14 at Golden State ... TBA

* If necessary

Dream, 101-98

At Atlanta

NEW YORK (0-2) — Fiebich 2-5 0-0 4, Stewart 11-21 11-13 35, Jones 8-11 3-4 21, Astier 2-6 0-0 5, Ionescu 3-8 2-6 10, Allen 0-0 0-0 0, Johannes 0-1 0-0 0, Han 0-1 0-0 0, Gardner 1-1 0-0 3, Fauthoux 8-10 0-0 20. Totals 35-64 16-23 98.

ATLANTA (2-0) — Bonner 2-11 5-6 10, Hillmon 5-11 1-1 12, Reese 8-16 6-6 23, Howard 5-20 6-6 18, Canada 9-15 2-2 23, Okot 0-0 0-0 0, Paopao 1-2 1-2 4, Borlase 4-9 0-0 11. Totals 34-84 21-23 101.

Halftime: Atlanta, 56-54. 3-pt. goals: NYL 12-25 (Fiebich 0-3, Stewart 2-4, Jones 2-4, Astier 1-2, Ionescu 2-4, Johannes 0-1, Gardner 1-1, Fauthoux 4-6), ATL 12-30 (Bonner 1-4, Hillmon 1-6, Reese 1-2, Howard 2-6, Canada 3-6, Paopao 1-1, Borlase 3-5). Rebounds: NYL 36 (Stewart 11), ATL 35 (Hillmon 8). Assists: NYL 23 (Ionescu 7), ATL 22 (Canada 8). Fouls: NYL 25, ATL 18. A: 9,574.

AHL

EASTERN CONFERENCE

Atlantic Division	W	L	OL	SL	Pts.
Hartford	2	0	0	0	4
Springfield	2	0	0	0	4
Charlotte	1	1	0	0	2
Hershey	1	1	0	0	2
WB/Scranton	0	1	1	0	1
Lehigh Valley	0	1	0	0	0
Providence	0	2	0	0	0
North Division					
Rochester	1	0	0	1	3
Laval	1	1	0	0	2
Bridgeport	1	1	0	0	2
Utica	1	0	0	0	2
Toronto	1	1	0	0	2
Cleveland	1	1	0	0	2
Belleville	1	1	0	0	2
Syracuse	1	1	0	0	2

WESTERN CONFERENCE

Central Division	W	L	OL	SL	Pts.
Manitoba	2	0	0	0	4
Grand Rapids	1	0	1	0	3
Iowa	1	0	0	1	3
Texas	1	0	0	1	3
Milwaukee	1	0	0	0	2
Rockford	0	1	0	0	0
Chicago	0	2	0	0	0
Pacific Division					
Calgary	2	0	0	0	4
Colorado	2	0	0	0	4
Coachella Valley	1	0	1	0	3
San Diego	1	0	1	0	3
Bakersfield	1	1	0	0	2
Henderson	1	1	0	0	2
Ontario	1	1	0	0	2
San Jose	1	1	0	0	2
Abbotsford	0	2	0	0	0
Tucson	0	2	0	0	0

WEDNESDAY'S RESULT
No games scheulded
THURSDAY'S GAMES
No games scheulded

Latest line

COLLEGE FOOTBALL

Favorite	Pts.	Underdog
Thursday		
At Western Ky.	3	Missouri St.
At Liberty	13½	Sam Houston St.
At Arkansas St.	1½	South Alabama
At UTSA	7	South Florida
Friday		
At Louisville	3½	Florida St.
At Washington	3½	Iowa
At Utah State	5½	Washington St.
At San Jose St.	6	Wyoming
At BYU	10	Iowa State
Saturday		
Arizona	3	at West Virginia
Indiana	7½	at Nebraska
At Pittsburgh	4	North Carolina
At Bowling Gren	7½	Sacramento St.
At Missouri	3½	Texas A&M
At Army	3	Tulane
At Oklahoma St.	10½	UCF
Wake Forest	3½	at N.C. State
At Northwestrn.	37	Ball State
At Florida	11½	South Carolina
At Appalchn St.	9½	Old Dominion
Miami (Ohio)	2½	at UMass
At Toledo	21	Buffalo
At Ohio	3	Central Mich.
At North Texas	28½	Charlotte
Duke	6½	at Georgia Tech
E. Michigan	7	at Akron
At Kansas St.	2½	Houston
Illinois	2½	at Michigan St.
At W. Michigan	13½	Kent State
Mississippi	10	at Vanderbilt
At Notre Dame	38	Stanford
Texas	7½	at Oklahoma
At Navy	2½	Tulsa
At Oregon	11½	UCLA
Virginia Tech	10	at California
At Temple	3½	UConn
At East Carolina	10	Rice
At Ohio State	34½	Maryland
Tennessee	13½	at Arkansas
At Oregon St.	14½	San Diego St.
At Marshall	3	Coastal Carolina
LSU	8½	at Kentucky
Nevada	9½	at UTEP
North Dakot St.	3	at UNLV
At Memphis	14	UAB
Air Force	7½	at No. Illinois
At Alabama	1½	Georgia
James Madison	7½	at Georgia So.
At Louisian Tch.	3	Louisiana
At Virginia	9½	Syracuse
At Penn State	1½	USC
Minnesota	2½	at Purdue
At Utah	15½	Kansas
Boise St.	6½	at Fresno St.
At Arizona St.	20½	Hawaii

NBA

Favorite	Pts.	Underdog
Tuesday		
At Charlotte	3½	Brooklyn
At Oklahom Cty.	3½	New Orleans
At Utah	NL	Denver
At Golden State.	NL	LA Lakers

NHL

Favorite	Line	Underdog	Line
At Buffalo	-110	Dallas	-110
At Tampa Bay	-145	Minnesota	+125
At Montreal	-180	Nashville	+150
At Ottawa	-140	Philadelphia	+120
Utah	-120	at Boston	+100
At Carolina	-330	Vancouver	+265
At NY Islandrs	-185	Chicago	+155
At St. Louis	-145	San Jose	+125
Colorado	-235	at Calgary	+190
At Vegas	-165	Toronto	+140

NFL

Favorite	Pts.	Underdog
Thursday		
At Dallas	8	Tampa Bay
Sunday		
At Jacksonville	7½	Philadelphia
Chicago	2½	at Green Bay
Cincinnati	6½	at Miami
At NY Jets	1½	Cleveland
Houston	7½	at Tennessee
At Pittsburgh	2½	Indianapolis
At New England.	3½	Las Vegas
Minnesota	2	at New Orleans
At Washington	3½	NY Giants
Denver	3½	at LA Chargers
Detroit	5½	at Arizona
At Seattle	3	San Francisco
At Atlanta	3½	Baltimore
Monday		
At LA Rams	3	Buffalo

NBA

EXHIBITION SEASON

WEDNESDAY'S RESULTS
At Indiana 123 ... Minnesota 112
At Chicago 124 ... Phoenix 117
Milwaukee 128 ... at Oklahoma City 126
Orlando 122 ... at Memphis 118
Golden State ... at Portland
THURSDAY'S GAMES
Boston at Cleveland ... 7
New Orleans at Miami ... 7:30
Philadelphia at Brooklyn ... 7:30
Washington at New York ... 7:30
Atlanta at San Antonio ... 8
Sacramento at LA Lakers ... 10:30

Remembered

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BY CITY AND TOWN

BOSTON
DOHERTY, Stephen S.
MENITOFF, Rabbi Michael
BRIGHTON
BAYH, Peter Stephan
TORCHIO, Mary Ahern
BROOKLINE
CHERNAIK, Robert Menasseh
MENITOFF, Rabbi Michael
CHARLESTOWN
DOHERTY, Stephen S.
CHELSEA
LEWIS, Frank
CHESTNUT HILL
MENITOFF, Rabbi Michael
COTUIT
McINNIS, Catherine Leveroni
DEDHAM
TORCHIO, Mary Ahern
FRAMINGHAM
POMERLEAU, Rena H. (Browne)
HARWICH
DiMODICA, Kathryn F. (Tangney)
HINGHAM
CHERNAIK, Robert Menasseh
LEXINGTON
MENITOFF, Rabbi Michael
LINCOLN
DiMODICA, Kathryn F. (Tangney)
LOWELL
HOGAN, Donald J.
MILTON
McINNIS, Catherine Leveroni
NEWBURY
DOHERTY, Stephen S.
NEWTON
BAYH, Peter Stephan
CHERNAIK, Robert Menasseh
MENITOFF, Rabbi Michael
TORCHIO, Mary Ahern
RANDOLPH
TORCHIO, Mary Ahern
SUDBURY
DiMODICA, Kathryn F. (Tangney)
WALTHAM
POMERLEAU, Rena H. (Browne)
WAYLAND
DiMODICA, Kathryn F. (Tangney)

OUT OF STATE

BAYH, Peter Stephan

Of Newton, passed away, October 5, 2026, leaving behind a legacy of warmth, humor, generosity, and countless stories that will continue to be shared by all who knew and loved him. Peter was born on April 7, 1952, in Longmeadow, New York, to the late Karl and Erna Bayh. He is survived by his spouse and endless love, Patt; his children, Zachary, Megan and Nicholas Arnold; his brother, Raymond (Denise); his sister, Susan Martino (Joseph); his in-laws, Judi Ciccarello (Richard), James Kelly (Laura); and countless nieces and nephews. Funeral from the Lehman Reen & McNamara Funeral Home, 63 Chestnut Hill Ave. (nr Brighton Courthouse), BRIGHTON, on Saturday, October 10, at 9:30am, followed by a Funeral Mass in St. Columbkille Church, 321 Market Street, Brighton, at 10:30am. Relatives and friends are kindly invited to attend. Interment in St. Joseph Cemetery, West Roxbury. Visiting Hours on Friday, October 9, from 4-7pm, in the funeral home. For complete obituary, please www.lehmanreen.com

Lehman Reen McNamara
Brighton 617 782 1000

CHERNAIK, Robert "Bob" Menasseh

Of Hingham, MA, formerly of Brookhaven, NY, 91, died on October 4, 2026. He was the beloved husband of Judith "Judy" Levenson Chernaik for 64 years, the dear son of Joseph and Ruth Chernaik, the devoted father of Andrew Chernaik and Carol Chernaik Rumpler, the proud grandfather of Asa Chernaik, Skye Chernaik, and Serena Rumpler and the loving brother of Richard Chernaik and Warren Chernaik (deceased). He served in the United States Army as a physician and captain in Fort Dix, NJ during the Vietnam War.

A small-town doctor for almost fifty years with degrees from Cornell University and the New Jersey College of Medicine, Bob cherished his long term relationships with patients and treated them like family. He served as Chief of Medicine at Brookhaven Memorial Hospital and as Medical Director of Brookhaven Health Care Facility. In addition to his rewarding career in medicine, Bob had a true zest for life and was endlessly curious about people, events, and ideas. He was an avid tennis and pickleball player, sailor, reader, and bike rider with a keen appreciation for nature. His optimism was unflagging and contagious as he looked for and found the upside of every situation he faced. In his later years, as long as the outdoor temperature was above 60 degrees, he could be found cycling on his recumbent bike, riding upwards of 20 miles around the Linden Ponds campus.

Funeral Services will be held in the chapel at Sharon Memorial Park on Friday, October 9, 2026 at 10:00am. Interment will follow. Service will be livestreamed. Shiva will be held at Linden Ponds Senior Living Community, Seasons Catering Room in Derby Clubhouse, at 1:30pm on Friday, following the Funeral.

To honor his legacy and memory, we are hoping to establish the Bob Chernaik Bike Fund, which will provide adaptive, recumbent bicycles for the Linden Ponds Community. Details to follow.

Brezniak FAMILY OWNED

BostonGlobe.com

DiMODICA, Kathryn F. "Kay" (Tangney)

Age 84, of Sudbury and Harwichport, passed away, on Saturday, October 3, 2026.

Kay was the beloved wife for 56 years of the late Michael J. DiModica, Jr. who predeceased her on July 20, 2021. She was the loving mother of Michael J. DiModica, III and his wife, Wendy of Sudbury and Thomas F. DiModica and his wife, Jennifer of Sudbury. She was the cherished grandmother of Isabella D. DiModica and Brianna M. DiModica, both of Sudbury.

Kay also worked alongside her husband, Michael, playing an integral role in M.J. DiModica Excavating, the well-established company he founded in Sudbury. Today, the family legacy continues as the business is operated by their sons under the name M.J. DiModica and Sons..

Kay was an English teacher for several years beginning with the Somerville School System, Lincoln School System and the Lincoln-Sudbury High School.

Visitation will be held on Saturday, October 10, 2026, from 1:00 pm to 4:00 pm, at the John C. Bryant Funeral Home, 56 Pemberton Road (off Rte 30), WAYLAND.

Family and friends may gather at the funeral home on Monday, October 12, 2026, at 9:00 am, followed by her Mass of Christian Burial at 10:00 am, at Saint Anselm Church, 100 Landham Rd., Sudbury.

Interment will follow in the DiModica family lot in Mount Pleasant Cemetery, in Sudbury.

In lieu of flowers, her family kindly suggests that gifts in Kay's memory may be sent to Tufts Animal Hospital or Buddy Dog Humane Society Sudbury.

For condolences and directions, please visit www.johncbryantfuneralhome.com

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DOHERTY, Stephen S.

Age 61, of Newbury, MA, died peacefully at home, on Monday, October 5, 2026, surrounded by his adoring family.

Born on April 9, 1965, to Mary (Brosnahan) Heneghan and John Doherty, in Somerville, MA, Stephen was raised in Charlestown, MA, a community he was proud to represent throughout his life.

A 1985 graduate of Arlington Catholic High School, Stephen went on to attend Unity College in Maine, where he studied Outdoor Recreation. He then attended Stonehill College and UMass Boston, where he studied Political Science.

On October 5, 2002, Stephen married the love of his life, his "Goose," Obeida Doherty. Together, they raised two children, Andy and Jonny, of whom he was immeasurably proud.

Stephen worked for Boston Harbor Cruises, and later retired from the MWRA as a mechanic. Whether on the deck of a ship in Boston Harbor or maintaining equipment on Deer Island, Stephen took great pride in his work. But he also used these experiences as opportunities to meet and to connect with people, many of whom became lifelong friends.

To say that Stephen loved and adored his family cannot be overstated. He often talked about how lucky he was to be married to his wife, Obeida, and to be the father of two incredible sons. Fatherhood was something he never took for granted, teaching his boys about the outdoors, how to both respect and enjoy it, as well as how to be a person of integrity, compassion, and high moral character.

Stephen's upbringing in Charlestown instilled in him a strong sense of street smarts. "Head on Swivel," he used to say. But his Townie roots also instilled in him a strong sense of community, which he carried with him throughout his life. This led him to build many strong friendships, and Stephen's friends were as devoted to him as he was to them. This was evidenced by his many nicknames; Steve-O, Ditzo, and Matches, just to name a few. The friends he made growing up, and in college, playing lacrosse, truly became his family. And he continued to add to this long list of friends throughout his life. An avid outdoorsman, Stephen loved hiking, camping, kayaking, and skiing with his friends and family. But he was also content being alone, where he found peace in the solitude and beauty of nature.

Music wasn't just something Stephen loved, it was an essential part of who he was. This was clear to all who knew him, as Stephen had an encyclopedic knowledge of 80s new wave and 90s alternative artists, both popular and obscure.

He is survived by his loving wife, Obeida (Parra) Doherty; and his two adoring sons, Andrew and Jonathan; his siblings, John Doherty of Newburyport, Phillip Doherty of Milton, Deborah Doherty of South Carolina, and Janice Doherty of California. He also leaves behind many loving nieces, nephews, aunts, uncles, and cousins. Stephen was preceded in death by his beloved mother, Mary Heneghan; his father, John Doherty; and his stepfather, Richard Heneghan.

Calling Hours will be on Friday, October 9, from 4 pm to 7 pm, at Ellott, Woodworth & Rogers Family Funeral Home, 35 Green Street, NEWBURYPORT, MA. Funeral Services will be held at 10:30 am, on Saturday, October 10, at the Immaculate Conception Church, 42 Green Street, in Newburyport, MA. Donations may be made in Stephen's honor to Care Dimensions Hospice or It Takes a Herd Foundation, a program that connects horses with individuals living with dementia and their care partners.

Stephen's family would like to extend their sincere appreciation to Care Dimensions Hospice, and to all of the friends and family who came to help and support Stephen throughout this difficult journey. Stephen's family will also be forever grateful to Julio Hinojosa Flores for the love, compassion, and devoted care he gave Stephen.

Announcements

PLUMBERS & GASFITTERS LOCAL UNION #12

Brother James Manning, initiated on June 25, 2001, passed on September 27, 2026.

Brother Manning was a proud member of Plumbers Local 12 for 25 years.

We will keep you in our prayers, James.

James Vaughan- Business Manager
Gregg Petersen- President

HOGAN, Donald J. "Don"

Age 69, of Lowell, Massachusetts, unexpectedly passed away, on Friday, October 2, 2026, at Lahey Clinic in Burlington.

He was the beloved husband of Barbara A. (Betley) Hogan, who survives him.

Born in Stoneham, MA, December 11, 1956, a son of the late Duncan M. and the late Ruth M. (Colby) Hogan, he graduated from St. Mary's High School in Cambridge, MA.

After high school, Don enrolled at UMass Lowell, where he earned a Bachelor's Degree in Business Management. He then furthered his education at Rivier University, earning a Master's in Business Administration.

For the past 31 years, Don was working as a Sales Representative for B&B Trading in Stoughton, a wholesale food distributor. Previously, he worked at Purity Supreme for 16 years.

In his spare time, he enjoyed hiking, traveling, and Maine. He coached youth sports for many years. Most of all, he enjoyed spending time with his family, especially his grandchildren.

Besides his wife, Don is survived by a daughter, Kate Brown and her husband, Steve, of Lowell, MA; two sons, Justin Hogan and his wife, Brittnee Cann, of South Orange, NJ and Trevor Hogan of Lowell, MA; seven grandchildren, Quinn, Annabel, and Owen Brown, Eli and Deliliah Hogan, and June and Mars Hogan; a sister-in-law, Sharon V. Sullivan of Chelmsford, MA; and his loyal companion, Angus T. Hogan.

He was the brother of the late Robert Hogan.

Visiting Hours: Relatives and friends are invited to attend his Memorial Visitation on Saturday, October 10, 2026, at the O'Donnell Funeral Home, 276 Pawtucket St., in LOWELL, from 9:30 to 11:15 AM, followed by his Funeral Service to be held in the funeral home, at 11:30 AM. Burial will be held privately at a later date. E-condolences/directions, at www.odonnellfuneralhome.com Those wishing may make contributions in Don's memory to your favorite charity. Arrangements by Funeral Director James F. O'Donnell, Jr. (978) 458-8768.

LEWIS, Frank

In Medford, formerly of Chelsea, on October 1. Father of Frank A. Lewis; son of Stella (Racki) Lewis of Chelsea and the late Winthrop L. Lewis; brother of Robert J., Richard A., Ronald W., Michael, Paul, Winthrop E., and Stephen Lewis, Elaine Chitopoulos, Michelle O'Neil and the late David Lewis. Also survived by grandchildren, numerous nieces, nephews, grand and great-grandnieces and nephews. Relatives and friends are most kindly invited to attend Calling Hours and Funeral Services in the Welsh Funeral Home, 718 Broadway, CHELSEA, on Thursday, October 8, beginning at 9:30 A.M., followed by Services in the funeral home at 11:00 A.M. Interment at Woodlawn Cemetery, Everett. For directions or to send expressions of sympathy, please visit www.WelshFH.com

Funeral Services

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583 Mt. Auburn Street, Cambridge
MON-FRI 9-9; SAT 9-5, SUNDAY 12-5

Show respect

View The Boston Globe's complete list of death notices and sign the guestbook at boston.com/obituaries.

McINNIS, Catherine Leveroni (O'Connell) "Cathy"

Age 98, of Cotuit, MA formerly Milton, MA, passed away peacefully at her home, surrounded by her loving family and friends, on October 5, 2026.

Cathy is survived by her loving children and their spouses, John Mark Leveroni (Cindy), Daniel Leveroni (Meri), Timothy Leveroni (Jody), Ann Christy Leveroni (Peter Catizone), Catherine "Kitty" Fatemi (the late Shahin) and the late Peter Leveroni (Maureen). Loving grandmother of Jacqueline Leveroni (Ryan Luczynski), Tim Leveroni (Simona), Chris Leveroni (Holly), Josephina "JoJo" Leveroni (fiancé, Tyler Tong), and the late John Michael Leveroni; and four great-grandchildren. She was the beloved spouse of both the late John J. Leveroni and Victor McInnis.

Cathy was born and raised in Georgetown, Washington D.C., daughter of William and Beulah O'Connell, the eldest of five children. After graduating from Georgetown Visitation College, she earned her Ph.D. in psychology from UMass Amherst and practiced for the Massachusetts educational system.

She was married to John J. Leveroni for 43 years and raised their six children in Milton, MA. They retired and moved to Cotuit, MA. After John's passing, she was married to Victor McInnis for 20 years.

Cathy was a member of the Colonial Daughters of the 17th Century, the Daughters of the American Revolution, the Osterville Garden Club, and trustee of both Curry College and the Cotuit Library. Her loving pursuits included reading, gardening, her Catholic faith and spending time with family and friends.

A Mass of Christian Burial will be celebrated at Our Lady of the Assumption, 76 Wianno Ave., Osterville, MA 02655, on Saturday, October 10, at 11:00 am. Interment will follow in St. Frances Xavier Cemetery, Centerville, MA.

In lieu of flowers, donations in memory of Catherine can be made to a charity of your choice. Notes of comfort may be made to her family, at www.chapmanfuneral.com

MENITOFF, Rabbi Michael

Beloved congregational leader, teacher, husband, father and grandfather, died on October 6, 2026, of heart complications. He was 83 years old.

A native of Dorchester, MA, Rabbi Menitoff had served congregations in Los Angeles, New Haven, CT, and in his hometown of Boston. He started his career at Hollywood Temple Beth El, where he was known for his long hair, his innovative ideas, energy and media savvy. He went on to serve at Ramat Zion and was the founding rabbi at Kehillat Ma'arav in Santa Monica. He served 13 years at his childhood synagogue, Mishkan Tefila, and spent his remaining years teaching rabbinical and cantorial students.

The most important part of his life was the love and kindness he shared with his family and friends. He loved his Patriots and Red Sox.

He is survived by his wife, Roz; his two daughters, Alana and Rachel; and his grandchildren, Hannah and Daniel. Funeral Services will be held on Friday, October 9, at 11AM, at Mount Sinai Memorial Park in Hollywood, CA.

Announcements

SHEET METAL WORKERS' LOCAL UNION 17

Mourns the loss of retired member Joseph Hanson, who passed away on September 24, 2026.

He was a member of Local 17 for 52 years.

Sadly missed but not forgotten.

Russell Bartash
President

POMERLEAU, Rena H. (Browne)

Of Glen, NH, formerly of Waltham, October 1, 2026. Wife of the late Ronald J. Pomerleau. Mother of Roni Sue P. Bower (Brian) of Framingham and the late Scott H. Pomerleau. Grandmother of Matthew and Halia Bower. Sister of the late Arlene Delaney and Lois Lindahl. Also survived by several nieces, nephews and their families. Family and friends will honor and remember Rena's life by gathering for an Afternoon Wake in The Joyce Funeral Home, 245 Main Street (Rte. 20), WALTHAM, on Thursday, October 8, from 3 to 6 p.m., and again at 9:30 a.m., on Friday morning, before leaving in procession to Saint Jude Church, 147 Main Street, Waltham, where her Funeral Mass will be celebrated at 10:30 a.m. Burial will follow in Mount Feake Cemetery, Waltham. To watch a broadcast of Rena's Funeral Mass, please visit https://saintjudewaltham.org/ In lieu of flowers, memorial donations may be made to The Scott H. Pomerleau Memorial Foundation, 555 Edgell Road, Framingham, MA 01701. For complete obituary, guestbook and directions, please visit www.JoyceFuneralHome.com

TORCHIO, Mary Ahern

Of Dedham, formerly Randolph, passed away at her home, on October 6, 2026, surrounded by her loving family, after a long battle with cancer, at the age of 74.

Family and friends are invited to honor and Celebrate Mary's Life on Friday, October 9, 2026, from 4:00-7:00 PM, at the George F. Doherty & Sons Wilson-Cannon Funeral Home, 456 High St., DEDHAM. Her Funeral will be held on Saturday, October 10, 2026, at 10:00AM, at St Mary's Church, 420 High St., Dedham (accessible parking in the rear of the church). Interment in Brookdale Cemetery, Dedham.

For complete obituary and online guestbook, see gfdoherty.com

George F. Doherty & Sons
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Obituaries

‘Sudden’ Sam McDowell, Cleveland strikeout king

By Richard Goldstein
NEW YORK TIMES

Sam McDowell, the Cleveland Indians’ All-Star left-handed pitcher of the 1960s and early ’70s who battled addiction to alcohol while gaining attention for unleashing fastballs, curves, and sliders that whizzed past hapless batters, has died. He was 84.

Major League Baseball announced the death on social media but provided no further details.

Mr. McDowell was known as Sudden Sam, a nickname he said was given to him by Bob Dolgan, a sports writer for The Plain Dealer of Cleveland who had watched him throw at the Indians’ 1961 spring training camp. (Minnesota Twins’ slugger Harmon Killebrew had also remarked that his fastball arrived “all of a sudden,” he recalled.)

Pitching in all or part of 15 major league seasons, 11 with the Indians, Mr. McDowell led the American League in strikeouts five times and posted a single-season high of 325 in 1965. Throwing out of a 6-foot-5-inch, 190-pound frame, he struck out 2,453 batters in 2,492 innings.

“I think he’s got the greatest fastball, curveball, slider, and changeup I ever saw. I call him ‘Instant Heat,’” Hall of Fame slugger Reggie Jackson had said. “Sudden simplifies things out there. You know he’s gonna challenge you, his strength against yours, and either you beat him or he beats you. And he won’t throw at you, either, because he’s too nice a guy.”

Mr. McDowell was named to the AL All-Star team six times and finished third in balloting for the Cy Young Award as the American League’s most outstanding pitcher in 1970. He went 20-12 that season and struck out 304 batters in 305 innings pitched.

Sports Illustrated portrayed Mr. McDowell on a May 1966 cover alongside the caption “Faster Than Koufax?” While Sandy Koufax went on to a Hall of Fame career, Mr. McDowell, for all his strikeout statistics, struggled with his control, topping AL pitchers in walks five times and in wild pitches three times.

He faced a far more consequential struggle off the field.

By his account, he had been addicted to alcohol since 1963, when he began drinking with teammates.

“I had cemented my standing as the worst drunk in baseball as the mid-1970s approached,” he wrote in his 2022 memoir, “The Saga of Sudden Sam: The Rise, Fall and Redemption of Sam McDowell” (with Martin Gitlin).

He continued to drink heavily after his baseball career ended. His wife, Carol Ann Beisgen, divorced him and gained custody of their two children. He was living with his parents in the Pittsburgh area when he passed out one day in April 1980. As he recalled, “All I remember of that dark moment was repeating both to myself and my demon addiction, ‘You beat me, you beat me.’ I felt that I was going insane.”

He was persuaded by his family and his employer at an insurance company to enter therapy at the Gateway Rehabilitation Center in Pittsburgh.

The sessions proved to be successful, and he went on to obtain an associate degree from the University of Pittsburgh in sports psychology and addictions. He was certified as a counselor by the state of Pennsylvania in 1982.

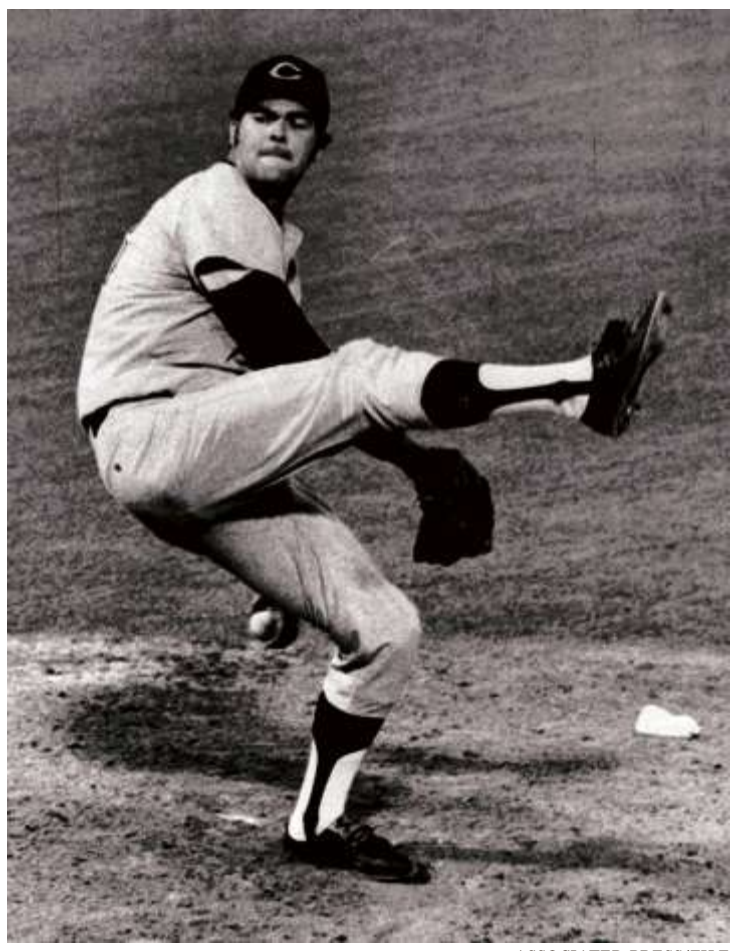
In the years that followed, he counseled addicted baseball players in coordination with the Baseball Assistance Team, which aids former players in distress, and helped athletes in other sports, as well as people in all walks of life.

“Sam spent eleven of his fifteen seasons in a Cleveland uniform as one of the game’s most feared hurlers. A strikeout king. He was a cherished member of our Alumni Ambassador program and loved sharing stories with our fans when he visited Progressive Field,” Guardians senior vice president of public affairs Bob DiBiasio said in a statement. “Most importantly, Sam’s life was a story of redemption,”

Samuel Edward Thomas McDowell was born in Pittsburgh on Sept. 21, 1942, one of six children of Thomas and MaryIrene (Donald) McDowell. His father, a former quarterback for the University of Pittsburgh, inspected equipment in steel mills. Both parents, he wrote in his memoir, were alcoholics.

He was a star pitcher and also competed in basketball, football, and track at Central Catholic High School, then signed with the Indians’ organization for a $75,000 bonus.

After pitching in the low minors, he was promoted to the Indians’ top farm club, in Salt Lake City, for the 1961 season, then made his debut with the Indians in September. He shuttled between the Indians and the minors during the next two seasons, then became part of their rotation in late May 1964. In his first start, facing the Chicago White Sox, he struck out 14 batters and went 6-0 for the season.



ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Mr. McDowell at work striking out 15 Chicago White Sox in 1970, and (below) joking with fellow baseball legend Steve Garvey at a baseball charity dinner in 2011.

FRANK FRANKLIN II/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Mr. McDowell compiled a 17-11 record in 1965 along with a league-leading 2.18 earned run average to go with his 325 strikeouts. He threw two consecutive one-hit shutouts in 1966, continued to blow pitches past batters in the next three seasons, then posted his only 20-victory season in 1970, when he was selected to his third consecutive All-Star Game.

He engaged in a contract dispute with the Indians in 1971, and they dealt him to the San Francisco Giants before the 1972 season for Hall of Famer Gaylord Perry and shortstop Frank Duffy. Mr. McDowell missed several weeks with a sore shoulder and a circulatory issue, and finished with a 10-8 record.

The Giants sent him to the New York Yankees in early June 1973. He went 5-8, then was hampered by a slipped disk in 1974. The Yankees released him after that season. He pitched sparingly in relief for the Pittsburgh Pirates in 1975, then was released in June, ending his major league career with 141 wins, 134 losses with a 3.17 earned run average.

Mr. McDowell had two children, Tim and Debbie, from his first marriage, and he married twice more, but a complete list of survivors was not immediately available.

In his later years, Mr. McDowell moved to the Florida city of Clermont, where he founded City of Legends, a community for retired athletes.

“I don’t think about the past very much,” he was quoted as saying in a 2015 profile by the Society for American Baseball Research. “Today is all I care about.”

Material from the Associated Press was used in this obituary.

Freddie Jackson, 70, R&B singer with hits in the ’80s

By Mark Walker
NEW YORK TIMES

Freddie Jackson, the silk-voiced balladeer who topped the R&B charts in the latter half of the 1980s with hits like “Rock Me Tonight (For Old Times Sake)” and “You Are My Lady,” died Monday. He was 69.

Mr. Jackson’s family announced the death on his official Instagram account Tuesday but did not cite a cause or say where he had died.

In 2024, Mr. Jackson revealed that he was living with kidney disease and said he was working with the National Kidney Foundation to raise awareness about the illness.

Mr. Jackson’s warm tenor was an instrument made for the so-called Quiet Storm era of R&B, when a lone satiny voice, a smoky saxophone, and the shimmer of an electronic piano softly drifted over the airwaves of late-night radio in big-city markets.

“It was one of those godsend voices, one of those one-in-a-lifetime voices,” Paul Laurence, a longtime friend and collaborator who wrote “Rock Me Tonight (For Old Times Sake)” for Mr. Jackson and composed other songs with him, said in an interview.

“Rock Me Tonight,” Mr. Jackson’s debut solo album, arrived in 1985 and spent 14 weeks atop the Billboard R&B albums chart. Two singles from the album, the title track and “You Are My Lady,” topped the Billboard R&B singles chart, and two others, “He’ll Never Love You Like I Do” and “Love Is Just a Touch Away,” reached the Top 10. He received two Grammy nominations in 1986, for best new artist and best male R&B vocal performance.

That run of success established Mr. Jackson as a R&B superstar. His 1986 sophomore album, “Just Like the First Time,” spent 26 weeks at the top of the Billboard R&B albums chart and featured three Billboard charttopping R&B singles: “Tasty Love,” “Have You Ever Loved Somebody,” and “Jam Tonight.”

Reviewing a 1985 Manhattan concert for The New York Times, critic Stephen Holden described Mr. Jackson’s voice as rich and warm, “pitched on the line between a tenor and a baritone.”

“With his inventive phrasing and flexible dynamics, he is able to transform formulaic pop-funk songs into engagingly open-ended personal statements,” Holden wrote, adding that Mr. Jackson “embellished love lyrics with extended melismas, vocal shivers and spontaneous hesitations that cut against the material’s formal rigidity and communicated a winning emotional immediacy.”

Mr. Jackson’s debut solo album topped the Billboard R&B albums chart.

Frederick Anthony Jackson was born in New York City on Oct. 2, 1957. Freddie, who later said he never knew his biological father, was raised by a single mother, Juanita Lavinia Jackson. He trained as a gospel singer from an early age, singing at the White Rock Baptist Church in Harlem, where he met Laurence.

In the early 1980s, Mr. Jackson moved to California, where he began his music career as a singer with the funk band Mystic Merlin. He returned to New York and reconnected with Laurence, who was working at the Hush Productions company. At Hush, Mr. Jackson sang on Laurence’s demo recordings and sang backup for singer Melba Moore, with whom he recorded another No. 1 Billboard R&B hit, “A Little Bit More,” in 1986.

Mr. Jackson, who never married, leaves no immediate survivors.

In 2024, Mr. Jackson revealed he had been diagnosed with kidney disease in a video shared on social media.

“This journey has had its challenges but I’ve decided to face it with openness and resilience,” he said in the clip. “It’s important to me that I share this with you, not just as a part of my personal story, but as a way to make a positive difference.”

Kevin Harewood, a former general manager of Hush Productions, said Mr. Jackson would be remembered for “a soulful voice which transmitted the spirit of love songs that lasts for the ages.”

“He always gave his all whether in studio or in his electrifying shows,” Harewood said.

He kept recording long after his commercial peak, issuing his last album, “My First Love,” in 2023. It was dedicated to his mother.

Material from the Associated Press was used in this report.

DAVID J. PHILLIP/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Mr. Franchione was surrounded by Texas A&M players before a game in 2007.

Dennis Franchione, college football coach

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Dennis Franchione, the longtime college football coach whose career included stops at TCU, Alabama, and Texas A&M, has died, TCU said in a statement. He was 75.

The Fort Worth Star-Telegram, which first reported the news, said Mr. Franchione’s family confirmed his death Tuesday, adding that he battled cancer for a decade. He was diagnosed with cancer in 2016 and 2021, but it had been in remission. Family friends said the cancer returned earlier this year and Mr. Franchione recently went into hospice, the newspaper reported.

Mr. Franchione worked his way up the college football coaching ranks during a career that spanned more than 30 years. Beginning as an assistant at Kansas State in 1978, he coached at New Mexico, TCU, Alabama, Texas A&M, and Texas State.

He compiled more than 200 wins in his career.

“TCU mourns alongside the Franchione family at the passing of ‘Coach Fran,’” TCU athletic director Mike Buddie said in a statement. “Our fortunes as a department would not be what they are today without the efforts of Coach Franchione, his staff, and players. Beyond his talent as a football coach, he was a beloved father, mentor, and friend to so many. Our thoughts and prayers are with his wife, Kim, and the entire Franchione family.”

TCU was coming off a 1-10 season when Mr. Franchione left New Mexico after six years to take over the Horned Frogs, who in his debut season in 1999 had a 7-5 record capped by a Sun Bowl win over Southern California. With future Pro Football Hall of Fame running back LaDainian Tomlinson, TCU finished tied atop the Western Athletic Conference standings each of the next two seasons, going 8-4 with another bowl win in 1999 before a 10-1 regular season in 2000 that led to him being hired by Alabama.

Mr. Franchione was replaced at TCU by his defensive coordinator, Gary Patterson, who had winning records in 15 of his 22 seasons as head coach.

John Iliffe, expert on ordinary Africans

By Adam Nossiter
NEW YORK TIMES

John Iliffe, a historian of Africa whose intensively researched work focused on the struggles of ordinary citizens, influencing generations of scholars and students, died on Aug. 20 in Cambridge, England. He was 87.

His death, in a nursing home, was announced by St. John’s College at the University of Cambridge, where he taught for 55 years.

For decades, Mr. Iliffe put in long hours in sweltering African archives for books that covered wars, nation-building, demography, disease, leaders and the poor. Fellow historians of the continent revered him because he placed the African at the center of his books. Not the king, the dictator or the guerrilla chief, but the African citizen, existing in the world’s most hostile physical environment and fighting to preserve his or her dignity.

Africans merited gratitude from the rest of us for that alone, Iliffe believed. They were “the frontiersmen who have colonised an especially hostile region of the world on behalf of the entire human race,” he wrote in his “Africans: The History of a Continent” (revised edition 2017).

“That has been their chief contribution to history,” Mr. Iliffe wrote in the book, still considered the standard text on African history, 30 years after it was first published.

“It is why they deserve admiration, support and careful study,” he continued.

Mr. Iliffe spent his life’s work engaged in all three.

In six major books — and especially in “The African Poor: A History” (1987) and “Honour in African History” (2005) — he cataloged the ways in which “suffering has been a central part of the African experience, whether it arose from the harsh struggle with nature or the cruelty of men,” as he wrote in “Africans.”

In “Honour,” he chronicled Africans’ endurance in the face of adversity, especially its latter-day manifestation, the tyrannical regime.

The code of African honor was many-sided, in Mr. Iliffe’s view. It helped the ordinary citizen endure brutality, but it also encouraged the dictator in vainglorious excess.

In Guinea’s ghastly Boiro prison under dictator Ahmed Sékou Touré, “prisoners measured courage by the number of torture sessions endured.” In Idi Amin’s Uganda, students “marched through the capital” to protest a shooting, at huge risk. Peasants from Ouelessebougou in Mali in 1968 flooded the capital’s jail to free their neighbors, braving the then-regime’s forces.

The flip side of this everyday heroism was what Mr. Iliffe called “the heroic style of leadership,” a “major obstacle to democracy,” he wrote, citing Ghana’s Kwame Nkrumah and Togo’s Gnassingbe Eyadema, who was “the hero himself, depicted in statues in all the important town,” a dictator who “required even his ministers to display abject servility.”

Mr. Iliffe was an old-fashioned scholar, colleagues said, interested in people and facts, not theory, and in filling hundreds of shoeboxes with index cards. Working in the state archives in Malawi, he wouldn’t leave them to applaud the head of state’s passing motorcade, as other researchers were told to do, “because he refused to sacrifice even a minute of precious time in the archive,” a colleague, Megan Vaughan, recalled.

“He had a tremendous capacity to find his way through complex subjects and bring out the humanity of the African actors,” said Derek Peterson, a historian of Africa at the University of Michigan.

“He took on a whole range of subjects, and he always put Africans at the center of the story, even when they failed.”

Mr. Iliffe wasn’t a sentimentalist about Africa and had no romantic notions about the continent, colleagues said, but nor was he what scholars and others call an Afropessimist. Mostly, he admired ordinary Africans, “the commoners, not the kings,” Peterson said.

“African history owes John a staggering debt in his sheer curiosity, his extraordinary appetite for grueling hard work, his courage in publishing in so many areas of others’ expertise,” his Cambridge colleague John Lonsdale said after his death.

CAROLINE GUTMAN/NEW YORK TIMES

Scores in National Symphony Orchestra folders on stage at the Kennedy Center in Washington. The orchestra rehearses at the center, but will perform in six venues across the region.

If the Kennedy Center is 'dangerous,' why does the Symphony rehearse there?

By Elizabeth Williamson
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The shuttered John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts is a deadly place. Just ask President Trump.

This week he said it was "a great danger to anyone who walks inside." Last month he said that a security guard had narrowly avoided "certain death" after a storm brought down a 5-foot piece of ceiling plaster, injuring no one. The center, he said, is in a "virtual state of collapse."

And yet on most weekday mornings, 100-odd members of the National Symphony Orchestra arrive for rehearsals in the shell of their former home. This week they are rehearsing in the center's main concert hall for upcoming performances in the Maryland and Virginia suburbs of Sergei Prokofiev's Symphony No. 5, Joseph Haydn's Symphony No. 85 ("La Reine"), and Igor Stravinsky's Scènes de Ballet.

The theme, as advertised on their website, is "music that finds hope and vitality in the face of adversity."

So far, none of the musicians have encountered collapsing concrete garage decks, falling 2,500-pound roof sections or "electrical explosions" — risks the center's management says lurk everywhere.

"We're just happy to work," a violinist said last week, while hustling into the building through a parking lot entrance. The violinist, and all other musicians interviewed as they entered the building, asked not be named for fear of retaliation against the orchestra, which still has financial ties to the Kennedy Center.

One musician expressed the hope that her colleagues would "shut up" and focus on music, not politics.

Another said that the orchestra's presence in the building reinforced the view by some former employees that the administration's portrayal of the building's problems have been exaggerated.

"The absurdity of this is mind-blowing," a longtime symphony patron said.

A Kennedy Center spokesperson, P.J. Elliott, said this week that the concert hall was perfectly safe for the musicians but not for the public. The hall "is not a restricted area to essential staff and NSO musicians," he said in a statement. "Musicians can rehearse in it safely during the closure." He did not explain why.

The development is the latest in the saga of Trump's takeover of the center. Briefly: Less than a month into his second term, the president purged the Kennedy Center board of Biden-era appointees, installed allies who made him chair, then announced that the place would close for two years of renovations. Democratic lawmakers on the board said it was an excuse to avoid the humiliation of plummeting ticket sales and fleeing artists.

In December, Trump put his name on the center, a living memorial to a slain president, but a judge ordered it off. When he was again denied last month, the president decreed that the renovation would not begin until courts allowed his name on the building front. He followed with a threat to tear the entire place down.

While the drama plays out, one of the nation's premier orchestras still needs a place to practice for its 2026-27 season, with concerts now in six different places across the region. They and the center's Opera House Orchestra, which now performs in an annex called The Reach, are the only paid performances that have survived Trump's takeover. Local music lovers call it a tribute to the orchestras' resilience.

ASKING ERIC

Florida heat might cause wife to leave husband

Q. I have been in central Florida for more than 26 years, and it has become unbearable to me. There's the brutal heat; the skin destroying UV-rays of that miserable, scorching, eye-blinding sun; the constant allergy/sinusitis issues that NEVER let up; the smothering humidity. The sun is here all year.

If you dare to venture out for a walk during the day, you have to wear long sleeves, long pants, a big, brimmed sunhat, a face full of sunscreen, and carry a sun umbrella. This is paradise?

It's impossible to talk about it to my husband of 51 years; he is always cold, puts the A/C at 80 degrees in the house, and walks around with a sweat shirt or flannel shirt on.

I have a 12-year-old rescue dog, a big black German Shepherd. I have limited income and want to move much further north, but I don't want to jeopardize the stable home I can give her here.

I am at the point that I dread waking up every morning only to see that intense Florida sun that keeps me in the house most of the day. I could leave my husband, but I CANNOT leave this vulnerable, loyal, loving creature that is by my side 24/7.

Because of my limited income, it would be rough finding a place that is safe and secure for me and my dog. I'm basically a very friendly, outgoing person, and living here is like being under house arrest.

What should I do to preserve my health and sanity until such time that I can get a car and drive out of this place?

TOO HOT

A. While you technically cannot outrun the sun — it does have a way of finding us — and the impacts of climate change are being felt the world over, it may help to attack this issue in pieces.

First, some immediate relief: Is there a friend or relative who lives in a cooler place and would let you and your dog visit for a week or more?

As fall progresses, this might be the perfect time to get away for a bit to clear your head. This wouldn't require you to leave your home or your marriage but could turn the heat down on the problem for a moment.

Consider talking to your husband about whether he actually likes Florida or just likes warm weather. If it's the latter, there might be other places that suit you both better.

Lastly, if you do decide you need to make a permanent move, look seriously at your finances and perhaps enlist friends or relatives to help you find a suitable place to live in a cooler climate.

Without knowing what your income is or what your living situation is in Florida, I can't say for sure that there are similar places in other parts of the country for you and your dog, but it's true that people of all income levels afford lives with pets in every state. So, it may take some creative thinking, but it is possible to find a new home, if you need to.

Q. I am writing in reference to the letter by "Mourning Mom," whose son said he wouldn't honor her burial wishes.

A possible solution to her problem could be a prepaid funeral. If she has a trusted funeral service provider, she can set up a contract and prepay for her funeral. These contracts allow you to stipulate your preferences as to cremation or another type of service.

As to the cremation, you can decide if you want a "direct to cremation." This means your remains are collected from the hospital and taken directly to the crematorium. There is no embalming or casket.

Or you can choose to have an open casket for visitation and viewing with cremation following the service. In this instance you can rent a casket for the viewing.

The contract also allows you to choose your urn for cremation, location of the service, location of the burial, the songs you wish sung, the person you wish to perform the service, and any other items you wish to state. You can even write your own obituary for the mortuary to keep on file.

You pay up front and the money is invested by the mortuary. Depending on the length of time between when you sign the contract and pay and the time it is used, your money collects interest. If there is any money left over it is turned over to the estate.

This could avoid problems with the location of a will in time so that your wishes would be carried out.

I'M ALL SET

A. This is very comprehensive and quite helpful. A great option for the letter writer and, I'm sure, other readers as well.

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at eric@askingeric.com.

Thursday October 8, 2026

Movies | Sports | News | Specials

		7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS	BBC News The	R. Steves	This Old House	Old House	Things to Do	Living in Pryde	(:10) Danny Sotomayor		(:05) Amanpour and Company (N)	
4	WBZ CBS	Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Georgie (N) (SP)	Eternally (N) (P)	Elsbeth "Crazy in Love" (N) (SP)		Cupertino "Michael & Olivia" (N) (P)		News (N)	(:35) Comics
5	WCVB ABC	News (N)	Chronicle	9-1-1 "Hearts and Flowers"		911: Nash "Intrusive Thoughts"		Grey's Anatomy		NewsCe-nter 5 (N)	(:35) J. Kimmel
6	WLNE ABC	Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live		Saturday Night Live	
7	WHDH	Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud (N)	Family Feud (N)	7 News at 9PM (N)		7 News at 10PM (N)		7 News at 11PM (N)	(:35) Inside
9	WMUR ABC	Chronicle	News (N)	9-1-1		9-1-1: Nashville		Grey's Anatomy		News (N)	J.Kimmel
10	NBC Boston	NBC 10 Boston News at 7pm (N)		Traitors "Wake of the Living Dead" (N)		Law & Order: SVU "Volition" (N) (SP)		Law "Ghost in the Machine" (N) (SP)		Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)
10	WJAR NBC	News (N) (Live)	Extra (N)	Traitors "Wake of the Living Dead" (N)		Law & Order: SVU "Volition" (N) (SP)		Law "Ghost in the Machine" (N) (SP)		News (N) (Live)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)
11	WENH PBS	Week-ends	Life-Pangea	Windows	Ken Burns & Florentine Films, 50 Years (N)			Autumn in New England		Amanpour and Company (N)	
12	WPRI CBS	Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Georgie (N) (SP)	Eternally (N) (P)	Elsbeth "Crazy in Love" (N) (SP)		Cupertino "Michael & Olivia" (N) (P)		12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics
25	WFXT FOX	ET (N)	TMZ (N)	Kitchen "Sliding Into Hell" (N)		Special Forces "Trust" (N)		Boston 25 News at 10PM (N) (Live)		News (N) (Live)	(:35) News (N)
27	WUNI	La rosa de Guadalupe (N)		Sabor a ti "El daño está hecho" (N)		Tierra de amor y "Impacto total" (N)		Corazón de oro (N)		Noticiero N+	SaborDe/ (:35) Noti..
36	WSBE PBS	Cook's Country	Story-Public Sq	Oh My Gourd		Roots Kate Burton, Barry Diller		Enslaved: The "Resistance"		PBS News Hour	
38	WSBK	Big Bang	Big Bang	WBZ News 8p (N)		Patriots	Jeopardy!	Perfect (N)	Perfect (N)	Flip Side (N)	Flip Side (N)
44	WGBX PBS	Test Kitchen	Antiques	Shakespeare		TURN "Gunpowder, Treason, and Plot"		Velvet "Two Men and a Dummy"			PBS News (N)
50	WWJE	Murder USA		Heartland Homicide		Killer Cases		Crime Stories		The FBI Files	
56	WLVI CW	Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	Scrabble (N)		Trivial Pursuit "On the Road Again" (N)		7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)		Modern Family	Modern Family
64	WNAC FOX	Family Feud (N)	Family Feud (N)	Kitchen "Sliding Into Hell" (N)		Special Forces "Trust" (N)		12 News on Fox Pr (N)		Seinfeld	Seinfeld
68	WBPX ION	FBI "Protégé"		FBI "Money for Nothing"		FBI "The Lies We Tell"		FBI "Family First"		FBI "Imminent Threat -- Part Two"	
	PREMIUM CABLE										
	Cinemax	(5:45) Colette	(:40) ★★★ Shazam! ('19) Mark Strong, Asher Angel, Zachary Levi.				(:50) ★★ Shazam! Fury of the Gods ('23) Asher Angel, Jack Dylan Grazer, Zachary Levi.				
	Flix	(6:00) ★ The Haunting ('99)		★ A Haunted House ('13) Marlon Wayans.			★ A Haunted House 2 ('14) Marlon Wayans.			★★ The Monster Squad ('87)	
	HBO	★★★ William Shakespeare's Romeo & Juliet ('96) Leonardo DiCaprio.				War (N)		(:55) War	(:50) Lanterns "Episode 8"		(:50) War
	HBO 2	NFL Film	(:40) Youth	(:10) Lanterns "Episode 8"		(:10) ★★ Supergirl ('26) Matthias Schoenaerts, Eve Ridley, Milly Alcock.				Youth	★★★ The Revenant
	Paramount-Sho	(6:05) ★★ We're the Millers ('13)		★★ Jack Reacher ('12) Rosamund Pike, Robert Duvall, Tom Cruise.				(:15) ★★ Jack Reacher: Never Go Back ('16) Cobie Smulders, Tom Cruise.			
	Showtime 2	(6:15) ★★★ Bridget Jones's Diary ('01)		★★★ My Cousin Vinny ('92) Marisa Tomei, Ralph Macchio, Joe Pesci.				★★ The Mexican ('01) Julia Roberts, James Gandolfini, Brad Pitt.			
	Starz!	(:20) ★★★ The 40 Year-Old Virgin ('05) Catherine Keener, Steve Carell.				(:20) Outlander: Blood of my Blood		(:20) Tip Toe "Episode 1"		(:10) S.W.A.T. Exiles "Take the Shot"	
	TMC	(6:15) ★★★ The Harvest ('13)		★★ Blindness ('08) Mark Ruffalo, Alice Braga, Julianne Moore.				(:05) ★★ Carriers ('09) Chris Pine, Lou Taylor Pucci.			Area 51 ('15)
	SPORTS										
	CBSSN	College Football Missouri State at Western Kentucky From Houchen Industries L.T. Smith Stadium in Bowling Green, Ky. (N) (Live)							Football (N)	Football (N)	Inside-Football
	ESPN	Count-down (N)	College Football South Florida at Texas-San Antonio From the Alamodome in San Antonio. (N) (Live)						SportsCenter (N) (Live)		SportCtr (N) (Live)
	ESPN2	Pardon (N)	College Football South Alabama at Arkansas State From Centennial Bank Stadium in Jonesboro, Ark. (N) (Live)						Basketball Sacramento Kings at Los Angeles Lakers (N)		
	Fox Sports 1	(6:00) PPA Tour Pickleball		SPEED With (N)	Kevin H Hour (N)	NHRA Drag Racing Midwest Nationals, Finals				Joel Klatt	Big Noon Kickoff
	Golf	PGA Korn Korn Ferry Tour Championship, First Round						Golf Central		PGA Tour Golf	
	NBA	(6:30) NBA	Basketball Washington Wizards at New York Knicks					The Association (N) (Live)			
	NBC Sports	NBA Basketball Boston Celtics at Cleveland Cavaliers (N) (Live)					Celtics (N) (Live)	Celtics (N) (Live)	Boston Sports (N) (Live)		Boston Sports
	NESN	NHL Hockey Utah Mammoth at Boston Bruins (N)					Bruins	Bruins	Chat (N)		NHLHock..
	FAMILY										
	Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty
	Disney	Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Place	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Kiff	Ladybug	Ladybug
	Encore Family	(6:30) Face the Music		(:05) Let Us In ('20)			Bark Ranger ('15)		(:50) ★★ The Winning Season		
	Nickelodeon	★★ Hotel Transylvania 2 ('15)				Friends	Friends	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang
	Nick Jr.	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	DORA (N)	DORA (N)	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
BASIC CABLE										
A&E	The First 48 "A Lonely Place to Die"		The First 48 "Mystery Man"		The First 48 "Drive Into Darkness"		The First 48 "Easy Mark"		(:05) The First 48	
AMC	(6:45) Stephen King's It				TNA iMPACT! (N) (Live)				★★ Carrie ('13)	
Animal Planet	Pit Bulls-Parole "Making Miracles"		Pit Bulls-Parole "Saving Prada"		Pit Bulls and Parolees "Face Off"		Pit Bulls-Parole "A Family Affair"		Pit Bulls-Parole "A Gift From Heaven"	
BBC America	(6:30) Rambo: First Blood Part II			★★ Rambo III ('88) Sylvester Stallone.					G. Norton (N)	
BET	★★ Don't Be a Menace to South Central While Drinking Your Juice in the Hood				★★ First Sunday ('08) Katt Williams, Tracy Morgan, Ice Cube.					Martin
Bravo	Housewives/OC "Don't Look Now"		The Real Housewives of Orange County (N)			Still Flipping Out "Sick of the Shtick"		Housewives/OC		Housew-ives/NYC
CMT	Mama's	Mama's	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Cheers	Cheers
CNN	OutFront (N) (Live)		Cooper 360 (N)		The Source With (N)		CNN NewsNight (N)		Laura (N) (Live)	
Comedy Central	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Daily Show (N)	(:35) Family G..
CSPAN	(6:00) Public Affairs		C-SPAN Primetime				C-SPAN Primetime			
CSPAN2	(6:00) Public Affairs		Public Affairs Events				Public Affairs Events			
Dest. America	Island (N)	Island (N)	Island (N)	Island (N)	Island (N)	Island (N)	Island (N)	Island (N)	Island (N)	Island (N)
Discovery	In the Eye of		In the Eye of		In the "Spin City"		In the Eye of		In the Eye of	
Discovery Life	Body Bizarre		Most Ext. (N)		Most Ext. (N)		Body Bizarre		Body Bizarre	
E!	★★ Burlesque ('10) Christina Aguilera, Cher.					(:35) ★★★ Easy A ('10) Emma Stone.				Movie
Encore	Movie	★★ Scary Movie 3 ('03)			★ The Back-up Plan ('10)			(:50) Man in the White Van		
Food	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Bobby Flay's the Line		Beat Bobby Flay "Titan Takeover"	
Fox News	Ingraham (N) (Live)		Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (N) (Live)		Gutfeld! (N)		Fox News (N) (Live)	
Freeform	(6:25) Ghostbusters: Frozen Empire (P)				CovenAc..	CovenAc..	(:10) Coven Acad		The 700 Club	
FUSE	Cher: Life in the Spotlight			Dolly Parton: Queen			Cheaters	Cheaters	Cheaters	Cheaters
FX	(6:00) ★★★ Thor: Ragnarok ('17)				American	American	(:15) ★★★★ Aliens ('86)			
FXM	(6:05) ★ The Watch		★★★ Sleepy Hollow ('99) Johnny Depp.				(:55) ★★★ Sleepy Hollow ('99)			Movie
Hallmark	(6:00) Texas Two-Step		Villa Amore ('25) Eloise Mumford.				Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	Gold Girls
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Murder, She ...		Darrow & Darrow "Body of Evidence"				Murder, She Wrote		Murder, She Wrote	
HGTV	Scariest House "The Eeriest of the East"		House Hunters	House Hunters	House "The Kid's Got Talent" (N)		House (N)	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters
History	Mysteries "Shady Secrets"		Mysteries "Most Valuable Finds"		Mysteries "Hidden Treasures"		(:05) Mysteries Unearthed		(:05) Mysteries Unearthed	
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic
HSN	Ron White (N) (Live)		Gotta See (N) (Live)		The List (N) (Live)		The List (N) (Live)		Radiance (N) (Live)	
ID	People Magazine "Gone Girls"		People Magazine "The Final Cut"		Murders "Little Miss Murder"		Hollywood Demons "Doctor Feelgoods"			
IFC	★★ The Devil's Rejects ('05) Bill Moseley, Sid Haig.					3 From Hell ('19) Sid Haig, Bill Moseley.				
Lifetime	NCIS "Lt. Jane Doe"		NCIS		NCIS		(:05) NCIS		(:05) NCIS	
LMN	(6:00) Dating App Kil...		The Copycat Killer ('26) Melissa O'Neil.				Killer Clown ('26) Sara Paxton.			
MAGN	Off the Grid		Off the Grid		Off the Grid		Off the Grid		Off the Grid	
MSNBC	The Weeknight (N)		All in (N) (Live)		Briefing (N) (Live)		Last Word (N) (Live)		The 11th (N) (Live)	
MTV	★★★ Ocean's Eleven ('01) George Clooney. (P)					★★★ Ocean's Twelve ('04) George Clooney. (P)				
National Geographic	Lost Tre "Legends of Hercules"		Lost Treasures of Ancient Greece		Lost Tre "Pompeii's Lost Twin"		Lost Tre "Secrets of the Acropolis"		Lost Treasures of Ancient Greece	
NatGeoWild	Port Protection		Port Protection		Port Protection		Port Protection		Port Protection	
NECN	Your News (N)		Your News (N)		Your News (N)		Your News (N)		Your News (N)	
NewsNation	Debate (N) (Live)		Cuomo (N)		On Balance (N)		Katie Pavlich (N)		Jesse Web (N)	
Ovation	Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin	
OWN	Videos		Videos		★★ Angels in the Outfield ('94) Danny Glover. (P)					First-Time
Oxygen	Unforgettable		Unforgettable		Dateline: Unforgettable "Plot Twist"				Unforgettable	
Paramount	(6:00) ★★ The Mummy ('99)				★★ The Mummy Returns ('01) Rachel Weisz, Brendan Fraser.					
QVC	Tommie (N) (Live)		Kim Gravel (N)		Inside Q (N) (Live)		Checking It Twice (N) (Live)			
Science	Fatal Engineering		Fatal Engineering		Conspiracies		Conspiracies (N)		Fatal Engineering	
Sundance	Law & Order "Sundown"		Law & Order "Loco Parentis"		Law & Order "Collision"		Archive X: Une "Alien Abduction"		Law & Order "Mother's Milk"	
SyFy	★★★ The Rock ('96) Nicolas Cage, Ed Harris, Sean Connery.						★ Night Swim ('24) Wyatt Russell. (P)			
TBS	(5:00) MLB Baseball		MLB Baseball Tampa Bay Rays at New York Yankees (N) (Live)							
TCM	(4:30) Spartacus		★★★ They Shoot Horses, Don't They?				(:15) ★★★ Lifeboat ('44)			
TLC	1000-lb Roomies		1000-lb Roomies		1000-lb Roomies (N)		My 600-Lb. Life "Syreeta's Journey"			
TNT	(5:30) Meg 2: Trench		★★★★ Jaws ('75) Robert Shaw, Roy Scheider. (P)					(:45) ★★ Jaws 2 ('78) (P)		
Travel	Most Terrifying		Most "Death Car"		Most Terrifying		Most Terrifying		Most Terrifying	
TruTV	(5:00) MLB Baseball		MLB Baseball Tampa Bay Rays at New York Yankees (N) (Live)							
TV Land	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(:20) Raymond		Raymond	Raymond	King	King
TV One	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	Uncensored		Different	Different	Different	Different	Different	Different
USA	Law & Order: Special Victims Unit		★★★ Oppenheimer ('23) Emily Blunt, Robert Downey Jr., Cillian Murphy. (P)							
VH-1	Chris	Chris	★ Blue Streak ('99) Luke Wilson, Martin Lawrence.					★★ Black and Blue ('19) (P)		
WE	NCIS "Swan Song"		NCIS "Pyramid"		NCIS		NCIS "Restless"		NCIS	

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; **TV-Y7** For children age 7 and older; **TV-G** General audience; **TV-PG** Parental guidance suggested; **TV-14** May be unsuitable for children under 14; **TV-MA** Mature audience only **Additional symbols: D** Suggestive dialogue; **FV** Fantasy violence; **L** Strong language; **S** Sexual activity; **V** Violence; **HD** High-Definition; **(CC)** Close-Captioned

Business

THE BOSTON GLOBE THURSDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/BUSINESS

Amazon subleasing Seaport building, in blow to market

Firm will only occupy half of space it intended to fill next year

By Catherine Carlock
GLOBE STAFF

Technology behemoth Amazon will no longer occupy about half of an office in Boston's Seaport District, where it once planned to hire 3,000 people.

Amazon is subleasing about 375,000 square feet of 1 Boston Wharf Road, a 17-story building the company was slated to fully occupy next year.

Amazon's partial exit from the space comes less than a year after CEO Andy Jassy moved leadership of the company's Alexa AI development from Boston to Seattle. Rohit Prasad, who'd been running that group in the Seaport, left at the end of last year. (This week, he joined the Waltham robotics firm Boston Dynamics as chief executive.)

Amazon's Seaport "tech hub" was big news back in 2022. An adjacent property at 111 Harbor Way has 480,000 square feet and is occupied by Amazon employees.

That first lease was set to receive some $25 million in state and city tax breaks in exchange for creating thousands of jobs, but there was no similar agreement for the 1 Boston Wharf office.

An Amazon representative did not respond to requests for comment.

The buildings are part of WS Development's Seaport Square, a mammoth 20-building mixed-use project on 23 acres that includes multiple luxury apartment and condominium buildings and high-end office space. This sum-

AMAZON, Page D2

DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

About 900,000 square feet of office space available for sublease is located in Boston's Seaport District.

UNIBAIL-RODAMCO-WESTFIELD

Market Basket is exploring housing and additional retail at its Chelsea flagship site, and this rendering shows potential design ideas.

Market Basket bets on Chelsea

Supermarket chain's new development will include housing

SHIRLEY LEUNG

If you love Market Basket's flagship store in Chelsea, you might like living there too.

Last week, the beloved grocery chain began circulating a 40-page conceptual master plan among Chelsea officials that would allow for two apartment buildings and more retail on its 30-acre parcel – home to its flagship and once the site of the Mystic Mall.

It's an ambitious vision that could create 162 units of housing and transform the area the city is rebranding as "West Chelsea." A residential-shopping district with a "village center" would be built on what is today the supermarket's overflow parking, according to the plan.

Hard to picture? Think Somerville's Assembly Row. At least that's the vibe the conceptual renderings give off.

The Demoulas family behind the Tewksbury-based Market Basket empire might be best known for cultivating a cult-like following with its low prices. But in Chelsea, they're also known for redevelopment. The chain bought and converted the former Mystic Mall, where it once was a tenant, into a 130,000-square-foot superstore in 2009. Now, the grocer's biggest and busiest location is about to get even bigger, when it opens a 20,000-square-foot liquor store known as MB Spirits on Friday.

Market Basket has been working for about a year with Chelsea City Manager Fidel Maltez, City Councilor-At-Large Leo Robinson, and other councilors on how to jumpstart residential development on its property. It's a great location for commuters: Both the commuter rail and Silver Line have stations abutting the property,

POWER PLAY, Page D3

POWER PLAY

Get in the loop with a twice-weekly dive into the power players and moves driving business in Massachusetts. Sign up for The Boston Globe's scoop-driven Power Play newsletter, authored by prominent Globe columnists Shirley Leung and Jon Chesto.

INNOVATION BEAT

Recent tech layoffs and buyouts tied to AI

Firms make adjustments as industry changes

By Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF

Artificial intelligence is upending all kinds of businesses, promising to take some to new heights while threatening to decimate others.

This week AI left a trail of damage across the local tech scene, like a hurricane moving up the coast, reshaping beaches in its wake. But ecosystems adapt to new shorelines. Bad news for existing companies could make room for more AI-focused startups to hire and to attract investors.

The first hit came Monday, when the industrial design software firm PTC in Boston — its stock battered by fears of AI displacement — was snatched up by a French conglomerate at a price less than it traded for a year ago.

On Tuesday, HubSpot, the Cambridge business software firm, announced it would cut nearly 700 jobs, as it struggles with AI competition (and its own declining stock price as a result).

And then Wednesday came news that Amazon will sublease more than half of its Seaport office tower, after the tech giant last year moved leadership of its AI development efforts from Boston out to the West coast.

"Tech has always been about cycles and whether it's dot com, mobile, or now AI," Boston VC Greg Raiz said. "The giants of today have trouble taking advantage of the disrupting nature of new technologies. ... This creates opportunities for some of Massachusetts' innovative and AI forward companies."

Acquisitions can be big job losers for Boston. Uber, which just bought ezCater, paid $1 billion for Boston delivery service Drizly only to shut it down three years later.

And it's an opportunistic moment for AI-related deals.

Take PTC — it's been adding AI features for several years, including autonomous agents to help design products, manage machinery, and track supply chains. But investors have remained concerned that customers would switch to newer AI-native soft-

INNOVATION BEAT, Page D2

Boston Dynamics appoints new CEO

Rohit Prasad, former Amazon Alexa executive, to lead the Waltham company known for dog robots

By Hiawatha Bray
GLOBE STAFF

Robot maker Boston Dynamics has named former Amazon Alexa executive Rohit Prasad its new chief executive.

The Waltham company, best known for its line of dog-like, four-legged robots, is naming a new chief after Robert Playter left the post in February.

Prasad, a local tech sector veteran, spent 12 years at Amazon, where he served as senior vice president and head scientist for the retail giant's Alexa virtual assistants as well as Amazon's artificial general intelligence project.

Before that, Prasad spent 14 years at Raytheon BBN Technologies of Cambridge, working on machine learning and speech recognition systems.

Boston Dynamics, owned by South Korea's Hyundai Motor Group, is a pioneering robot maker that's gained a foothold in logistics robots with its Stretch systems for unloading trucks. The company's Spot robot is used for industrial inspection, security patrols, and search-and-rescue missions.

It also was recently in the news for selling its dog robots to US Immigration and Customs Enforcement. The company said at the time that its robots are "legally prohibited from being weaponized or used for purposes of harm or intimidation."

Boston Dynamics is rolling out commercial versions of its Atlas humanoid robot to compete against humanoid machines made in China.

Atlas machines are being tested at a Hyundai facility in Georgia to see how they can be used in automotive manufacturing. The company has announced plans for a factory capable of building 30,000 Atlas robots per year.

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Rohit Prasad spent 12 years at Amazon as a head scientist.

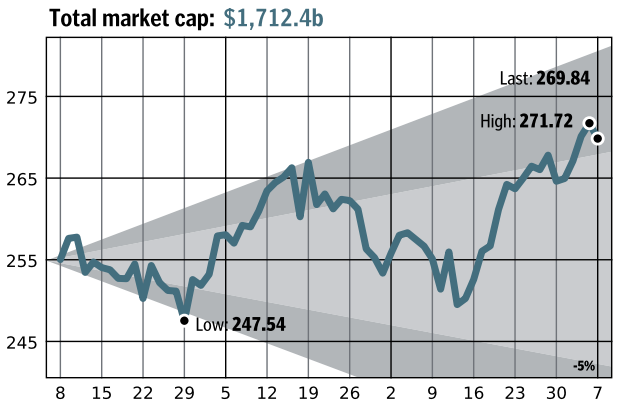
THE BOSTON GLOBE

25

Index of publicly traded companies in Massachusetts

Globe 25 index

Total market cap: $1,712.4b



Yesterday 269.84 ▼ 1.88 ▼ 0.7% ▲ YTD 11.5%

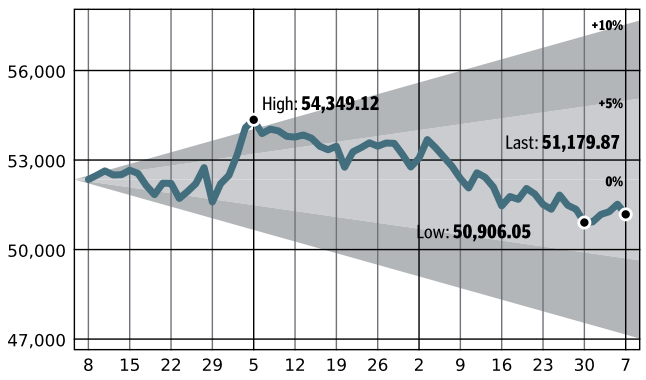
	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	997.09	-32.12	-3.1	265.6
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	662.06	+5.48	+0.8	244.8
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	410.08	-10.47	-2.5	198.7
TJX COS INC (TJX)	138.80	+1.77	+1.3	152.7
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	505.64	+3.33	+0.7	128.2
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	196.48	+9.02	+4.8	78.4
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	166.18	+1.40	+0.8	77.4
TERADYNE INC (TER)	411.78	-18.54	-4.3	64.4
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	41.58	-0.61	-1.4	60.3
STATE ST CORP (STT)	174.19	-1.56	-0.9	47.9
WATERS CORP (WAT)	435.99	-0.44	-0.1	42.8
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	30.54	-0.59	-1.9	41.6
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	115.75	-0.75	-0.6	34.5
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	222.15	-0.74	-0.3	32.8
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	224.41	+0.47	+0.2	30.0
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	43.31	-0.84	-1.9	26.2
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	335.91	-14.76	-4.2	25.7
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	166.32	-0.57	-0.3	25.4
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	65.24	-0.02	-0.0	24.6
VERALTO CORP (VLTO)	95.73	-0.72	-0.7	23.3
MKS INC (MKSI)	273.15	-8.26	-2.9	18.5
TOAST INC-A (TOST)	30.55	+0.30	+1.0	17.7
DYNATRACE INC (DT)	59.81	-1.24	-2.0	17.3
REVVITY INC (RVTY)	153.60	+0.30	+0.2	17.1
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	315.54	-2.52	-0.8	16.7

Markets

Rising yields sink stocks again

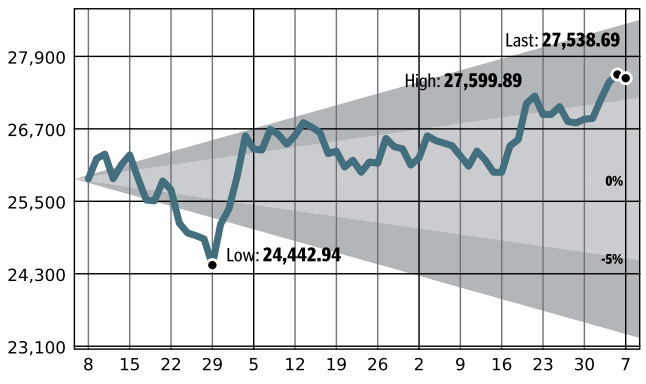
US stocks pulled back from their record on Wednesday. Stocks felt pressure as yields swung in the bond market. The yield on the 10-year Treasury climbed as high as 5.36 percent in the morning, up from 5.27 percent late Tuesday and near its highest level since 2002. But the 10-year yield eased back to 5.28 percent later in the day after the US Treasury sold $39 billion of 10-year Treasury notes at an auction, where the median yield was less than 5.26 percent. Yields also swung with oil prices, which continue to yo-yo amid uncertainty about when the war with Iran will allow the industry to return to normal. The price for a barrel of Brent crude, the international standard, topped $102 in the morning before falling back later in the day and eventually settling at $100.20, down 0.4 percent. The International Energy Agency said Wednesday that its members supported accelerating the release of oil from inventories that they announced earlier this year, with a particular emphasis on diesel fuel. Also pushing up on bond yields are worries about how much debt the US government and others worldwide have racked up, plus how much more they add to it by the day. — ASSOCIATED PRESS

DOW JONES industrial average



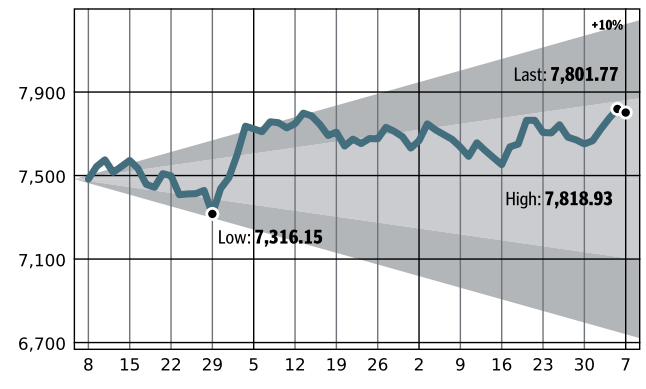
Yesterday 51,179.87 ▼ 341.41 ▼ 0.7% ▲ YTD 6.5%

NASDAQ Composite index



Yesterday 27,538.69 ▼ 61.20 ▼ 0.2% ▲ YTD 18.5%

S&P 500 index



Yesterday 7,801.77 ▼ 17.16 ▼ 0.2% ▲ YTD 14.0%

SOURCE: Bloomberg News

Report: ChatGPT for Teens unsafe

Says chatbot fails to alert parents

By Rachel Metz
BLOOMBERG

OpenAI's ChatGPT for Teens — which the company rolled out in August as the default way for kids ages 13 to 17 use its popular chatbot — is too risky for children, according to a new report from Common Sense Media.

The report, published Wednesday by the California-based nonprofit's Youth AI Safety Institute, found that in the group's tests, ChatGPT for Teens often either took too long to alert or didn't alert parents at all when teen accounts showed concerning behaviors, like engaging in lengthy conversations with the chatbot about suicide, self-harm, or eating disorders. It also determined that when users engaged the chatbot in conversations about these high-risk topics, ChatGPT for Teens did not reliably suggest getting in touch with a crisis hotline or seeking professional help.

Common Sense Media's testing found that ChatGPT for Teens only seemed to notify parents about concerning chatbot conversations if the account had "already been engaging in testing hundreds of prompts across a dozen-plus conditions over weeks, not from a single alarming conversation."

"We call on OpenAI to pause marketing the product and to keep teens off ChatGPT until it can offer a safe, developmentally appropriate experience," the group, which shared its findings with the AI startup before publication, said in its report.

An OpenAI spokesperson said, "We welcome rigorous independent evaluation, but we do not believe Common Sense Media's testing accurately reflects how ChatGPT's teen safeguards work in practice or expert perspectives on how AI can support teens."

The spokesperson said that OpenAI's review of Common Sense Media's methodology for the report indicated that most of its testing might have started and finished before OpenAI completed its rollout of parental controls for teenagers; if so, that would make the group's conclusions inaccurate and wouldn't show whether the parent-safety notifications work as they are designed. The company said it asked the nonprofit to redo its tests.

"We are deeply committed to teen safety and to developing safeguards and giving parents meaningful tools to guide their teens' use of AI," the spokesperson said.

Robbie Torney, head of AI and digital assessments for the Youth AI Safety Institute, said that the nonprofit stands behind its testing methodology and results. He added that before carrying out its tests, the group confirmed with OpenAI that teen-related features for ChatGPT such as notifications related to eating disorders had been rolled out. For the parental notification feature, OpenAI told the group after its tests were completed that it can take several hours for its systems to activate on newly linked accounts; some test accounts were linked "within that window" and some for "significantly longer," but still provided no adult notifications, Torney said.

"This new information does not change our conclusion that parental alerts are unreliable for crisis situations," he said.

ChatGPT also fails to reliably identify interactions with teen users, Common Sense said. OpenAI has said its chatbot would switch to its Teens mode when it detects users in the 13 to 17-year-old age range. The nonprofit said that when it registered for accounts and claimed to be an adult, those accounts weren't automatically switched to the teen experience — even if the user told the chatbot they were 13 years old.

OpenAI said its age-prediction software takes into account a number of different signals over time to ensure adult and child users get the right version of the chatbot for their age group. A user stating their age in a conversation with ChatGPT is one such signal, but that alone won't change how the account is classified, the company said.

OpenAI, which has more than 1.2 billion ChatGPT users, released ChatGPT for Teens with the aim of making its chatbot safer for younger people. The company said at the time that the teen-focused experience included increased parental controls and was designed to promote healthy AI use and encourage teens to learn and think critically.

The release is among a number of changes the company has made in response to scrutiny about how its products affect young users' mental health and cognitive development. These concerns mounted after the parents of a 16-year-old user sued the company in last year, alleging that OpenAI's technology aided in the planning of their son's suicide.

In its report, Common Sense Media said it tested ChatGPT both before and after OpenAI released ChatGPT for Teens, trying over 4,000 prompts on accounts registered as users between the ages of 13 and 17.

CHANCE YEH/GETTY IMAGES FOR HUBSPOT/FILE/2023

HubSpot said this week it would cut nearly 700 jobs.

Tech layoffs, buyouts tied to AI

▶INNOVATION BEAT
Continued from Page D1

ware, or even start coding their own apps, which could put pressure on PTC's pricing and sales growth.

The company's shares were trading at $144 last week — down from a peak of almost $220 last July. If the deal with France's Schneider Electric is completed, the offer of $205 a share will be a short-term balm for suffering shareholders.

Still, Schneider chief executive Olivier Blum is assembling a lineup of software offerings via acquisitions, including PTC, to appeal to his customer base of manufacturers, utilities, and other industries. That means there may be little duplication between PTC's current workforce and Schneider's, beyond the usual HR and finance overlaps. If Blum decides PTC's Boston base is a strength and adds jobs here, the impact on the local market could be muted or even positive.

At HubSpot, cutting jobs won't by itself help address the company's AI struggles. Chief executive Yamini Rangan insisted on Tuesday that the layoffs would allow the company to shift more resources to add AI smarts to its marketing and customer support software, even as stock market investors have been skeptical.

"This is not simply a cost-cutting exercise," Rangan wrote in an email to employees. "This change is about where and how we invest so we can put more resources behind our biggest opportunities." Departing employees got 20 to 30 weeks of severance and five months of health care premiums, she noted.

The job-cutting tactic is widespread among software companies trying to add AI features as quickly as possible, as their stock prices sink on fears they will be displaced by newer AI startups, according to a report by Arjun Bhatia, an analyst at William Blair. HubSpot's stock, which had previously fallen 45 percent this year, barely budged on the layoff news.

Amazon, which once planned to create 3,000 high-paying jobs in the city, has obviously swung its expansion plans elsewhere. Last year, chief executive Andy Jassy shifted leadership of the company's AI development efforts from Boston, under longtime local tech fixture Rohit Prasad, to Seattle. Prasad left Amazon at the end of 2025 after a dozen years there.

But Prasad's departure from Amazon may provide the kind of disruption that helps a different local tech player. This week, Waltham robotics company Boston Dynamics, famed for its dog-like Spot machine, snapped up Prasad to be its new chief executive. His charge is to boost sales by imbuing the company's robots with more AI powers.

And that could be part of an AI-fueled rebound that everyone seems to be hunting for.

Aaron Pressman can be reached at aaron.pressman@globe.com. Follow him @ampressman.

Boston biotech's Parkinson's pill hits goals

By Naomi Kresge
BLOOMBERG

Cerevance Ltd.'s experimental pill helped people with Parkinson's disease control their symptoms for a longer period each day, potentially giving patients a new option for managing their illness.

The pill, called solengepras, reduced patients' average "off-time," a period when medication wears off and symptoms return, by about 37 minutes compared to a placebo after 12 weeks, the Boston-based biotech said on Wednesday. The therapy was tested as an add-on to existing treatment.

While the pill can't restore neurons affected by the disease, the results are promising because the drug works differently from existing Parkinson's medicines, which replace or mimic dopamine in the brain.

The results could open up "an entirely novel drug class beyond the dopamine pathway which has been the basis of Parkinson's treatment for decades," Kate Bingham, a managing partner at SV Health Investors, said in a statement. SV Health says it's the largest investor in privately held Cerevance, while declining to disclose the size of its stake.

The most frequently reported side effects were headaches and urinary tract infections, followed by insomnia. Solengepras acts on a receptor in the central nervous system called GPR6.

SV Health hopes to see the compound reach patients as soon as possible, said Laurence Barker, a partner at the firm and board member at Cerevance. The biotech will meet with the Food and Drug Administration regarding the data.

Introduction in Europe is more challenging because of the large differential between Parkinson's treatment pricing in the United States and other markets, Cerevance chief executive Craig Thompson said in an interview. The Trump administration's most-favored nations policy calls for companies to price new medicines in the United States at the level of other wealthy countries.

Amazon to sublease some space in Seaport

▶AMAZON
Continued from Page D1

mer, the Chestnut Hill-based company took out a $660 million mortgage on a portion of the 1 Boston Wharf property from Wells Fargo, Suffolk County property records show. WS Development declined to comment.

To Mark Fallon, director of research and strategy at real estate brokerage Hunneman in Boston, such a large sublease is an example of Boston's uneven office market recovery following the pandemic. Business leaders last month cheered Fidelity Investments reopening Commonwealth Pier, where it now expects workers to report five days a week. But this week, Amazon, a tech giant with a market capitalization of $2.76 trillion, said it no longer needs office space it had long planned to occupy.

Recovery "is not going to be perfectly linear," Fallon said. "There's going to be fits and starts."

There's about 2.3 million square feet of office space available for sublease in Boston, Fallon said. Of that, about 900,000 square feet is located in the Seaport District.

The smaller office that Amazon already occupies, at 111 Harbor Way, is expected to eventually also house a small-format Whole Foods grocery store. Whole Foods, which Amazon owns, has not said when the store will open.

The 1 Boston Wharf space, meanwhile, will have a 500-seat theater and a 100-seat black box theater, which Amazon has previously said "will add significant state-of-the-art capacity for the performing arts in Boston." WS Development has not said when the theaters are expected to open.

Amazon's offices are close to the headquarters of Foundation Medicine, a subsidiary of Swiss pharmaceutical giant Roche, at 400 Summer St. Foundation has subleased offices within its 16-story life-science laboratory to toymaker Hasbro, which intends to relocate 700 employees from Providence to its new Boston headquarters by the end of this year.

Aaron Pressman of the Globe Staff contributed reporting. Catherine Carlock can be reached at catherine.carlock@globe.com. Follow her @bycathcarlock.

TALKING POINTS

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HEALTH

WHO SAYS OBESITY DRUGS SHOULDN'T BE USED FOR YOUNG CHILDREN

The World Health Organization issued a strong recommendation against obesity medications for children under the age of 10, saying it's not clear how the powerful drugs would affect them in the long term. Healthy food and exercise should be the focus for these young patients, WHO said. For older ones between the ages of 10 and 19, medicine is an option only if supervised lifestyle-change programs haven't been successful, according to the United Nations agency. Bariatric surgery could also be considered "under strict conditions" for adolescents with severe obesity, WHO said. If health authorities around the world follow the guidance, it could reduce the potential uptake of the current generation of powerful weight-loss medicines, which market leaders Eli Lilly & Co. and Novo Nordisk are increasingly testing on children. Some 170 million children and teens had obesity as of 2024, according to WHO. In a study released last month, Novo's blockbuster GLP-1 medicine Wegovy helped two out of five children between the ages of six and 12 lose enough weight to no longer be classified as obese. Lilly started a study of its drug Zepbound last month in the same age group that's due to deliver results by 2029. Wegovy is approved in the US and Europe for teenagers aged 12 and older. Zepbound isn't. — BLOOMBERG NEWS

ECONOMY

FED MINUTES SHOW OFFICIALS SAW MORE WORK TO DO TO QUELL INFLATION

Federal Reserve officials overwhelmingly concluded that they had more work to do to quell inflation after raising interest rates at their September meeting, according to minutes from the meeting released Wednesday. Last month, the Fed voted to raise rates by a quarter of a percentage point to a range of 3.75 percent to 4 percent. It was the first increase since July 2023 and was supported by all 12 members of the policy-setting committee. Projections released alongside the Fed's rate decision showed that 16 of the 18 policymakers who submitted rate estimates expected at least one more quarter-point move by the end of the year. That would push rates to a range of 4 percent to 4.25 percent. Most wanted rates to stay at or above that level throughout 2027. Officials also raised their estimates for rates for 2028 and beyond compared with three months ago. According to the minutes, many officials assessed that higher rates would be "prudent on risk-management grounds, providing insurance against inflation remaining persistently above target due to stronger-than-expected demand or further adverse supply shocks." Others suggested that raising rates was necessary based solely on the current outlook for price pressures. Some also suggested that raising rates would guard against the public losing confidence that inflation, which has overshot the Fed's 2 percent target for nearly six years, would eventually ease. Moreover, several participants said they did not view the Fed's previous policy settings as either "restrictive or only mildly restrictive," suggesting that higher rates were necessary to slow down demand sufficiently and get inflation under control. — NEW YORK TIMES

REAL ESTATE

THE CHRYSLER BUILDING WILL GET MAKEOVER BY NEW OWNER TISHMAN SPEYER

The Chrysler Building, the art deco skyscraper that has defined the Manhattan skyline since it opened in 1930, is poised for a makeover. Tishman Speyer, the large commercial landlord, along with a number of other investors, is buying the building for $235 million and planning a substantial upgrade of its interiors. The purchase caps more than a year of uncertainty after the building's previous owners ran into financial difficulty and were criticized for neglecting its upkeep while vacancies soared. Rob Speyer, the CEO of Tishman Speyer, said in that his firm planned to restore the Chrysler Building's offices and common areas to their former glory. "We're going to modernize the whole infrastructure of the building, whether it's doing a total overhaul of the elevators, or the stainless steel at the crown of the building, polishing it so that it shines," Speyer said. "Because this is a building that every New Yorker feels like they own. Because when you see it on the skyline, it's your building." — NEW YORK TIMES

PHARMACEUTICALS

MERCK'S NEW KEYTRUDA SHOT BLOCKED IN EUROPE AFTER COURT LOSS

Merck & Co. was blocked from selling a new injectable version of its blockbuster cancer drug Keytruda in several European countries, dealing a setback to the drugmaker's efforts to extend its most important franchise ahead of looming patent expirations. A Dutch court ordered Merck's European unit to stop manufacturing, selling, or stocking the subcutaneous version of Keytruda in Belgium, Denmark, France, Ireland, Italy, the Netherlands, Sweden, and Switzerland, according to drug delivery company Halozyme Therapeutics Inc., which has several suits underway against Merck. The court found that the product infringed one of Halozyme's patents covering technology used to deliver medicines under the skin, the company said Wednesday. The technology, called MDASE, was developed through years of rigorous research that allows patients to receive rapid, high-volume subcutaneous drug delivery, the company said. "We strongly disagree with the Dutch court's decision to grant a cross-border injunction. We consider Halozyme's patent to be invalid globally and its allegation of infringement to be without merit," a spokesperson for Merck said. "We are evaluating next steps but are confident in our overall legal position and believe that, ultimately, we will prevail in the courts." The ruling complicates Merck's strategy for protecting Keytruda, the world's top-selling cancer medicine, as its core patents begin expiring later this decade. Merck has developed the under-the-skin formulation, sold as Keytruda Qlex in the US, in part to shift patients away from the original intravenous version before cheaper copies arrive. Merck reported $463 million in sales from Keytruda Qlex last quarter. It's expected to become a multibillion dollar product. The new injectable version can be administered in minutes, compared to about 30 minutes for the intravenous infusion, making it more convenient for patients and doctors. Merck has said it expects a significant portion of eligible Keytruda patients to eventually switch to the new formulation. — BLOOMBERG NEWS

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

MCDONALD'S SUED OVER AI TOOL THAT RECOMMENDS PRICES TO US FRANCHISEES

McDonald's is facing a federal lawsuit that alleges its AI-enhanced pricing tool violates antitrust laws because it shares nonpublic data with franchisees who might be competing in the same market. The lawsuit, which was filed Friday in Illinois, said McDonald's pricing tool uses artificial intelligence to collect data that competing franchises wouldn't normally share, like store-level sales. The Chicago-based burger giant has said it makes the tool available to US franchisees to help them set prices at their individual restaurants. The lawsuit also blames the pricing system for raising McDonald's US prices. "McDonald's has built and for years deployed its own information-sharing pricing platform, which draws on data from its millions of daily transactions to set menu prices across thousands of US restaurants," the lawsuit states. "The result is algorithmic price-fixing aimed at customers who are already stretched thin." McDonald's said Tuesday that the lawsuit is "filled with inaccuracies" and it would vigorously defend itself. "AI does not set menu prices at McDonald's restaurants – McDonald's franchisees do," the company said. "Optional tools are available to franchisees to help them make the best decisions for their businesses and customers, but these tools do not automate, coordinate, or fix pricing in any way." — ASSOCIATED PRESS

FINANCE

TRUMP'S HUD INVESTIGATING WELLS FARGO FOR RACE-BASED LENDING

The Trump administration on Wednesday accused Wells Fargo of discriminating against homebuyers by creating programs that favored minority applicants for loans. The allegations came in a letter from the Department of Housing and Urban Development to Wells Fargo's CEO, Charles Scharf. The letter said the San Francisco bank was being investigated for violations of the Fair Housing Act, a Civil Rights-era law that barred banks and other lenders from considering race, religion, sex, and national origin, among other factors, in their underwriting. The letter cited "repeated public promotion of explicit race-based policies," including offering Black homeowners lower-cost refinancing and the creation of a $150 million credit program "to advance racial equity in homeownership." He raised the specter of expanding the investigation to include the Department of Justice. Black and Hispanic families are far less likely to own homes than their white and Asian counterparts, according to the Pew Research Center. — NEW YORK TIMES

Blue Cross spending on health care rises; drug costs cited

By Alison Kuznitz
STATE HOUSE NEWS SERVICE

Health care spending growth at the state's largest commercial insurer surged by nearly 12 percent in fiscal 2025, according to a new study that offers a jarring account of health care affordability woes partly driven by pricey drugs.

Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts saw spending growth escalate after the pandemic, climbing from 1.2 percent in calendar year 2019 to 6.8 percent in fiscal 2024. That acceleration continued into fiscal 2025, with spending climbing 11.8 percent, according to the study published Monday in the national journal Health Affairs.

The study, coauthored by experts from Harvard University and Blue Cross Blue Shield itself, dove into the insurer's claims and administrative data from 2018 through the first half of 2025. Roughly 40 percent of commercially insured in the state — or about 1.8 million to 2 million residents — are enrolled in Blue Cross Blue Shield plans.

The insurer-specific findings function as a microcosm within the state's overarching health care affordability crisis, with soaring premiums and out-of-pocket costs forcing residents to delay seeking care or sacrifice paying for other essentials like groceries. Initial recommendations from Governor Maura Healey's Health Care Affordability Work Group aim to ameliorate the problem by increasing investments in primary care, instructing insurance regulators to establish default out-of-network payment rates, updating the state's health care proxy and default surrogate decision-making laws, and leveraging state agencies' purchasing power to lower drug costs and improve access to medications, among other policies.

Recent spending growth acceleration in the Blue Cross Blue Shield sample was "a few percentage points" above other states, which the study said "largely reflects a greater impact of GLP-1s in Massachusetts relative to other states because of greater generosity of GLP-1 coverage in Massachusetts." Commercial insurers, as well as MassHealth and the Group Insurance Commission, have stopped covering GLP-1 drugs for weight loss due to massive cost pressures, though critics say the policy move could exacerbate health care disparities.

Spending on retail prescription drugs grew by nearly 19 percent when adjusted for inflation in fiscal 2025, compared to 1.7 percent in calendar year 2019. Spending on GLP-1 drugs increased by about 84 percent, compared to a 9.6 percent growth rate for all other retail drugs, the study found.

According to Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts, "essentially almost all of the growth in retail drug spending was due to growth in volume or a shift in utilization to higher-price drugs, including new drug launches," the study said, pointing to "increased use of high-cost chemotherapy and other specialized treatments for conditions such as multiple sclerosis and Crohn's disease."

The study also said new drugs may be clinically valuable, though policymakers must balance which patients should receive the treatments and how to rein in steep prices without "unduly discouraging innovation."

Market Basket bets on Chelsea housing

▶POWER PLAY
Continued from Page D1

and multiple bus routes have stops. And when there's no traffic, the drive to downtown Boston can take less than 15 minutes.

One thing is clear: Market Basket couldn't have moved forward unless Chelsea made it easier to build. Rising interest rates and the high cost of construction have made it impossible for many projects to pencil out.

Maltez kept hearing from the company and other developers about how three things were needed to get them off the sidelines: zoning reform, easing the city's affordable housing mandate, and tax breaks.

His reaction? "Let's do it."

Like a contractor checking off his punch list, Maltez has been working with the City Council, and in June the city reduced its affordable housing requirement and passed zoning regulations allowing increased density in the area that surrounds Market Basket. Now city officials are actively working with other developers who need tax abatements from the city and state.

Why the sense of urgency? Maltez saw how developers flocked to neighboring cities of Revere and Everett. Between 2020 and 2025, Chelsea grew housing permits by 31 percent, while Everett surged by 59 percent and Revere by 228 percent, according to Boston Indicators research. (At least Chelsea wasn't as bad as Boston, which saw a 40 percent drop!)

Maltez thinks apartment construction stalled in Chelsea because the city passed an affordable housing requirement in 2017. Developers went to Revere and Everett, where mandates are nonexistent and lower, respectively.

Consider the calculation developer Greystar made as it was constructing 1,900 apartments on land straddling Everett and Chelsea. It considered putting one building on the Chelsea side, but the affordable housing requirement made it financially unfeasible. Instead Greystar put a park in Chelsea.

Now Chelsea's so-called inclusionary development policy matches Everett's. Gone is the 15 percent set aside of affordable units; buildings under 10 units are exempt, while only developments with 50 or more units must have 10 percent that are affordable.

In a statement, Market Basket president Chuck Casassa confirmed the chain has been "working very closely" with the city and that recent policy changes made a difference.

"The city has shown its strong commitment to this process by making complementary zoning changes and actively pursuing needed infrastructure improvements and other financial incentives for developers," he wrote.

If the master plan is approved by the council, Market Basket, I'm told, would seek a development firm like Redgate for the buildout.

On a recent walking tour of the Market Basket site, pigeons and box trucks occupied the store's overflow parking lots, where Maltez hopes apartment buildings will rise some day soon. He explained that Chelsea needs development to generate new tax revenue and alleviate the city's housing crunch. The Market Basket property is a good place to start.

After all, he pointed out: "Pigeons don't pay taxes."

Shirley Leung is a Business columnist. She can be reached at shirley.leung@globe.com.

Inheritances shatter families. Could a therapist help?

By Susan Shain
NEW YORK TIMES

Bill Martin knows one thing: When he dies, he wants his three sons to stay close — to still grill out on summer evenings, to still gather on holidays and birthdays, to still go fishing side by side.

Martin and his brother no longer do any of those things, even though they live next door to each other in Rufus, Ore., a desert town about 100 miles east of Portland.

After their father retired, leaving them the family farm in 2022, the brothers hired a business consultant. But they clashed over the farm's future, and their relationship devolved painfully, to the point where they no longer speak.

Martin, who grows peppermint and wheat and raises cattle, is 55. He doesn't plan to retire for decades. But when he does, he doesn't want his sons to squabble. So he hired a coach-slash-therapist to help develop a succession plan that prioritizes family harmony.

"I don't want my kids to go through the pain that I went through," Martin said.

Over the next two decades, an estimated $124 trillion will change hands in the United States, flowing mostly from boomers to younger generations, in what has been deemed the greatest wealth transfer in history. In many cases, the decisions leading up to these inheritances, and their consequences, will be fraught. To get through the process while maintaining their sanity — and their relationships — some family members are turning to coaches or therapists for guidance.

"It's not necessarily about getting everybody to agree," said Donna Hillier, a Florida psychologist who's helped dozens of families navigate inheritance issues. "It's helping the family develop the capacity to disagree, without allowing the disagreement to determine how they interact with each other."

Bequests can be a boon and a bane: Roughly one-third of adults over 50 have experienced family conflict as a result of an inheritance, one AARP survey found.

Whether it's grandma's favorite earrings or a multimillion-dollar trust fund, the answer to "who gets what" can be emotionally sticky.

For the bequeathers, especially those who have founded a business, Hillier said, questions of legacy and identity abound: Who will I be after stepping down? Who will steward the business in a way I approve of? Who will take care of the money I worked so hard for?

For the inheritors, questions of worth come into play: Whom did mom love more? Who did dad think was more responsible? Who was paying attention to my accomplishments?

"As human beings, we make meaning of different things, like what money means, what inheritance means, what ownership and titles and authority mean," Hillier said. "We'll use those words and will tie them to things like fairness, trust, competence, contribution, and belonging."

Nancy Burgoyne, a psychologist and the chief clinical officer at the Family Institute at Northwestern University, agreed. "It can be as simple as money and 'who gets more,' but usually what's underneath that is 'who matters more,'" she said. Or at least that's how it can feel to those involved.

GILBERTO TERRAZAS/NEW YORK TIMES

Bill Martin and his brother squabbled over their family farm in Rufus, Ore., after they inherited it. Martin said he doesn't want the same fate for his sons.

Therapists can encourage parents to think about the impact their decisions will have on their children and their children's relationships with one another, Burgoyne said. Even when things can't be split evenly, as is often the case with family businesses, therapists can help parents telegraph their reasoning — a small step, she said, that can make a big difference.

No matter what someone is passing down, Burgoyne advises her clients to start with curiosity. If a father is wondering what to do about the family home, for example, she might nudge him to ask his children how they feel. Maybe all of them want the house. Maybe none do.

That knowledge could inform a plan. And even if the ultimate decision doesn't please everyone, Burgoyne said, letting people feel heard increases the likelihood of a successful outcome. "At a minimum, having the process communicates respect," she said.

Hillier also tries to steer clients away from the nitty-gritty of the plans and back to the people who are or aren't named in them.

"Families devote considerable energy to the legal and financial plan, while postponing conversations underneath it," she said. "A lot of assumptions start to happen."

Elaine Froese, a coach and farmer from Manitoba, Canada, estimates she's helped more than 1,400 families with the succession process in her decades-long career. Most of them have been farmers.

"I started in 1993 going to people's farmhouses with a flip chart to get them to talk about the things they weren't talking about," she said. "Nobody wants to grab the bull by the horns and deal with it."

Today, though her process often occurs virtually, Froese and her colleagues still meet with each family member separately before bringing everyone together to discuss their hopes and fears about the transaction ahead.

"Accountants and lawyers are tactical and strategic," she said. "But our driving force is communication, understanding, and conflict resolution."

Martin's brother, Doug, 54, wishes they'd found someone like Froese years ago. He believes he and his brother's "biggest screw-up" was hiring a consultant focused more on the business than the people behind it.

"I wish there was some way that we could rewind and have the right person," Doug Martin said. "My mom and dad are 83, and their family is torn apart."

From right down the road, but worlds away, Bill Martin felt similarly.

"My relationships are broken," he said. "We didn't get our ducks in a row."

Bill Martin's oldest son, Max, 27, appreciates that his father is trying to avoid that outcome by hiring a coach. "Any help is great through my eyes," he said. "When you've lived what we've lived through, you don't want to ever see that happen again."

Officials seek to build up Black businesses

Lawmakers at event call on owners to speak up, ask for support

By Katie Castellani
STATE HOUSE NEWS SERVICE

Black small business owners are facing economic conditions similar to those they dealt with as a result of COVID-19, Black Economic Council of Massachusetts chief executive and president Nicole Obi said Tuesday. And to help, state and federal lawmakers are calling on more Black business owners to speak up.

"Well, like many businesses and particularly small businesses, there's inflation, the tariffs, the higher prices, the immigration policy removing a lot of — not only affecting our business owners themselves but the employees that they often hire," Obi told the News Service during the council's Mass Black Expo. "All these are really difficult to overcome when at the same time you're also under-resourced. So, you know, in many ways, our community is facing economic challenges on the same level as when we were during the COVID crisis because of it."

Obi pointed to an August report from the Federal Reserve Bank of Boston that estimated the median net wealth for Black families to be $7,800 compared with a median net wealth of $374,000 across the state. And the report estimated that the median family net wealth was $549,200 for white families.

"We really want to make sure that we are keeping it front and center, so that when we're looking for solutions, we're not just focused on the big businesses. We're focused on even some of our smaller businesses that really help to keep our economy going," Obi said.

US Senator Ed Markey, ranking member of the Senate's Committee on Small Business and Entrepreneurship, vowed to provide more support for Black businesses. He suggested he expects to be reelected this fall and return to Washington as part of a Democratic majority in the US Senate. Markey is competing against Republican John Deaton in the Nov. 3 general election in his bid to maintain his seat.

"I will be, in January, the chair of the small business [committee] of the United States. So, I will be there in the Senate as the chair, and the whole agenda is just going to flip 180 degrees. We're going to start to focus on the Black-owned businesses, the entrepreneurs that deserve support," he said.

If tapped as committee chair, Markey said his "number one bill" would be legislation dubbed the SPARK Act that aims to boost access to capital and resources for entrepreneurs from underserved communities. The bill would establish the SPARK Program to offer at least $500,000 annually in grant funding to community organizations that help small business accelerators and incubators, according to a one-pager on the bill. There would also be a SPARK Financing Program offering up to $500,000 for organizations that would be used to provide either grants of up to $20,000 or subsidized loans to underserved small businesses.

JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Nicole Obi, president and chief executive of the Black Economic Council of Massachusetts, emphasized the challenges Black small business owners face.

"And so, to the extent to which we're going to need lobbying, we're going to need people who are activating. We're going to need the Boston and Massachusetts leaders in the Black community communicating with the leaders all across the country. So we build a national loop around the need to have the SPARK Act to come along," Markey said.

State Senator Lydia Edwards, an East Boston Democrat, also urged more Black residents and small business owners to meet with the elected officials and ask for help.

"I can count on one hand the amount of Black businesses that came into my office and said, 'Yo, I need help,'" Edwards said. "Again, that had nothing to do with D.C. and a lot to do with you coming to me or Ms. [Senator Liz] Miranda — the other Black senator — and saying to us, 'I'm here, I'm struggling,' or 'I'm here and I'm trying to thrive, and I need you to work with me.' You wouldn't believe how many other businesses have no problem doing that."

Edwards and Markey spoke during a fireside chat at the event, which was held at the Omni Boston Hotel at the Seaport in Boston. Obi said BECMA added the fireside chat to its annual event two years ago and it became popular among members who don't know who their lawmakers are and the work that they do.

"And so we want to just really, if for nothing else, get our community more engaged in understanding what these elected officials actually do, and that this is not something that every four years or every two years or every six years that you just check a box, that you should actually know who they are. Know what they do, and also make sure that they know who you are, and don't let the first time they hear from you be because of a crisis that you're having," Obi said.

Attorney General Andrea Campbell, the first Black woman to hold the role in the state, also explained her office's work during the event. She noted that for small businesses, access to capital remains a major hurdle and encouraged business owners to contact her office if they need help.

"So we want people to know we're accessible to them," Campbell said, adding that she has offices across the state.

Asked what it looks like for residents to advocate for themselves or their businesses, Campbell discussed the importance of community.

"The power of our community should never be discounted," Campbell said. She added, "Creating community and space for us to say, 'OK, how do we demand what we want from our government, but they can't do it all. How do we fill the gaps in our own community? How do we hold each other accountable? How do we do it without any ego, making space for everyone?'"

New AI trade group launches with focus on health sector

By Colin A. Young
STATE HOUSE NEWS SERVICE

A new trade group launched this week to give artificial intelligence companies in the health, human services, and life sciences worlds a collective voice in anticipation of state government writing the rules that will govern how AI can be deployed in hospitals, dentists' offices, group homes, and more.

MassIntelligence launched with two founding member companies and plans to add 13 others by invitation. The founding member companies included in the group's launch are Impruvon Health, a Maryland-based company that has a Massachusetts state contract to provide an electronic medication record system for group homes and community programs, and California-based patient logistics company VectorCare.

Jay Youmans, a former state health official who now heads up the public affairs and strategic consultancy Bulfinch Strategies Group, cofounded the group with biotechnology strategist Mahnoosh Mirzaei. Bulfinch partner Thomas Mangan, a former state public health official, is the group's director of government affairs.

The group's formation comes as House and Senate negotiators privately debate how to regulate powerful AI models at the state level and as federal policy makers are also moving to impose greater government oversight on an industry that is fueling both economic expansion and constituent anxiety. US Representative Lori Trahan of Westford on Wednesday announced draft legislation to make it easier for people to sue AI developers in situations when an AI agent causes harm.

Youmans said Massachusetts should not try to replicate Silicon Valley's focus on general-purpose AI models. His group will look to hone the state's "competitive advantage [of] applying AI to the sectors where the Commonwealth already leads, like health care, human services, and life sciences."

"We already have the hospitals and human-services providers, researchers and innovators, life sciences ecosystem, public-policy infrastructure and global credibility to lead the world in applying targeted AI innovations to real-world problems. MassIntelligence exists to meet this Massachusetts moment and ensure the companies already doing this transformational work are at the table when the rules governing it are written," Youmans, who previously held senior positions at the Department of Public Health and the Executive Office of Health and Human Services, said.

State government in Massachusetts is in the early stages of grappling with AI. The Executive Office of Technology Services and Security established a generative AI policy for state agencies; the attorney general outlined how existing consumer protection, civil rights and data security laws apply to AI; and the governor and Legislature have authorized $100 million for the Massachusetts AI Hub, with additional investment included in ongoing legislative negotiations.

"However, Massachusetts still lacks the operational rules governing how AI may be deployed in settings including hospitals, dental practices, group homes, and research programs. Current law does not yet fully define how sensitive health and research data may be used within health AI systems, what constitutes meaningful professional oversight, or how systems should be monitored after deployment," MassIntelligence said in its launch announcement. "Massachusetts has an opportunity to create a statewide framework for distinguishing low-risk tools from high-risk clinical applications, and existing law does not clearly allocate accountability when adverse events occur."

VectorCare CEO David Emanuel said state regulations should recognize different levels of risk for different uses of AI. He said powerful frontier models and purpose-built health care applications operate "in completely different contexts."

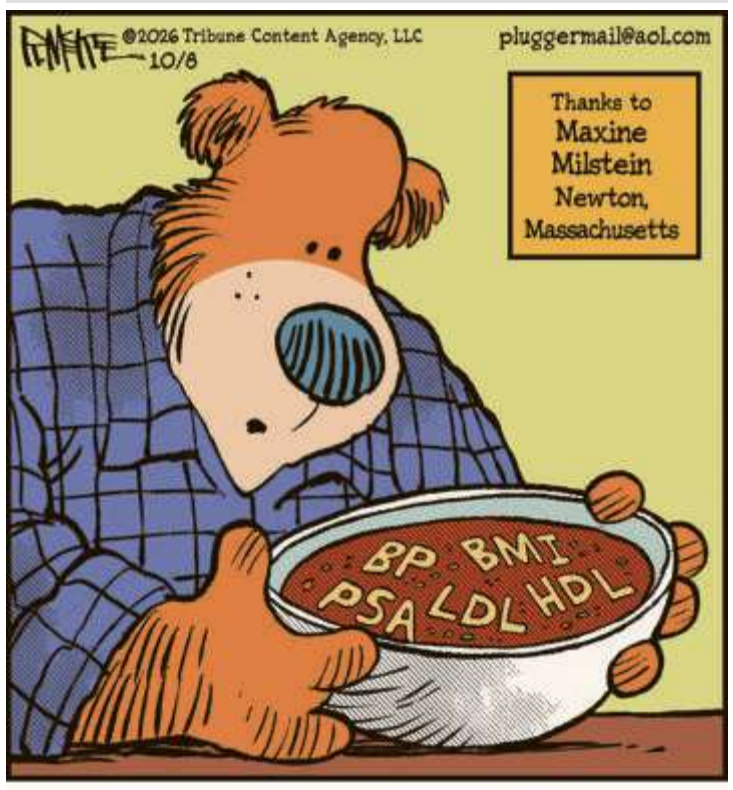
"Companies like ours are already using machine learning within existing care infrastructure to expand access, improve coordination and deliver measurable benefits for patients. Massachusetts needs rules that recognize those critical differences, regulate with appropriate nuance, and enable responsible innovation that delivers measurable improvements in people's lives while reducing inefficiencies," he said.

The Executive Office of Health and Human Services paid Impruvon, one of MassIntelligence's founding member companies, $14.4 million in July 2025 for a license running through June 2028. The deal gives providers in the Department of Public Health's Medication Administration Program a free electronic medication record system. DPH said in August 2025 that "Impruvon will reduce medication errors, limit turnover and simplify MAP compliance."

On Wednesday morning, Trahan released a "discussion draft" of her proposed Clear Liability for Artificial Intelligence Misconduct Act, which the congresswoman said aims to ensure that developers "answer for what their systems do." She is seeking feedback from experts, industry, advocates, and the public.

CRABGRASS by Tauhid Bondia

PLUGGERS by Rick McKee



A plugger's new alphabet soup.

ZITS by Jerry Scott & Jim Borgman

DOONESBURY by Garry Trudeau

DUSTIN by Steve Kelley & Jeff Parker

RED & ROVER by Brian Basset

ARCTIC CIRCLE by Alex Hallatt

FOR BETTER OR FOR WORSE by Lynn Johnston

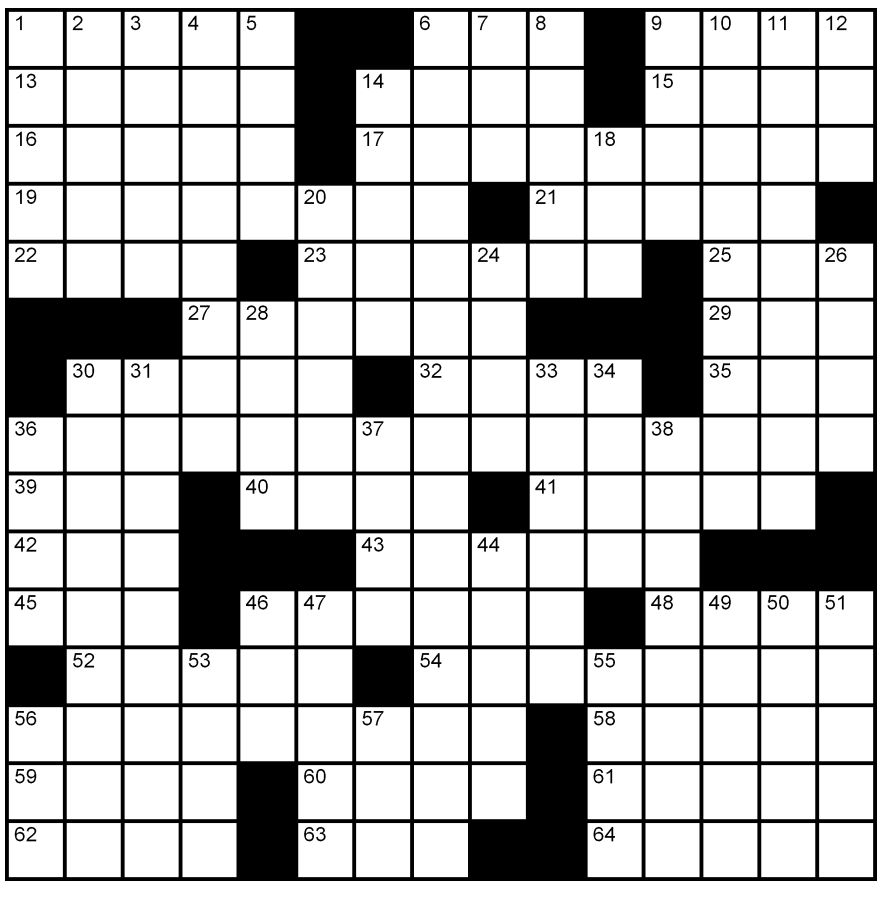
CURTIS by Ray Billingsley

RHYMES WITH ORANGE by Hilary Price

ARLO & JANIS by Jimmy Johnson

UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

FALL 2026 THEMELESS WEEK, PUZZLE 4 BY ZACHARY EDWARD-BROWN AND ADAM SHAPIRO | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG



ACROSS

1 What a mathematician or detective seeks
6 It can be found on Safari!
9 "Frozen" queen
13 Two-gender pronoun
14 Hindi for "tea"
15 Attaches the binding to a quilt, say
16 Warren Buffett's Nebraska hometown
17 Foamy drinks made with plant-based milk
19 "So there!"
21 Alpaca relative
22 Australian gem
23 No more than
25 Type "typo" rather than "type," e.g.
27 Oscar winner Brie
29 Wilson of the WNBA
30 Certain songbird
32 It's not working!
35 Touch on the shoulder
36 Causes of icy postgame interviews?
39 Like Adam (age redacted), but not Zachary (age 17)
40 Idle of Monty Python
41 Agenda entries
42 Don't squander
43 In a ___ of speaking
45 Soccer coach Guardiola
46 Park, e.g., in Manhattan
48 They may bruise when they clash
52 Indian wedding dye
54 "See you then!"
56 Warning to stay in one's lane
58 Line between two cities in Ticket to Ride
59 Result of beehiving yourself?
60 Mid
61 Red emotion in "Inside Out"
62 Piece of office furniture
63 Flat fish
64 Ales and lagers

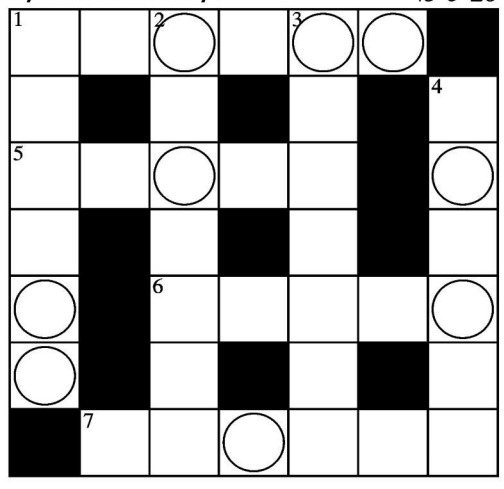
DOWN

1 Snapchat story part
2 Change, as keyboard assignments
3 Tennis player Naomi
4 "Absolutely not!"
5 Guinness entry, say
6 Exasperated cry to a relentless arguer
7 Have some kolacky or doughnuts
8 Banknotes
9 Is, in Ibiza
10 "I wanna fight those guys!"
11 They benefit from curses!
12 Really bad, in slang
14 Nail polish layers
18 Dump account, perhaps
20 Response to a groan-worthy dad joke
24 White Monopoly 8-Down
26 Many songs on the 2026 Drake album "Iceman"
28 Lot measure
30 Unrealistic expectation
31 "Could be yes, could be no"
33 Radiates
34 NPR bag
36 Ascend
37 Coin with a 2026 "Liberty Over Tyranny" version
38 "This relationship is SO over!"
44 A little loco
46 Insect in a hill
47 What e-cigs don't produce, technically
49 Dashboard device
50 Playful water mammal
51 Futures experts?
53 Cozy place to solve crosswords
55 Omani, typically
56 Palindromic flop
57 Lucius Best, ___ Frozone

JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt

10-8-26



ACROSS

CLUE	ANSWER
1. Bodily harm	RYUNIJ
5. Handmade work	FCTRA
6. One in possession	NWEOR
7. Break free	CPSAEE

DOWN

CLUE	ANSWER
1. Earnings	NCIOEM
2. Envious	LSOEUAJ
3. Domed chamber	DTNUROA
4. Very intense	CFREIE

CLUE: He was 15 when his first stand-up comedy performance bombed at a Toronto club.

BONUS ○○○ ○○○○○○

How to play: Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

ANSWERS: 1A-Injury 5A-Craft 6A-Owner 7A-Escape 1D-Income 2D-Jealous 3D-Rotunda 4D-Fierce B-Jim Carrey

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Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

Boston's forecast

AccuWeather. Superior Accuracy™ for Better Decisions Visit AccuWeather.com

TODAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.
HIGH **72-77** LOW **51-56** | A morning shower; otherwise, sun and some clouds. Winds WSW 10-20 mph. Clear tonight. Winds W 8-16 mph.

FRIDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.
HIGH **67-72** LOW **48-53** | Mostly sunny and a steady breeze. Winds W 12-25 mph. Clear at night. Winds WNW 7-14 mph.

SATURDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.
HIGH **64-69** LOW **51-56** | Plenty of sunshine. Winds WSW 6-12 mph. Mainly clear at night. Winds SW 6-12 mph.

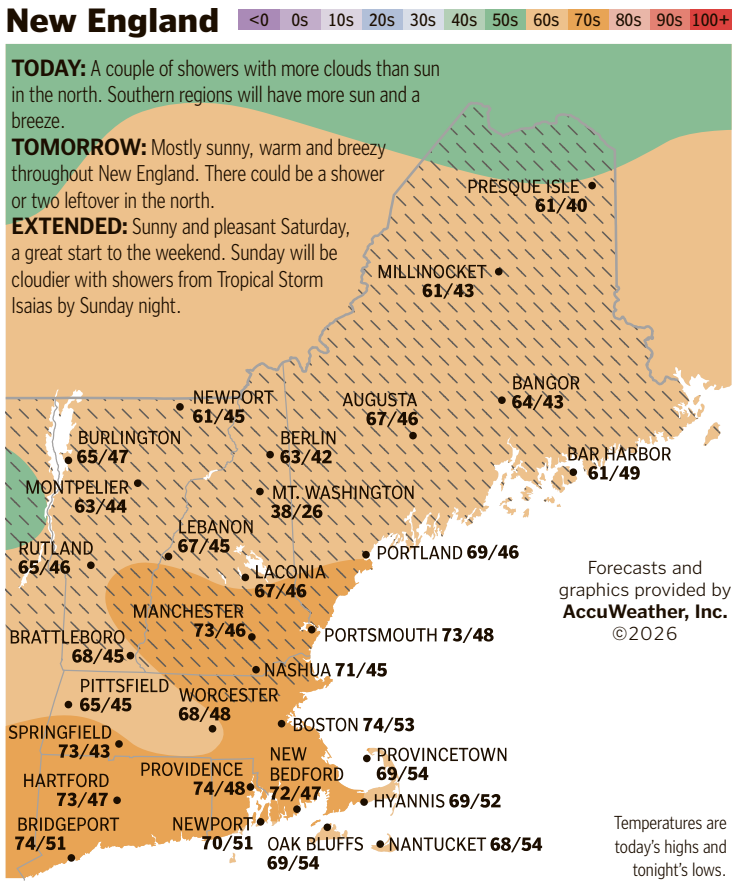
SUNDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.
HIGH **66-71** LOW **55-60** | Sun through high clouds. Winds SSW 7-14 mph. Rain from Tropical Rainstorm Isaias at night. Winds SSE 6-12 mph.

MONDAY 6 A.M. NOON 6 P.M.
HIGH **65-70** LOW **52-57** | Rain from Tropical Rainstorm Isaias in the morning; cloudy. Winds NNE 7-14 mph. Clearing at night. Winds NW 6-12 mph.

New England

<0 0s 10s 20s 30s 40s 50s 60s 70s 80s 90s 100+

TODAY: A couple of showers with more clouds than sun in the north. Southern regions will have more sun and a breeze.
TOMORROW: Mostly sunny, warm and breezy throughout New England. There could be a shower or two leftover in the north.
EXTENDED: Sunny and pleasant Saturday, a great start to the weekend. Sunday will be cloudier with showers from Tropical Storm Isaias by Sunday night.



Forecasts and graphics provided by **AccuWeather, Inc.** ©2026

Temperatures are today's highs and tonight's lows.

Almanac

Yesterday's high/low	66°/43°
Sunrise today	6:49 a.m.
Sunset today	6:14 p.m.
Moonrise today	4:31 a.m.

Mount Washington (5 p.m. yesterday)

Weather	Mostly cloudy
Visibility	90 miles
Wind	west-southwest at 44 m.p.h.
High/low temperature	41/21
Snow depth at 5 p.m.	0.0"

Allergies Source: Asthma & Allergy Affiliates, Inc.

Trees	Weeds	Grass	Mold
Absent	Absent	Absent	N.A.

Yesterday's mold and spore rating.

Eastern Massachusetts air quality
GOOD MOD. UNHEALTHY VERY UNHEALTHY
40 — 50 100 150 200 300

For more information on today's conditions, call the state hotline at (800) 882-1497 or Massachusetts Department of Environmental Protection web site www.state.ma.us/DEP

24 Hr. Precipitation (valid at 5 p.m. yesterday)

Yesterday	0.00"	Month to date	Trace	Year to date	22.94"
Precip days in October	3	Norm. month to date	0.89"	Norm. year to date	32.49"

Climate data are compiled from National Weather Service records and are subject to change or correction.

Tides

	A.M.	P.M.
Boston high	10:05	10:27
Height	10.0	10.3
Boston low	3:48	4:10
Height	0.2	0.3
High tides		
Old Orchard ME	9:57	10:18
Hampton Beach NH	10:11	10:32
Plum Island	10:16	10:39
Ipswich	9:56	10:18
Gloucester	10:09	10:32
Marblehead	10:05	10:27
Lynn	10:08	10:30
Scituate	10:10	10:34
Plymouth	10:15	10:39
Cape Cod Canal East	9:59	10:22
Cape Cod Canal West	8:53	
Falmouth	9:49	10:11
Hyannis Port	10:58	11:23
Chatham	11:04	11:31
Wellfleet	10:19	10:41
Provincetown	10:04	10:27
Nantucket Harbor	11:05	11:31
Oak Bluffs	10:33	10:58
New Bedford	6:42	7:08
Newport RI	6:34	6:59

New England marine forecast
● Small craft advisory ● Gale warning ● Storm warning

	Wind	Seas	Temp
Boston Harbor	SW 8-16 kts.	1-3 ft.	73/53
● East Cape Cod Canal	SW 10-20 kts.	4-7 ft.	71/50
● Buzzards Bay	SW 10-20 kts.	3-5 ft.	71/49
● Martha's Vineyard	SW 10-20 kts.	2-4 ft.	70/51
● Nantucket	SW 12-25 kts.	3-5 ft.	68/55
● Provincetown	SW 10-20 kts.	2-4 ft.	70/55

For current Charles River Basin water quality, call (781) 788-0007 or go to http://www.charlesriver.org.

Cities

Forecast high and low temperatures and conditions

● Travel delays possible, **C** Clouds, **F** Fog, **H** Haze, **I** Ice, **Pc** Partly Cloudy, **R** Rain, **Sh** Showers, **S** Sun, **Sn** Snow, **Fl** Flurries, **T** Thunderstorms, **W** Windy

	Today		Tomorrow	
Atlanta	85/66	Pc	80/62	Pc
Atlantic City	78/49	S	73/48	S
Charlotte	85/61	S	77/59	Pc
Chicago	71/51	Pc	70/59	Pc
Dallas	88/66	S	90/65	S
Denver	84/56	S	85/55	S
Detroit	69/44	S	68/53	Pc
● Fort Myers	87/75	T	89/76	T
Los Angeles	93/68	S	86/68	S
● Miami	89/79	T	91/78	T
New Orleans	86/75	Pc	80/70	R
New York City	74/54	S	70/54	S
Philadelphia	78/54	S	74/53	S
Phoenix	103/81	S	104/79	S
Salt Lake City	83/60	S	85/64	S
San Francisco	77/57	Pc	71/59	Pc
Seattle	70/55	Pc	63/47	Sh
Washington	81/54	S	76/56	S
Beijing	80/49	Pc	80/55	S
● Cancun	88/77	R	90/76	R
● Mexico City	72/57	R	69/55	T
● Montreal	63/46	Sh	57/37	Sh
Toronto	65/46	Sh	65/47	Sh
Vancouver	62/53	Pc	59/48	Sh
Jerusalem	78/63	S	79/62	S
London	60/52	S	66/47	Sh
Moscow	59/45	C	62/44	C
Paris	60/44	S	60/53	R
● Rome	77/64	Sh	73/56	Pc
San Juan	90/79	T	91/79	Sh
● Stockholm	56/44	R	46/35	C
Tokyo	77/63	S	77/63	S

SUDOKU

		3	9	6				
					5	1	6	
					1			4
1	2				7		4	
3								2
	4		2				8	5
7			4					
	9	4	8					
				9	6	4		

Fill in the grid so that every row, every column, and every 3X3 box contains the digits 1 through 9. Puzzle difficulty levels: Easy on Monday and Tuesday, more difficult on Wednesday and Thursday, most difficult on Friday and Saturday. Tips and computer program at www.sudoku.com.

DAILY BRIDGE CLUB

BY FRANK STEWART

South dealer — Both sides vulnerable

North
♠ 8 7 6 2
♡ A J 8 3
♢ 8 7 3
♣ 7 4

West
♠ Q J 4
♡ Q 10 7 4 2
♢ K 9
♣ J 3 2

East
♠ 5
♡ K 9 5
♢ A Q 6 4 2
♣ Q 9 8 5

South
♠ A K 10 9 3
♡ 6
♢ J 10 5
♣ A K 10 6

South	West	North	East
1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠	Pass
4 ♠	All Pass		

Opening lead — ♡ 4

"We are confronted with insurmountable opportunities." — Pogo.

Declarer's task at today's four spades seems insurmountable: He has three diamonds and a trump to lose. A diamond opening lead would let the defense prevail, but West isn't up to leading the king from K-9; he leads a low heart.

In my club's penny game, South took the ace of hearts and cashed the A-K of trumps. East discarded, so South went down one. Could he surmount his problem?

South can compress his four losers into three. He must ruff a heart at Trick Two, then cash the the top trumps. When East shows out, declarer takes the A-K of clubs, ruffs a club in dummy, ruffs a heart and leads his last club.

West can't gain by ruffing with his high trump — dummy would pitch a diamond — so West discards, and dummy ruffs. South has won nine tricks. He ruffs dummy's last heart, winning his 10th trick when West must follow. The defenders' trump trick and diamond tricks clash on the last three tricks.

DAILY QUESTION You hold: ♠ 5 ♡ K 9 5 ♢ A Q 6 4 2 ♣ Q 9 8 5. The dealer, at your left, opens one spade. Two passes follow. What do you say?

ANSWER: You must not sell out to one spade; your side may have a makeable partscore or game. Double. A few players would double one spade in the direct position, but in the "balancing" position, to double is clear. Partner must realize that you may have stretched to act to prevent the opponents from buying the contract cheaply.

HOROSCOPES

HAPPY BIRTHDAY for Thursday, Oct. 8, 2026: You're clever, idealistic, and optimistic. You pursue your dreams with charm and logic. This is the final year of a nine-year cycle for you. Take inventory of your life. Let go of the people, places, and things from the past that held you back. Do some internal and external housecleaning.

ARIES *(March 21-April 19)*
Today you might have to put your own emotional considerations second to those of someone else. An element of service is a theme for you. You also might explore ways to improve your health, especially through diet. Be aware there's a Moon Alert all day. Tonight: Get organized.

TAURUS *(April 20-May 20)*
This is a wonderful, creative day! If you're involved in the arts or a creative project, you can use your artistic talents because this entire day is a Moon Alert, which means your mind is free, floating like a helium balloon released in the sky. Tonight: Socialize!

GEMINI *(May 21-June 20)*
Focus on home and family. Relax at home among familiar surroundings. Cut yourself some slack, because it's hard to crank up ambition today. Take it easy. Enjoy the company of others, but don't agree to anything important. Tonight: Cocoon at home.

CANCER *(June 21-July 22)*
This is a great day for a short trip. Or you might want to relax and learn something new. Conversations with daily contacts will be a pleasant way to pass this day. Because there's a Moon Alert all day, avoid shopping except for food and gas. Tonight: Learn something new.

LEO *(July 23-Aug. 22)*
This is a tricky day because the entire day is a Moon Alert, which is a poor day for shopping or making important decisions. Nevertheless, this Moon Alert is taking place in your Money House, which means you're thinking about financial matters, negotiations, and perhaps shopping. Caution! Tonight: Check your belongings.

VIRGO *(Aug. 23-Sept. 22)*
Today the Moon Alert is taking place in your sign, which might make you feel more emotional. However, it can also make you feel relaxed and free-floating. Don't make important decisions. Don't go shopping. Relax and socialize with others. Tonight: You're in charge.

LIBRA *(Sept. 23-Oct. 22)*
This is the perfect day to be low-key and hide somewhere (with good food and drink). Lower your ambitions when it comes to what you want to accomplish today. Shortages and a lack of focused energy might slow you down. Go gently. Tonight: Peace and quiet.

SCORPIO *(Oct. 23-Nov. 21)*
This is a lovely day to schmooze with others! With Venus and Mercury in your sign, you'll enjoy talking to people. In turn, people will be attracted to you because you're charming. Think about future goals but commit to nothing important today. Tonight: Be friendly.

SAGITTARIUS *(Nov. 22-Dec. 21)*
This entire day is a Moon Alert, which is pleasant, creative, and great for schmoozing, but poor for important decisions and spending money. For your sign, the Moon Alert is taking place at the top of your chart, which means people notice you. Be aware of this. Tonight: Be modest.

CAPRICORN *(Dec. 22-Jan. 19)*
You might have some feelings of escapism today because you want to do something different. You want a change of scenery. If you can explore the world around you, by all means, do so. Keep things light. Restrict spending to food and gas because there's a Moon Alert all day. Learn something new! Tonight: Explore and learn.

AQUARIUS *(Jan. 20-Feb. 18)*
Be careful because today there's a Moon Alert in effect all day, and it's taking place in one of your Money Houses. Therefore, postpone decisions about inheritances, shared property, taxes, debt, and insurance issues. It's OK to do your homework in these areas, but wait until tomorrow to commit or act. Tonight: Check your finances.

PISCES *(Feb. 19-March 20)*
You have to be accommodating when dealing with others today. In fact, you might have to go more than halfway. Don't agree to anything important, because this entire day is a Moon Alert. Enjoy schmoozing with everyone. Tonight: Be friendly and cooperative.

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ZIPPY "Extra Innings" by Bill Griffith

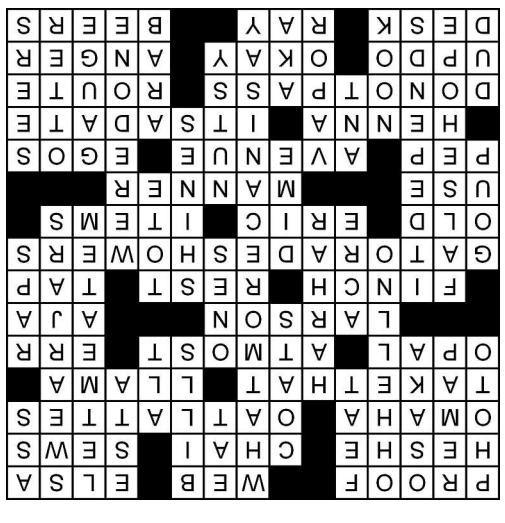
ADAM@HOME by Rob Harrell

BIZARRO by Wayno & Piraro

ROSE IS ROSE by Pat Brady & Don Wimmer

MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM by Mike Peters

Today's Crossword Solution



Today's Sudoku Solution

5	1	3	9	6	4	2	7	8
4	7	2	3	8	5	1	6	9
9	8	6	7	2	1	5	3	4
1	2	8	5	3	7	9	4	6
3	5	9	6	4	8	7	1	2
6	4	7	2	1	9	3	8	5
7	6	1	4	5	2	8	9	3
2	9	4	8	7	3	6	5	1
8	3	5	1	9	6	4	2	7